

Amazon Support Knowledge Base

Orders • Delivery • Returns • Refunds • Payments • Prime • Account & Privacy

20 sections • 359 answered entries • 22 reference tables • worked case files • letter templates • topic index

Search the help centre: [where is my order](#) | [return window](#) | [refund not received](#) | [a-to-z claim](#)
| [prime renewal](#)

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AMZ-KB-2026-09 • REV 3.0 • 20 SECTIONS • 359 ENTRIES

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Reading this guide

How this guide is organised

Every entry is written answer-first, the way a help-centre article is written: the question a customer would actually type, then the mechanics, then what to say or upload so the request lands in the right queue. Where a rule is the platform's, it appears as a **POLICY NOTE**. Where the useful part is knowing how to ask, it is a **SUPPORT-DESK TIP**. Where the obvious answer is wrong, it is a **WATCH OUT**. Numbers are given as ranges and windows rather than single figures, because the figure printed on your own order page is the only one that binds.

How the sections fit together

Sections 01 and 02 cover the account itself — what is collected, and who can get in. Sections 03 to 11 follow an order through its life: placement, delivery, the return decision, the refund, and everything that can go wrong at each stage, with warranty and Prime alongside. Section 12 is a rapid-fire FAQ that points back into the others. Section 13 covers who you can actually talk to and what they can do. Sections 14 to 19 extend the same treatment to digital content, streaming, devices, grocery and household subscriptions, business purchasing, and — read it backwards — the seller's side of a claim. The appendices hold the reference tables, ten worked case files, ten letter templates and the index.

The one thing that resolves most contacts

Before contacting support, assemble the six-item evidence set described in section 11: order ID, invoice PDF, photos of the item and its label, a short failure video, the packaging with its shipping label, and a timestamped list of what you already tried. Cases opened with the full set are routinely granted on first review; the same cases opened bare come back as “more information required” and re-enter a queue, which is where most of the delay customers experience actually comes from.

First-response checklist — run this before opening a case

1. Read the order details page in full, including per-shipment status and the **Invoice** link.
2. Check **Your Messages** in the account — verification and policy notices appear there, not in email.
3. Check both balances: gift card / wallet, and any promotional credit.
4. Search Your Orders across a 90-day range rather than the default 30, and check other marketplaces.
5. Screenshot the exact on-screen wording; button text is frequently the policy that applies to you.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Ask for the artefact, not the outcome. Every queue accepts a defined noun: an **ARN**, a **case number**, a **replacement order ID**, a **shipping-fee refund**, a **note added to the order**. Requests phrased as nouns get actioned by front-line agents; requests phrased as outcomes get escalated and wait.

If this happens	Do this first	Read
“Where is my order?”	Your Orders → Track package; escalate after the promise date + 48 h	03 / 04
“It says delivered”	Photo, wait 48 h, neighbours, then the WISMO flow	04
“I want to return it”	Return or replace → true reason → read the fee line	05
“Where is my refund?”	Release date, then the ARN to your bank	06
“Cancel it now”	Self-service while “Not yet shipped”, else refuse at the door	07
“It arrived broken”	Photos inside the return flow, then choose Replace if in stock	08

If this happens	Do this first	Read
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01

Privacy & Data

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01 Privacy & Data

SECTION 01

Amazon Help splits privacy material across four hubs — Privacy Notice, Your Account and Privacy Settings, Alexa Privacy, and Data Privacy Requests. Real contacts land in three buckets: what was collected, who else can see it, and how to get it removed. This section answers those, in order, plus the device cases (Echo, Kindle, Ring) that generate repeat contacts.

Q1 How do I see exactly what personal data Amazon holds about me?

Open amazon.com/privacy → **Your Privacy, Your Choices**. The dashboard groups stored data — browsing and search, voice and device, location, contacts, email and SMS, purchases, advertising — each with a **Manage** link that goes to the live setting, not a description. Two entries are easy to miss: third-party purchase history (the seller is a separate data controller) and ad data, which lives under **Interest-Based Ads**, not under browsing.

1. Sign in on the website — privacy requests cannot be filed from the mobile app.
2. Account & Lists → **Login & Security** → **Data rights** (or amazon.com/hub/privacy-request).
3. Choose **Request my personal data**, **Request deletion**, or **Object to processing**.
4. Select data classes and date range, then submit.
5. Confirm the verification email within 7 days or the request stays in **Submitted** state.

Q2 How long does a data copy or deletion request take?

A copy is answered within **30 calendar days**, extendable by 30-60 more for complex requests, with an explanatory email either way. Deletion is actioned within 30 days but expect **30-90 days** end to end, because records must also fall out of backup rotations. Some data cannot be deleted on request: invoices and order records for tax, payment records under anti-fraud rules, warranty and recall correspondence, and the contents of any dispute, open or closed.

POLICY NOTE

Deletion of transaction records is blocked for the retention period required by tax and platform-integrity rules. A successful request removes profile, preference, browsing and advertising data — it does not erase the fact that you bought something.

Q3 Can third-party sellers see my information?

Sellers get the minimum needed to complete the sale: name, delivery address, masked contact details where applicable, and the items ordered. Exceptions: gift orders share the recipient's address so the parcel can be delivered, and FBA orders route through the fulfilment network. Sellers are prohibited from using buyer data for anything but fulfilment and service — report abuse via **Report Abuse** on the seller's store page, which is monitored separately from customer service.

Q4 Do advertisers see my shipping address for campaign measurement?

No. Sponsored Products and Sponsored Brands reporting is aggregate attribution — impressions, clicks, order counts and sales — without names or addresses. If the same company also fulfilled your order, it holds your address for delivery reasons; that is a fulfilment flow, and turning off ads does not withdraw it.

Q5 How do I stop Amazon using my voice recordings for improvement?

The toggle is **Alexa Privacy → Help improve Alexa** (the transcriptions and text-to-speech review programme). Opting out stops new recordings being routed to human reviewers; it does not delete what was already processed. Short audio snippets are retained roughly 20-45 minutes after transcription processing, while transcripts and account-linked metadata persist far longer. Delete history item by item, or use **Delete all recordings**.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Deleting voice history in the Alexa app removes nothing recorded by an Echo Show camera or a Ring device — separate retention systems with their own delete controls.

Q6 How do I turn off targeted advertising?

Set **Interest-Based Ads** to off. That stops Amazon using on-site activity for ad profiles; ads still appear (contextual and measured), and networks that already collected data keep it. For cross-site opt-out use the DAA/EDAA ad-choice pages in every browser you use — opt-outs are browser- and device-specific, so a household tablet keeps its own profile. Signed-out browsing is still tied to cookies; use a private window for research you want detached.

Q7 What happens to my data if I close my account?

Closure is permanent. You lose cloud content, Prime Reading loans, digital warranties recorded against the account, gift card balances and unused promotional credit. Deletion is a two-step path people skip: **request data deletion** first, then close — closing alone only starts retention clocks. Download invoices, warranty receipts and return authorisations before you close; they become unreachable and are the only proof most manufacturers accept.

1. Download invoices: Your Orders → Invoice → save all PDFs locally.
2. Deregister every device (Content & Devices → remove from account).
3. Spend any gift card balance — balances are forfeited, not refunded.
4. Cancel subscriptions so they cannot bill an old card.
5. Submit **Close Account** under Login & Security and confirm by email.

WATCH OUT

There is no self-service “undo” once closure is confirmed by email. An agent may intervene inside a short window if you contact immediately — do not rely on it.

Q8 How do I deregister a device I am selling or giving away?

Order matters: deregister from the account before you factory reset, or a Kindle or Fire tablet can arrive at the new owner locked behind a parental or account screen. Do it from either end — on the device (Settings → Device Options → **Unregister**) or at amazon.com/hz/mycd/myx → **Deregister** — then reset locally to wipe profiles and caches.

Q9 Are Ring cameras part of the same account and privacy controls?

No. Ring keeps a separate account system, and the settings do not merge even if you link a login. The controls that matter: Motion Zones, **Privacy Zones** to black out a neighbour's window, recording schedule, and Shared Users with permission tiers. Video is encrypted in transit and at rest, with optional per-device end-to-end encryption; cloud retention defaults to 180 days and stops when a plan lapses. Ring cannot record through the doorbell's USB-C port — that port is power only, despite the widely repeated claim.

Q10 How do I remove third-party apps connected to my account?

Login & Security → Apps & Websites lists everything using Login with Amazon plus connected skills. **Remove** revokes future access only — data the app already stored is theirs to delete, and you must ask them. Also check **Share my delivery updates** and any Household or Teen permissions, which are separate systems that do not appear in that list.

Q11 Where do I find the privacy policy, cookies notice and legal documents?

In the footer of every page: **Conditions of Use**, **Privacy Notice**, **Your Ads Privacy Choices**; business accounts find the Data Processing Addendum under **Services Agreements** in Seller or Vendor Central. The version that binds you is the one in force when you accepted it, and there is no public archive of superseded notices — request the historical text in writing, which the privacy team handles, not the orders team, so it takes longer.

Q12 Does Amazon sell my personal data?

No, not in the sense most people mean: there is no customer list for sale to advertisers, and the Privacy Notice states that personal information is not sold, only shared with the parties needed to complete a transaction — sellers, carriers, payment networks, tax authorities, service providers under contract, and law enforcement on a valid request.

What does happen is behavioural targeting on Amazon's own ad inventory, and measurement reporting to advertisers, which some state privacy statutes classify as a “sale” or “sharing” for opt-out purposes. That is why the **Your Ads Privacy Choices** footer link exists and why the opt-out has a legal obligation behind it even where the word “sale” never appears.

If you want the formal version of the question — what disclosures were made and to whom — file a rights request for **categories of third parties**, which is a different field in the request form than a data copy, and is often forgotten.

Q13 Do other members of my Household see my browsing, orders or lists?

No. A Household shares benefits, not history: each adult keeps a private cart, private orders, private lists and private recommendations. A child profile's activity is visible to the paying adult, because that is the point of the consent model.

The leak paths are all on the same device or same browser rather than in the account structure: a shared browser keeps one session, Alexa history on a shared Echo belongs to the device and not the voice, and delivery notifications go to the address's contact email, which is usually the primary adult's. Use separate profiles in the browser and **Voice ID** on Echo to close the last one.

Q14 How does Amazon use my location data?

Location is collected from four places with four different purposes: the shipping address (fulfilment), GPS from the shopping app when you allow it (store availability, local delivery, tax jurisdiction), coarse IP geolocation (fraud screening and default address suggestions), and device Wi-Fi data on Echo and Ring (which network the device is on).

Tax is the one people do not expect: your shipping address, not your residence, determines sales tax and it can change your total. Digital content availability is decided the same way, which is why a VPN makes a catalogue look different rather than making you invisible.

Q15 Does Amazon read my messages to sellers?

Messages sent through **Contact seller** are stored on Amazon's systems and are readable in the sense that any support or claims reviewer can pull the thread — and they routinely do when adjudicating an A-to-z claim. Automated scanning for prohibited content (off-platform payment requests, personal data, threats) also runs over that channel.

What is not used for marketing is the content of those messages. But do not assume confidentiality: write to a seller as though a claims reviewer will read it aloud to you, because in a dispute that is exactly what happens.

Q16 Why does the product page remember what I looked at yesterday?

Browsing history is stored against your account and the browser cookie when signed out. The visible consequence is the **Recently viewed section** on Home and the item's own page, and the invisible consequence is recommendation ranking and Sponsored Products targeting.

You can pause the whole thing at **Your Store → Browsing history → Manage history**; removing single items only removes them from the shelf, not from the ad profile. For research you want gone permanently, browse in a private window before signing in.

Q17 How long do customer service calls and chats stay on record?

Contact records — the transcript, the case category, the outcome and any attachments — remain attached to the order for years, not weeks. That is deliberate: a claim filed in month eleven is adjudicated against the chat from month one.

Voice recordings of the call itself are typically retained for the duration of the service relationship plus a fixed compliance window, and are accessible to quality review teams. If a dispute turns on what was promised, ask for the **case notes** rather than the recording — the notes are the thing agents are actually bound by, and they can be pasted into a chat transcript you keep.

Q18 Are privacy requests handled by the same team that answers my order problem?

No, and this is the single most common reason a privacy question goes nowhere. Order support has tools for refunds and returns; it has none for data deletion, and its only real capability is to file a transfer request.

File rights requests through the privacy hub yourself (see the earlier entry) or by email to the privacy contact published in the Privacy Notice. Written channels get a legally-tracked response clock; a verbal request relayed through chat does not, which is why the paper route is faster even though it starts slower.

Q19 What happens to my Alexa history if I delete an Echo from the account?

Deregistration stops new data flowing, but it does not delete the old: transcripts, wake events, smart home logs and any recordings remain under **Alexa Privacy** until you delete them or the retention period expires. A new owner who sets the device up gets a clean device, not your history.

For a device you no longer own at all, the useful sequence is: delete all voice history, remove contacts and calendar skills, deregister, then physically reset. Skipping the first step is the one that leaks — not the reset.

POLICY NOTE

Retention clocks differ by data class, which is why a single “delete everything” request can be only partly satisfied. Profile and preference data is on the shortest clock, voice transcripts sit behind it, and transaction and tax records sit on a multi-year clock that no customer request can shorten.

Q20 Can Amazon refuse my deletion request outright?

It can decline the parts it is legally obliged to keep, and it can refuse an abusive or manifestly unfounded request (repeat requests for the same export within days, or requests designed to erase evidence mid-dispute). It cannot refuse the right itself, and it must tell you which exception it is relying on.

Where you think a refusal is wrong, the escalation is the privacy contact named in the notice, then your local data-protection authority. Note that a complaint to an authority does not pause your ability to shop, and Amazon's order teams will not know about it — these systems are deliberately separate.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

If you need proof of what you were told about your own data, ask for the response **in writing to the address on file**. Email replies from a privacy team carry a case reference; chat summaries do not, and are much weaker as evidence later.

Q21 Do I get notified if my account data is exposed in a breach?

Yes, for a breach affecting your account: notification arrives at the primary email, in **Your Messages**, and — for anything touching payment instruments — usually with an instruction to change the password, which the account enforces on next sign-in.

For a breach at a third-party seller or an app you authorised, Amazon generally will not notify you, because it is not the data controller. That is the gap to remember: the exposure you are least likely to hear about is the one at a company that got your address to ship you a kettle.

02

Account & Security

SECTION 02 · 22 entries

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03	How do I set up recovery codes, and what if I lost them?	11	How do Amazon Kids accounts work for security and privacy?
04	How do I remove a device or browser I no longer have?	12	Where do I check what devices and activity are tied to my account?
05	There is a charge on my account that I did not make. What is the correct order of actions?	13	Does Amazon support passkeys, and should I use one?
06	My account is locked or suspended. What does that actually mean?	14	What does “advanced security” change on a day-to-day basis?
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02 Account & Security

SECTION 02

Security contacts move fast because the correct first action is usually the counter-intuitive one: stop transacting, fix access, then unwind the money. This section covers sign-in recovery, the two forms of two-factor protection, hijack response, and the three account states — locked, deactivated, closed — which customers describe with the wrong word, changing which team can help.

Q1 I cannot sign in and my password is not working. What are my options?

Work the recovery ladder in order — each rung has its own cooldown, so repeated attempts at a lower rung can lock you out of a higher one for 24 hours. Use **Forgot your password?** rather than guessing. If the OTP never arrives, check the SMS spam folder and your carrier's short-code block list, then switch to **Call me**, which reads a code aloud and bypasses SMS filtering.

1. Password reset to the email actually on file, not just the one you typed.
2. OTP by SMS or voice call to the primary phone.
3. **Use a login code** — the recovery codes you saved when 2FA was set up.
4. Backup email or alternative phone, if registered.
5. Account verification support: **Help → Something else → I need help signing in**. Have a card on the account and a recent order number ready.

POLICY NOTE

After repeated failed verification, sign-in and self-service recovery are suspended for 24-72 hours. Support cannot shorten the wait, and identity proofing restarts from scratch afterwards.

Q2 What is the difference between two-step verification and Advanced Security?

Two-step verification is the standard second factor — password plus a code from an authenticator app, SMS or voice call — and it protects the sign-in event. **Advanced Security** is a separate free tier for US accounts that adds account protections instead of a login prompt: tamper-proof changes (a removal grace period before a deleted phone or password takes effect), protection against social-engineering changes, guaranteed phone contact before high-risk actions, and a \$100,000 reimbursement cap for unauthorised account use on eligible purchases. Neither replaces the other; if you enable only one, make it 2SV with an authenticator app (SIM-swap defeats SMS), then add Advanced Security behind it.

Q3 How do I set up recovery codes, and what if I lost them?

Login & Security → Advance security settings → Use login codes. Print or save the PDF: codes are single-use and the list rotates as you consume them, so last year's screenshot is partly spent. Lost the whole list? Disable 2SV entirely (which itself needs a valid second factor) or go through account verification. There is no email-only bypass, and that is deliberate.

Q4 How do I remove a device or browser I no longer have?

Amazon does not publish a per-device session list, so the practical route is: **change your password**, then enable or refresh 2SV. Most web and app sessions on other devices are invalidated within minutes, though a device mid-session may keep working until its token expires, usually under 24 hours. For a lost Fire tablet, Kindle or Echo, use **Content & Devices → remove from account** immediately.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Stolen phone? Ask your carrier to port-lock the number first. If the SIM moves to another handset, every SMS code follows it — your bank's included.

Q5 There is a charge on my account that I did not make. What is the correct order of actions?

Do not file a bank dispute yet — reversing a payment while Amazon is investigating freezes the order, blocks the return flow and flags the account, which is how a refundable problem becomes a multi-week escalation. Instead: confirm the merchant descriptor, pull the order number, then report it as unauthorised via **Login & Security → Report a problem with a charge** or the contact form. That routes to payment integrity, which can suspend the seller's payout and intercept the shipment. Then secure the account: password, 2SV, remove unknown cards and addresses, and check for a “secondary” card someone else added.

1. Screenshot the order confirmation and the bank entry with the 12-digit order ID visible.
2. Report the charge in-account — this creates the fraud case ID.
3. Change password, enable 2SV, sign out of other sessions.
4. Remove unknown cards, addresses and gift card recharges.
5. Ask support to intercept any shipment still in transit; address changes on a fraud-flagged order are auto-refused.
6. Escalate to a bank dispute only if Amazon's case is denied or stalls past 10 business days.

Q6 My account is locked or suspended. What does that actually mean?

Three distinct states, three different appeals. **Temporarily locked**: automatic, from unusual sign-in, chargeback risk or a failed verification; resolve by replying to the email requesting documents, usually same day. **Deactivated**: reviewed by a risk team for policy breaches (counterfeit claims, review abuse, account sharing, A-to-z abuse, repeated late returns) and you must appeal in writing with the evidence the notice names. **Closed**: permanent; only a documented error or a court order reopens it.

Q7 What documents actually get an appeal approved?

Name-matched, dated and unedited: government photo ID, a bank or card statement showing the holder name and the address on file, and proof of purchase from an authorised distributor for authenticity cases. The rejections are avoidable — cropped screenshots missing the header, statements with the address “redacted for privacy”, invoices from a retailer rather than a distributor, and a photo of a screen instead of a PDF.

WATCH OUT

Never appeal the same suspension repeatedly. Duplicate tickets reset the queue position of the open case and are logged as “excessive contact” against the account.

Q8 How do I change the email address on my account?

Login & Security → Email address → Edit, then verify the new address from its link before signing out. Check whether you sign in with an **alternate email** alias — changing the primary address does not change the sign-in identifier. The old address stops receiving order notifications immediately, so review spam rules on the new one. If the old mailbox is already shut, add the new address as a secondary, confirm both, then promote it.

Q9 Can I have two Amazon accounts, and can they be merged?

Amazon expects one primary consumer account per person and offers no self-service merge. Multiple accounts for business, another region (.com / .in / .co.uk) or a Household are fine. What gets flagged is splitting reviews, promotion abuse and returns across accounts — and two accounts still means one Prime trial, because the eligibility check uses payment and device fingerprints and silently denies the second.

Q10 Someone took over my account. What do I do in the first hour?

Treat it as an incident, in order: (1) password reset, (2) enable or rotate 2SV, (3) check saved payment methods and gift card balance, (4) check the address book — attackers almost always add a delivery address, (5) review orders from the last 48 hours including digital content, (6) report to the number on your bank's card. Then ask specifically for a **device and session audit** and an **account activity statement** listing sign-in IPs and times, and copy the result into your own notes — the fraud case will ask for it.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

A gift card recharged by an attacker is the hardest loss to recover: once the code is spent the value is gone and no chargeback covers it. Report an unfamiliar recharge within the same hour and ask for the redemption order ID.

Q11 How do Amazon Kids accounts work for security and privacy?

Kids profiles under a Household get their own sign-in with a child email alias, an approval workflow that routes purchase requests to the parent, and content limits in the Amazon Kids console. Nothing is collected from a child account for advertising. Under 13 requires parental consent under COPPA and the account cannot stand alone. At 13 a parent can convert the profile into a full account — at which point parental controls stop, so convert deliberately rather than automatically.

Q12 Where do I check what devices and activity are tied to my account?

Three places, showing different things: **Content & Devices** (registered hardware), **Your Orders** and **Your Payments** (transactions and gift card activity), and Alexa History (voice events and device wake-ups). Browsing is only visible under **Browsing History**, which you can pause. There is no “last 10 sign-ins” page in the consumer UI — which is why the named audit request above matters.

Q13 Does Amazon support passkeys, and should I use one?

Yes, passkeys are supported for consumer sign-in on current browsers and mobile platforms, and they replace both the password and the second factor with a single device-bound credential.

For most people this is the best security change available, because it defeats the two attacks that actually take accounts: phishing (a passkey will not sign you in on a lookalike domain) and credential stuffing (there is no password to leak). The trade-off is recovery: passkeys live in your platform account (iCloud Keychain, Google Password Manager), so losing that account becomes the new single point of failure — set the recovery codes as well.

Q14 What does “advanced security” change on a day-to-day basis?

Concretely: changes that could lock you out — removing a phone, changing a password, deleting a device — take effect only after a delay, and you get a call or SMS announcing them before they commit. That delay is the whole product; it is what makes a 30-second social-engineering attempt recoverable.

The practical downside is that you are also slowed down. If you plan to sell a phone or change numbers, make the account changes first and wait out the pending period before you let the device go, or you will be locked out on purpose with nobody to blame.

Q15 I keep getting verification codes I did not request. What is that?

Three causes, in decreasing order of seriousness. A **credential-stuffing wave**: attackers have a leaked password list and are testing it against your address — annoying, but blocked by 2SV. A **targeted attempt**: someone who knows your number is trying to trigger resets — which is when you should call your carrier about a port PIN. And simply a **typo**: someone else's number is one digit from yours.

Do not ignore a burst of codes. Change the password, confirm no unknown device is registered, and put a note on the account by asking support to flag it for verification on high-risk changes — that flag is real, and it makes an agent call you before any removal is processed.

Q16 Why is my email listed as already associated with an account when I try to add it?

Because the address is the identifier of another account — often one you created years ago, at a previous employer, or as a teen. Amazon does not merge or release addresses on request quickly, since address reassignment is a classic takeover route.

The clean path: start a password reset on the other account, get in, then either close it (after moving anything you need) or swap its email to a throwaway to free the address. Do it in that order; closing the wrong account is irreversible.

Q17 Can I stop one-click buying?

Yes — **Settings → Payment & Shipping → Seller-controlled payments settings** and the one-click toggle in the same panel; you can restrict one-click to physical goods only, or disable it entirely. For a shared household, this is the single highest-value setting, because one-click is the mechanism behind most “I did not buy this” disputes that are actually a partner or a child.

There is no per-device one-click control: it is an account setting, so disabling it affects every device signed in, including the tablet you use for grocery top-ups.

Q18 How do I give a family member access without sharing my password?

You do not — and any answer involving a shared password is the wrong answer, because shared credentials break the fraud model and every dispute that follows. Two supported routes: add them as an **adult in the Household** (their own login, shared benefits, separate orders), or use **Amazon Kids** profiles for children.

For an elderly relative or someone who needs help buying, the practical pattern is their account with you listed as a contact plus a gift card balance funding their cart, rather than your card on their account — it keeps refunds, warranties and dispute authority with the person who legally bought the item.

Q19 What is an account review, and how is it different from a lock?

A **review** is prospective: a specific order, payment method or profile change is held while risk checks run, and shopping usually continues. A **lock** is retroactive and account-wide, triggered by something already concluded about the account.

Reviews are usually resolved by supplying exactly what is asked — a card statement page showing the name, last four digits and billing address, not the whole PDF. Locks need the appeal bundle from the earlier entry. The tell: a review leaves your order visible with a status note, a lock hides orders and you know it by the login message.

Q20 My account was closed by mistake. Can it be reopened?

Only in the narrow case where the closure was an operational error — a duplicate account merged wrongly, a closure request submitted by an agent in error, or a policy flag applied to the wrong account. Each needs written evidence and the closure reference, and it is handled by the risk team, not by the phone queue.

Assume that digital purchases tied to the closed account are the hardest part to restore: licences are often re-issued only when the order record can be proved against a payment instrument. Keep the order emails; they are what a restoration is built on.

WATCH OUT

Never open a second account to work around a restriction on the first. It is the one action that reliably converts a recoverable review into a permanent closure, because the fingerprint link is detected immediately and logged as evasion.

Q21 How do I see which email or phone Amazon has on file if I am locked out?

The sign-in page masks them deliberately: **Forgot your password?** shows a partial address and the phone's last digits, and that is the only disclosure available before authentication. There is no “show my recovery contact” link, because that would itself be an attack surface.

Practical route when you have genuinely lost the mailbox: bring an account verification call with a card on file, the billing ZIP, and the order number from any email you still have. Agents can change a recovery contact after verification but cannot tell you the old one.

Q22 Does Amazon notify me of new device sign-ins?

Not as a standing notification, which surprises people coming from other providers. There is an email for some first-time device registrations and for changes to security settings, but no device list with last-seen timestamps in the consumer account.

What you can do: turn on 2SV so an unregistered device cannot complete sign-in at all; check **Content & Devices** monthly for hardware you no longer own; and if you want an auditable trail, ask support in chat for the **recent sign-in activity** and paste the reply into your own records.

03

Orders

SECTION 03 · 23 entries

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01	Where do I find my order number, and what else is on that page?	09	Amazon cancelled my order. Why, and do I get anything?
02	My card was charged but I cannot find the order. Where did it go?	10	How do I get an invoice, receipt or tax document?
03	Why was my order split into several shipments? Do I pay more?	11	I bought this as a gift. What does the recipient see, and can they return it?
04	How do I track a package, and what is a TBA number?	12	Can I deliver to a locker, counter or my workplace?
05	What does the promised delivery date mean, and when does it change?	13	Why does my order say “we’ll confirm the price with the seller”?
06	Can I change the delivery address after ordering?	14	My order disappeared from Your Orders entirely. What happened to it?
07	Can I change the item, quantity or payment method after ordering?	15	Can I pay with two cards plus a gift card on one order?
08	How do pre-orders work — when am I charged, and is the price locked?	16	Is it against the rules to cancel and re-order when the price drops?

03 Orders

SECTION 03

Nine out of ten order contacts are resolved by reading the order details page correctly rather than by changing anything. This section covers where to look, then the mechanics that surprise people: shipment splitting, promise dates, the point at which an order becomes immutable, and the states worth contacting support about instead of waiting.

Q1 Where do I find my order number, and what else is on that page?

Your Orders (amazon.com/gp/css/order-history) lists everything; the 12-digit ID in the form **112-3344556-7788990** is the only identifier support accepts. One order can hold four shipments in four different states. Under **Order actions** → **Order details** you get the seller of record, the ship-from location, the promised date, which instrument paid which portion, and under **Invoice** the tax breakdown — alongside Return or replace items, Write a review, Track package, Download invoice.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

The order confirmation proves what you agreed to pay; the shipping confirmation proves what was dispatched. Keep both whenever a seller disputes a price.

Q2 My card was charged but I cannot find the order. Where did it go?

Search by amount and date using the date-range filter, not the default 30 days. Check other marketplaces you may have used once — accounts are not unified across regions. Check whether the order came from a household member or a Kids profile needing approval. Finally check the non-order charges: Prime renewal, Audible, a Subscribe & Save cycle, an app or channel subscription, a pre-order that shipped early, or a one-click reorder. Each bills under its own descriptor.

Descriptor on your statement	Actual source	Where to confirm
AMZN*MKTP / AMZN.COM/BILL	Marketplace order, or the umbrella billing descriptor	Your Orders → date range
AMZN*DIGITAL / AMZN MKTP US	Digital content, apps, in-app purchases	Digital content library
AMZN*PRIME / AMAZON PRIME	Prime membership renewal	Memberships & Subscriptions
AMZN*MPDSUBS	Subscribe & Save cycle	Your Subscriptions
Seller name + AMZN*MP	Third-party seller billed through Amazon Pay	Your Orders → Sold by
AMZN*AUDIBLE	Audible membership or credit purchase	Audible → Account details
AMZN*AMZPAY	External merchant using Login & Pay with Amazon	amazon.com/amazonpay

Q3 Why was my order split into several shipments? Do I pay more?

Because items sit in different fulfilment centres, because one is sold by a third party, or because an oversize or hazmat item cannot travel in the same carton. Splitting never adds a charge on Prime or above-threshold orders — shipping is priced per order, not per shipment. Watch the estimates: each shipment carries its own promise date, and a seller can add a fee on a split that drops one carton below their free-shipping threshold, which is their policy, not Amazon's.

Q4 How do I track a package, and what is a TBA number?

Track package shows a per-shipment timeline — Ordered, Preparing for shipment, Shipped, In transit, Out for delivery, Delivered — and the scan events under each belong to the carrier, so they can lag 12-24 hours. A number beginning **TBA** (or TNT, USPSPKG) is an **Amazon Logistics** tracking ID handled by Delivery Service Partners and flex drivers; it will never appear on a UPS, FedEx or USPS site and can only be tracked on the Amazon page or app.

Q5 What does the promised delivery date mean, and when does it change?

The promise is per shipment and is recalculated until dispatch. Common causes of a moving date: the item re-sourced to another FC, weather or capacity surcharges, an address validation correction, or a seller changing the ship date. Two deadlines are measured differently: the **grace period** (the day after the latest promised date) is when the automated “where's my stuff” flow opens, while the **A-to-z deadline** is 3 days after the estimated delivery date for non-receipt, or 30 days after the maximum estimate, whichever comes first.

POLICY NOTE

Amazon refunds or replaces lost in-transit shipments without waiting for the promise date; the trigger is typically a tracking stall of 7+ days on domestic orders. Shipping fees are refunded on eligible lost Prime orders even when the item itself is not.

Q6 Can I change the delivery address after ordering?

Yes while the order reads **Not yet shipped**: Order actions → **Change or correct address**. The change can re-price shipping and shift the promise by a day or two. It is not possible once the status is **Shipped**. Then your options are carrier-side instructions (UPS My Choice or FedEx Delivery Manager — unavailable for TBA numbers), a hold at a nearby location, or returning it. Never ask a locker or apartment desk to forward a parcel: unattended re-forwarding is where most delivered-not-received losses happen.

Q7 Can I change the item, quantity or payment method after ordering?

Amazon does not let you edit line items at all. The only self-service paths are cancel the shipment and re-order, or contact the seller on a gift order. When the **Cancel** button disappears the order is already in the pick-and-pack queue and no agent can change it either. Payment method can be changed in the same window; two cards can fund one order (gift card plus card), but not three.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

The window where cancellation is self-service is often only 20-40 minutes on same-day and One-Day items. Cancel and re-place immediately — do not open a chat first.

Q8 How do pre-orders work — when am I charged, and is the price locked?

The card is authorised at pre-order and captured only when the item ships. For most physical goods you pay the **lowest price listed between pre-order and ship date** (the pre-order price guarantee); third-party marketplace pre-orders often do not carry it, and deal pricing can be excluded. Digital pre-orders capture closer to release and refunds after download are restricted. Release delays are common and do not move your charge date.

Q9 Amazon cancelled my order. Why, and do I get anything?

Frequent causes: oversold stock, a manifest pricing error by a seller (cancellation is permitted where the error is obvious and they notify promptly), payment authorisation failure, address validation failure, or an anti-fraud block on high-value resale-risk items. There is no automatic compensation. Ask for **goodwill** on an erroneous cancellation — a promotional credit is available on documented cases — and report repeated cancellations by the same seller, which is a seller-performance issue rather than a customer-service one. If you were refunded nothing after 3-5 business days, see Refunds.

Q10 How do I get an invoice, receipt or tax document?

Your Orders → Invoice → Download invoice and payment receipt. Amazon Business orders produce a proper tax invoice carrying your GST or VAT number; consumer receipts list tax charged but not your registration. For a marketplace order the seller is the issuer of record — request it via **Contact Seller**, then chase with an A-to-z claim after 48 hours, since missing documentation is a valid claim reason in several marketplaces.

Q11 I bought this as a gift. What does the recipient see, and can they return it?

Gift orders ship with no prices on the packing slip, and only gift notifications go to the recipient if you chose that. Digital gifts must be redeemed before they become the recipient's, and the sender cannot see redemption status. Returns use the gift flow: the order number with its **G123456** suffix plus the sender's email. The refund then goes to an **Amazon Gift Card for the sender**, never to a card — the most common source of “where is my refund” tickets after a gift return.

Q12 Can I deliver to a locker, counter or my workplace?

Choose an **Amazon Locker** or a staffed **Counter** at checkout, or add a workplace address. Locker capacity is checked at selection, not at delivery, so a chosen locker can fill and the carrier falls back to your primary address — which is why the confirmation email still shows it. Pick-up windows are typically 3 days for a locker, 7 for a counter, then the item returns to sender and auto-refunds. Workplace delivery is a Prime benefit in eligible metro ZIP codes and requires the parcel to meet the receiving location's rules.

Q13 Why does my order say “we'll confirm the price with the seller”?

A marketplace seller may still revise the price before accepting the order, typically on imported or out-of-stock items. Nothing is captured until they confirm, so you can cancel freely in this state. If the confirmed price is higher than listed, decline and report the listing — post-order price increases breach listing policy, and that is one of the few complaints that reaches the seller-performance team instead of customer service.

Q14 My order disappeared from Your Orders entirely. What happened to it?

An order that vanishes rather than showing cancelled is nearly always one of four things: it was placed on a different marketplace and you are looking at the wrong account; the date-range filter is set to the last 30 or 90 days; a seller's order was voided and archived with it; or an anti-fraud cancellation moved the order out of the active list.

Search by the amount and date across **All orders** and archive folders, then check the payment descriptor. If the money posted and no order is visible anywhere, that is a payment-integrity case, not an order case — say so when you open it, or the orders queue will bounce you.

Q15 Can I pay with two cards plus a gift card on one order?

Gift card or balance plus one card is the normal maximum for physical goods — the balance is applied automatically and the residual to a single instrument. Some marketplaces let you pick the primary card, but a second card in the same transaction is not offered.

Workaround when you must split: place two orders, one funded by each card, and combine shipments in your head. Watch the free-shipping threshold, because splitting can cost a shipping fee that a single order avoided — the fee logic is per order.

Q16 Is it against the rules to cancel and re-order when the price drops?

No. Nothing in the conditions of use prohibits it, and it is the standard response to a price change since price adjustments were withdrawn. The only thing that can make it awkward is volume: repeatedly buying and cancelling a resale-sensitive product is what triggers review, not the price arbitrage itself.

Do note what you lose: the original delivery slot may not be reproducible, one-use coupons may not re-apply, and a cancellation after dispatch becomes a return, which is slower and can cost a label.

Q17 What does “Deliver my packages when I'm home” actually do?

Where offered, it lets you pick a tight window and pays the driver a per-stop fee to wait for contact rather than leaving the parcel. Not all addresses qualify, and it is a per-order choice, not an account setting.

Availability is the complaint, not the mechanic: eligibility depends on the delivery station serving your address, so the same option can appear for one order and not the next. It is also the feature that disappears first during volume surges.

Q18 Why does one order show two different sellers?

Because the basket was assembled from multiple listings. Amazon shows a single order ID for the checkout, but each item has its own seller of record, its own return window and its own warranty responsibility. That is why one item can be returnable for 30 days while its neighbour is not returnable at all.

Read it in **Order details**: each line has Sold by. Any dispute must name the line, not the order — opening a claim against the wrong seller in a mixed order is a common and entirely avoidable reason for a denial.

Q19 How do I contact a seller after the order is old?

The **Contact seller** form is gated to orders inside the dispute window, so on an aged order the button may be gone. Then use the seller's public store page — search their brand name, and the **Questions, feedback, and ratings** block has a contact link that works without an order.

Keep it factual and quote the order number in the subject. Sellers answer warranty and invoice requests far faster than complaint requests, and their reply is admissible in a later A-to-z claim even if it came through the store-page form.

Q20 Is the order number in the confirmation email the same as the one I need?

Yes for the main ID, but the email also contains shipment numbers that are not order numbers and agents cannot look them up. The one to give is the 12-character triple **XXX-XXXXXXX-XXXXXXX**; gift orders add a **G1** suffix that only works in the gift return form.

If a form rejects your ID, you almost certainly have a shipment or a return authorisation number. Both look similar and neither is a substitute.

Q21 Can I add a delivery note for the driver after ordering?

Yes, on eligible shipments from the tracking page: gate codes, a safe place, a landmark, leave-with-neighbour. These are advice, not instructions — they are not guaranteed to reach the driver who already has your route, and they are unavailable for signature-required parcels.

Assume anything typed here is readable by whoever gets the delivery email. Do not put a door code in a note that goes to a shared household address.

Q22 What happens when a seller ships the wrong thing and then goes quiet?

This is the case the A-to-z Guarantee exists for, and you need the sequence in order: message the seller through the order (creating a timestamped record), wait 48 hours, then claim on **item not as described**, attaching photos of the item beside the packing slip. Claiming without that first contact is denied procedurally, not on the merits — which is why so many of these fail.

If the seller has left the platform, coverage still applies for orders inside the guarantee window; outside it, your remaining route is a card dispute, and you should quote the claim attempt date.

Order status	What it means in practice	Your options right now
Ordered	Payment authorised, not captured; stock reserved	Edit payment or address; cancel freely
Preparing for shipment	Picking has begun at the FC	Cancel may still work; no address change on some items
Shipping	Box sealed, label created, not scanned	Cancellation stops working; refuse later
Shipped	In the carrier's hands	Track only; do not report missing yet
In transit	Moving between facilities	Redelivery or hold requests via the carrier
Out for delivery	On the last-mile vehicle	Window is today; instructions last useful moment
Delivered	Scanned complete — not necessarily in your hands	48-hour rule, then WISMO
Returned / Refused	Coming back to sender	Refund releases on the return scan
Cancelled: customer	You cancelled	No restore; re-order
Cancelled: Amazon	Payment, address, fraud or stock failure	Ask for a purchase review

Q23 Why does my delivery estimate change twice a day?

Because it is recomputed against live capacity at the delivery station, not against the package. As the vehicle manifest fills, the promise slides; a re-source to another FC can pull it forward.

Only the final promise matters for your rights: the grace period for a lost-package claim is measured from the latest date shown, so screenshot the promise you were relying on if you plan to claim.

04

Delivery & Shipping

SECTION 04 · 21 entries

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03	Who actually delivers the parcel?	11	I moved house. What must I update beyond the address book?
04	Do you deliver to PO boxes, APO/FPO/DPO and rural addresses?	12	Will a driver leave a package without knocking?
05	It says “Delivered” but nothing arrived. What exactly should I do?	13	Why does the map show my package in another state after delivery?
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04 Delivery & Shipping

SECTION 04

Delivery questions split into eligibility (“can it come here, and when”), execution (“it says delivered, it is not here”) and exceptions (hazmat, international, rural). The second group is most of the volume and has a strict, time-boxed sequence; the others are mostly about knowing which rules are Amazon's and which belong to a seller or a carrier.

Q1 What are the free-shipping options and their conditions?

Non-Prime orders get free standard shipping above the site's current threshold on eligible items; Prime members get One-Day or two-day on eligible items with no minimum. Marketplace sellers set their own rates under the Buy box. Beyond that: Local Delivery in selected metros, release-day delivery on pre-orders, Amazon Global for international with duties pre-paid on eligible ASINs, and scheduled grocery windows.

Service	Typical speed	Cost	Notes
Prime One-Day	Next calendar day, by the cut-off	Included	Cut-offs vary by ZIP; not every ASIN
Prime two-day	2 business days	Included	Default for eligible items
Standard (non-Prime)	3-8 business days	Free above threshold	Seller-fulfilled can be slower
Same-day	Within a day, metro only	\$9.99, often free above a basket	Eligible metro ZIP codes
Scheduled delivery	Chosen window	\$7.99 varies	Grocery baskets
Amazon Global (export)	5-22 business days	Varies	Duties sometimes pre-paid; else buyer pays
Freight / room of choice	5-14 days, booked call	Varies	Oversize; needs an inside-delivery date

Q2 What does “Ships from and sold by Amazon.com” change in a dispute?

Everything. When Amazon is both seller and shipper you get Amazon's return policy, refund speed and support authority. When a third party sells the item — even if it ships from an Amazon FC — the seller is the merchant of record, their window governs the return, and Amazon's role is the A-to-z backstop. Read the byline under the Buy box: Ships from plus Sold by. FBA means fast delivery but seller-controlled returns; FBM means the seller controls both.

Q3 Who actually delivers the parcel?

Amazon Logistics (contracted Delivery Service Partners and flex drivers), UPS, USPS for last-mile handoffs, FedEx, and regional carriers in dense metros. The tracking page names the real carrier, which is not always what the label suggests. This matters on escalation: a TBA number can only be investigated by Amazon, while a UPS or FedEx number gives you a carrier claim reference and a second path to a loss claim.

Q4 Do you deliver to PO boxes, APO/FPO/DPO and rural addresses?

PO Box via USPS final mile, but not signature-required or oversize items. APO/FPO/DPO at roughly 10-20 business days with no expedited service, and some sellers block them outright. Rural addresses are served on the carrier's every-other-day or Saturday schedule, often to the mailbox rather than the door. Where an address is genuinely undeliverable, checkout withholds the fast options rather than offering them and failing.

Q5 It says “Delivered” but nothing arrived. What exactly should I do?

Run this in order; agents are instructed to ask these questions first, so doing them yourself turns a 20-minute chat into a 2-minute one. Most delivered-not-received cases resolve at step 2 or 3, because carriers scan early and drivers leave parcels with a neighbour or behind a planter.

1. Read the delivery photo and the map drop shown for TBA deliveries.
2. Wait 36-48 hours — “delivered” while still in transit is a common scan error and self-heals.
3. Search the property, ask household members, the front desk and immediate neighbours.
4. Check whether a second shipment is still coming; “delivered” may refer to another carton.
5. Then: Your Orders → problem with order → the delivered-but-empty option, or the ‘where is my stuff?’ flow.
6. Ask for a carrier investigation; for Amazon Logistics this is a DSP search on the driver's route.
7. Still missing past 48 hours, expect a replacement or refund. Do not file a police report first — it closes as ‘insufficient evidence’.

POLICY NOTE

Amazon's stated rule: do not report a package missing before 48 hours have passed after the delivery scan. Cases opened earlier are closed as “still in transit”, and the closure can appear in the account's claim history.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

For high-value items ask for **Signature on Delivery** where offered, and photograph the parcel and its seal before opening. Loss claims and returnless refunds both hinge on that photo.

Q6 My parcel is held for a signature, or the driver could not deliver.

Signature confirmation is required for age-restricted, high-value or declared-value items. If nobody is available, leave instructions on the tracking page, request a hold at an access point, or route to a locker; Amazon Logistics cannot drop a signature-only parcel, which is why drivers attempt three times. After the final failed attempt the parcel returns to sender and the order auto-refunds once the return is scanned, often 7-14 days later. Ask for redelivery before attempt three instead of waiting.

Q7 Why can't you ship this to me, or why is shipping so expensive?

Hazmat classification (lithium batteries above a threshold, aerosols, flammable liquids, some magnets) removes air options and therefore one-day service; the seller may not offer your region; import restrictions apply; oversize items price by freight; and quantity limits exist on resale-risk ASINs. If an item ships fine for everyone else, that is usually a shipping-template error on the seller's side — say so in the message and they can fix it within a day, which is faster than buying elsewhere.

Q8 Can I change delivery details or add driver instructions?

Yes for eligible shipments, from the tracking page: gate codes, a safe place, a date nudge. These reach the driver's route notes but are not guaranteed, and are unavailable on signature-required parcels. One caution: instructions are repeated in the delivery confirmation email, so a shared household mailbox can leak them.

Q9 Do you ship internationally, and who pays customs?

Where eligible, **Amazon Global** shows an import-fees deposit at checkout. Pay it and the carrier clears the parcel, a shortfall is refunded and an excess is not recovered from you (customs-deposit protection). Skip it and the local broker bills you on arrival, usually with a handling fee, and refusing to pay means the parcel returns at your cost. Cross-marketplace caution: buying on .com and shipping abroad means you pay international return shipping yourself, and warranties are often region-locked.

Q10 Weather or a carrier disruption is delaying my parcel. What do I do?

Check the banner on the tracking page first — network disruptions are flagged there and promise dates extend automatically, with the grace period then measured from the revised date. Shipping-fee refunds are still issued during a flagged disruption. Ask for a **shipping fee refund** rather than “compensation”: the first is a standard action any agent can take, the second needs a supervisor.

Q11 I moved house. What must I update beyond the address book?

The address book does not propagate to four places: each **Subscribe & Save** subscription's address, device content defaults, grocery and Prime Now serviceability, and gift card auto-reload. Invoices and tax documents keep the old address permanently, which is what your records need. If you moved mid-order the change usually applies; once the parcel is on a truck use carrier reroute instead, and delete the old address so it cannot be one-clicked at checkout.

Q12 Will a driver leave a package without knocking?

Yes, for anything not marked signature-required — the standing behaviour is “leave at a safe place, photograph it, move on,” and a knock is not guaranteed even for an apartment. Amazon Logistics in particular is optimised for stops per hour, not for contact.

If you need contact, the only reliable lever is a service that provides it: a Locker, a Counter, a signature option where offered, or **Deliver when I'm home** where available. Notes asking the driver to knock are not enforceable.

Q13 Why does the map show my package in another state after delivery?

Because the GPS ping attached to a delivery scan is the driver's device location at the moment of scanning, and drivers frequently pre-scan an entire block. An out-of-state dot on a delivered order usually means a stale scan, not a stolen parcel.

Judge delivery by the photo and the door, not the map dot — but keep the discrepancy if you are claiming non-receipt: a wrong-location ping is the strongest single piece of evidence in a WISMO review.

Q14 Can I schedule a delivery time window?

Only where a scheduled service exists — grocery and some oversize bookings let you choose a window, and freight requires an inside-delivery appointment. Standard parcels have no time selection; the day is the only commitment.

For an irreplaceable item, the workaround is a Locker or Counter for a day, so nobody needs to be home at an unpredictable hour.

Q15 It says “Arriving tomorrow” at 10pm. Is that real?

Yes, and it is usually honest: the estimate reflects the package being on a route the following day, even though the last scan happened hours earlier. Late-night estimate changes are typically re-planning, not a problem.

The exception is a change to a later date overnight, which usually means the parcel missed the cutoff at a hub. If the new date is past your original promise, you have a shipping-fee refund case for paid shipping, and a delivery-date claim for a Prime item that simply did not arrive.

Q16 Can I ask the driver to leave it with a neighbour?

As a note, yes; as an instruction, no. A named neighbour in the instructions is honoured only if the driver can reach them, and liability for what happens after hand-off is murky — the delivery is scanned complete at the address, so a neighbour's missing item is a harder claim than your own.

For high-value goods, use a Locker, a workplace, or signature instead of a neighbour arrangement, and photograph the neighbour's door if you must rely on one.

Q17 A parcel was delivered and then stolen from my porch. Does any protection apply?

This is the boundary case, and the honest answer is: usually not from the retailer. Once a parcel is scanned delivered to the correct address, the carrier's and the seller's obligations end; theft after that point is a police matter and a homeowner's or renter's insurance claim.

Two real exceptions. First, if the parcel was left somewhere the notes said not to (behind a bin room you asked to avoid, a neighbour you did not nominate), that is a carrier mis-delivery and it is claimable. Second, some card benefits and standalone parcel insurance cover porch theft — check your card's purchase

protection terms rather than assuming the platform covers it.

Q18 Can the carrier hold my package at a local depot?

Yes, for UPS, FedEx and USPS where you have an account with that carrier: a hold request or a reroute to an access point is the fastest fix after a missed delivery, and it beats waiting for a return to sender. The listing carrier is shown on the tracking page.

Amazon Logistics parcels cannot be held this way — there is no customer-facing portal for the Delivery Service Partner — so for those the only levers are the tracking-page instructions and asking support to message the driver's dispatcher.

Q19 Do deliveries happen on weekends or holidays?

Saturdays are routine where USPS or Amazon Logistics covers the route; Sundays are increasingly common for Prime in dense metros. Public holidays shift the promise rather than suspending service, and the site-wide banner usually says so.

The practical trap is a long weekend during a sale: capacity, not weather, is what causes the multi-day slips, and those promises extend without notice because the disruption is network-wide.

POLICY NOTE

Delivery attempts: signature-required and high-value shipments get up to three attempts over consecutive business days. A single missed attempt is not a lost parcel, and reporting it as one before the final attempt produces a closed case on your record.

Q20 Why is shipping so much more expensive than it was at checkout?

Usually a rate-box or dimensional-weight change: the item was re-sourced to a facility further away, or the seller's shipping template was updated after your session started. Less often it is a fuel or oversize surcharge applied at the FC.

You are not bound by a change before capture: cancel and re-order at the price you saw, or ask the seller to honour it. Where the increase is a surcharge on an already-captured order, it is contestable if the listing did not disclose it — screenshot the listing's delivery block when you order high-value furniture and appliances for exactly this reason.

Q21 Does a Locker really guarantee my parcel is safe?

For theft, effectively yes: the parcel is inside a locked compartment until the code you control opens it, and “delivered to locker” shifts responsibility cleanly to the platform until pick-up.

What it does not fix: capacity (the locker chosen at checkout can fill before delivery, so the parcel falls back to your porch — check the confirmation), oversized parcels that will not fit the available compartment, and the short retrieval window, after which the item is returned and only refunded on the return scan.

05

Returns

SECTION 05 · 21 entries

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02	What is the return window, really?	10	What happens to my item at the returns facility?
03	Which items are not returnable, and what are the exceptions?	11	Can someone else drop off my return, and how do gift returns work?
04	Do I need the original box and accessories?	12	What is a “return rate” and can it get my returns restricted?
05	How long from drop-off until I see money?	13	Can I return an opened subscription-box item?
06	My refund was less than what I paid. What was deducted?	14	The return label never arrived or will not print. What now?
07	It is more than 30 days. Can I still return it?	15	Can I drop a return off at a physical store without a box?
08	The seller won't answer. What now?	16	If the price of an item I returned was higher than what I paid, do I get the difference?

05 Returns

SECTION 05

The default expectation — 30 days, free, no questions — is true for items sold and shipped by Amazon in good condition. Almost everything else is conditional, and the conditions are printed on the return page at the moment you start the return, which is the only moment they matter.

Q1 How do I start a return?

Your Orders → Return or replace items → select the item → choose a reason → choose a resolution (refund, replacement, or repair where offered) → choose how to send it back. The reason you pick decides whether you pay return shipping, so read the fee line on the confirmation screen before submitting — prose in the comment box does not override the dropdown. If the button is missing, the window has closed or the category is restricted, and the route is the contact-us form, not another button.

Return method	Who acts	Cost to you	Best for
Prepaid label → UPS/USPS drop	You, at a counter	Free on fault reasons	Anything boxable
UPS Store / Kohl's	You	Free	No home printer
Whole Foods or Amazon Store counter	You, in store	Free	Clothing, small electronics
Home pickup	Carrier at your door	Sometimes a fee on no-fault returns	Oversize, carless households
Pallet / freight pickup	Two-person crew, booked	Usually free on defects	Furniture, appliances
Returnless refund	Nothing — keep or dispose	n/a	Items worth less than freight
Counter drop with QR code	You, at a partner store	Free	Nothing to print

Q2 What is the return window, really?

For items sold and fulfilled by Amazon in the US the base window is **30 days from delivery**. On top of it sit overlays: a **holiday extension** under which items delivered through the October-December peak are commonly returnable to 31 January, applied per order rather than announced per customer; an **electronics** split of 30 days no-fault but commonly up to 12 months for defects through warranty or A-to-z rather than the returns engine; and **fashion** rules requiring unworn items with tags and generally free return shipping. Third-party sellers must meet a marketplace minimum and may state longer — the number that binds them is on their listing, not Amazon's 30 days.

POLICY NOTE

The window shown on **your** order's return page overrides everything on the listing or in Help. If the page offers you a button, the agent has to honour it — cite that screen by name.

Q3 Which items are not returnable, and what are the exceptions?

Typical exclusions: opened software and video games, digital content once downloaded, groceries and perishables, live plants, hazmat that cannot be shipped back, personalised items, prepaid gift cards, and anything marked non-returnable on the listing; pharmacy and medical categories carry legal restrictions. Exceptions survive even without a button: a **dangerous or defective** product, a **wrong item**, or a **counterfeit** claim. Those run warranty or A-to-z routes where a photo of the item and the packing slip is often enough for a refund with no label at all.

Q4 Do I need the original box and accessories?

For an Amazon-shipped return, not the carton — any box that protects the item works. Keep accessories, manuals and the slip, because missing pieces are the main cause of a refund being reduced for “incomplete” grading at the sortation centre. A seller may deduct for absent original packaging if their listing said so; if you never received a retail box because it arrived inside a plain Amazon carton, write that in the return comment before shipping, which removes the argument later.

Q5 How long from drop-off until I see money?

Two clocks. **Release:** Amazon normally issues the refund within about 24 hours of the first carrier scan on the return leg — not arrival at the FC — for standard categories. **Posting:** then the payment method's own timeline, per Appendix A. Practically: drop off, refund released same or next day, gift card instantly, card 3-5 business days. If nothing appears 7 days after drop-off with a valid return scan, the problem is with the carrier, not with you — which is why you kept the receipt.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Get a stamped or e-receipt at drop-off showing the return authorisation number. That document converts “we’ll check with the FC” into an immediate refund, and it is the only proof that exists when a carrier loses a return in transit.

Q6 My refund was less than what I paid. What was deducted?

Legitimate: return shipping charged because the reason was “no longer needed”; restocking fees on opened large electronics, laptops, cameras and instruments; recovery of free shipping when a partial return breaks the basket threshold; a prepaid-pickup fee; and open-box grading at the FC. Not legitimate: a deduction for shipping on a delivery that never happened, a restocking fee on a defective item, or a fee for a label you printed and never used. Contest those on the resolution centre page rather than by phone, quoting the item condition stated on the listing.

Q7 It is more than 30 days. Can I still return it?

Sometimes, depending on which lever you pull: a **defect** routes to warranty or extended protection, which ignores the returns window entirely; a **goodwill exception** is likelier for a one-time customer with photos of a real failure; an **A-to-z claim** works against a seller for non-conforming merchandise inside the claim deadline; a chargeback is the last resort with the consequences noted in Appendix A. Say the sentence that matters: “this is a defect, not a change of mind — which warranty path applies?” Late change-of-mind requests are refused by script.

Q8 The seller won't answer. What now?

Message via **Your Orders → Contact Seller** with the topic “Return or refund request”; sellers are expected to respond within 24 hours and their response clock is enforced on them. After 48 hours without a resolution, file an **A-to-z Guarantee claim: Your Orders → problem with order → I did not receive the item or it's not as described**. You must show the seller was contacted first.

Q9 What is the A-to-z Guarantee and what does it cover?

Third-party orders, for two scenarios: item not received, and item not as described, defective or inauthentic. Amazon can refund the full price plus original shipping and separately rate the seller's account. Limits worth knowing: a maximum claim value (\$2,500 per order in the US), a filing deadline roughly within 90 days of the order (much shorter for non-receipt), and — the one that surprises people — if you have already filed a bank chargeback on the order, the claim is closed, because the dispute has left Amazon's hands.

Q10 What happens to my item at the returns facility?

Returned units are graded **sellable**, **used-like-new**, **used-acceptable**, **unsellable**, or sent to liquidation or disposal. Grading normally does not touch your refund on Amazon-shipped orders — it decides whether the item becomes a Warehouse deal or a disposal line — but on marketplace orders the seller can claim a reduction. Where a facility decides the item came back incomplete or damaged by you, the refund is reduced or the item is shipped back to you. Appeal with photographs: grading reversals are common when evidence exists.

Q11 Can someone else drop off my return, and how do gift returns work?

Yes — the prepaid label carries the return authorisation number, not your identity, so any adult can hand it to UPS, USPS, Kohl's or a Whole Foods counter, and pickups only need someone to hand over the parcel. Never ship on your own carrier account where a “return to seller” was required: the seller need not refund an unauthorised return. Gift returns use the link in the gift notification, or the gift order number plus the sender's email, and the refund is issued as an Amazon Gift Card to the sender — so the sender learns a return happened, which is worth knowing before you send one back.

Q12 What is a “return rate” and can it get my returns restricted?

Yes in categories where the platform measures them. Returns are assessed on volume relative to spend and on whether refunds are being claimed without cause; a pattern of returning items late in the window, refusing parcels, or claiming defects without evidence produces either a warning, a charge for return shipping, or in the extreme a restriction on returning at all.

Occasional returns have no effect. What registers is the shape of the pattern — the serial returner of one item from every three orders, the same size-then-return cycle on fashion, the refund without a return on every order above a threshold.

Q13 Can I return an opened subscription-box item?

Subscription boxes are their own category, and the terms printed on the box page govern: opened beauty or snack boxes are commonly non-returnable once opened even where individual items inside would be, because the curation is the product.

Defective or unsafe contents are a different question and are claimable item by item — photograph the seal, the lot code and the item, and cite the specific product's own return policy rather than the box's.

Q14 The return label never arrived or will not print. What now?

This is a service failure, not yours, and it changes what you owe: with no usable label there is no valid return obligation, and any later charge for an unreturned item is contestable on that ground. Options before you panic: **QR-code counter return** at a partner store, print-to-store at many UPS and Whole Foods locations, or ask support to re-issue a label and note the original request date in the case.

Do keep the evidence: a screenshot of the failed print page with its timestamp. That single image converts a “you never sent it back” refusal into a refund.

Q15 Can I drop a return off at a physical store without a box?

Frequently yes — Whole Foods and Amazon Fresh counters, and many Kohl's and UPS locations, accept loose items for most categories with no box and no label printing, on presentation of the QR code from the app.

Two caveats. Fragile or high-value items without packaging can be graded as damaged in transit, which is your loss, not the store's; and the store hands your item over without inspecting it, so photograph it before you hand it across.

Q16 If the price of an item I returned was higher than what I paid, do I get the difference?

No. Refunds are of the amount actually paid, split across the instruments used, not of the current listing price. The corollary is that a return is the wrong response to a price rise: if you were promoted a price-match and the price has since climbed, the refund you receive will feel like a loss.

Where a return is motivated by price alone, check the arithmetic before you send: with return shipping charged on a no-fault reason and a lower price now live, re-ordering after the refund is often a wash.

Q17 My cart said an item was returnable and now the order page says otherwise. Which wins?

The order page wins in practice, because that is the engine the agent sees — but you have a real argument when the listing affirmatively promised free returns and the order page contradicts it, because the listing is the description of the offer.

To use that argument you need the listing. Screenshot it at purchase for anything above trivial value: the returns block in the seller's conditions, the delivery promise, and the price. Listings change silently, and a claim that depends on “it said free returns” without a capture is usually declined for want of evidence.

Q18 The carrier lost my return in transit. Am I liable?

No, provided you used the prepaid label Amazon issued and can prove drop-off. The return is the platform's contract with the carrier; your obligation ended at hand-off. The proof of hand-off is the stamped or e-receipt — which is why it is the most valuable document in the whole process.

If you shipped on your own account instead, the position flips: the seller may refuse an unauthorised return and you are left with a claim against your own carrier. Use the label.

Q19 Do return shipping charges ever get waived retroactively?

Yes, routinely, when the reason was a fault — defective, wrong item, damaged in transit, not as described — and the deduction was applied because the dropdown reason did not match the facts. The correction is a shipping-fee refund and any agent can issue it.

It is not waived for a no-fault return just because you forgot to include a box, or because you chose a pickup instead of a free drop-off; those are your choices under stated terms, and arguing them generally wastes the contact you could have spent on something recoverable.

Q20 Can I return a personalised or made-to-order item?

Only on fault. Personalisation defeats resale, so change-of-mind returns are excluded as a matter of policy; but a personalised item that arrived wrong — misspelt, wrong colour, wrong size, not what you submitted — is a non-conforming order and is refundable, usually without requiring you to post the worthless unit back.

Evidence is everything here: keep the personalisation text you submitted (the confirmation page, not just the chat) and photograph the delivered item beside it. That pair is the whole case.

Q21 How do returns work for large items like furniture and appliances?

They are booked, not dropped: freight pickup requires two people and a date, and the item must usually be repackaged or blanket-wrapped or the crew will refuse it. Where the return is due to delivery damage, note it at the door on the driver's device — that notation is the difference between a clean claim and an argument.

Expect a pickup fee on a no-fault return of an opened oversize item; expect none on defects. If a restocking charge appears on a defective mattress or wardrobe, contest it in writing with the damage photos attached, since oversize grading disputes are commonly settled in the customer's favour when the evidence is contemporaneous.

WATCH OUT

Do not send an unauthorised return to a third-party seller's address that you found online. It is not a return, it is an unsolicited parcel, and the seller is entitled to refuse the refund.

06

Refunds

SECTION 06 · 19 entries

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01	What does “refund issued” mean, and when will the money appear?	09	The refund was partial. Can I contest it?
02	My refund shows “pending” at the bank. Whose problem is that?	10	Which refund method is fastest, and when should I deliberately choose it?
03	What can be deducted from a refund, and what cannot?	11	Do I pay return shipping if the item was defective?
04	Why was I refunded to my gift card balance instead of my card?	12	The refund arrived before the return scan. Is that a mistake in my favour?
05	It has been a week and there is no refund. Walk me through the escalation.	13	Can a refund ever exceed what I paid?
06	A charge is still on my card after cancellation. Do I chase a refund?	14	Do I get sales tax back on a refund?
07	Can I get a refund for a price drop?	15	My refund was sent as an Amazon credit. Can it be changed to cash?
08	How do I get a refund on digital content?	16	Why was my chargeback reversed a week later?

06 Refunds

SECTION 06

Refund tickets are mostly a vocabulary problem. “Refund issued” means the instruction was sent; “pending” is often a hold that will simply vanish; and “the money is not in my account” is usually a card-network and statement-cycle issue. This section gives the definitions, the deduction rules, and the escalation route when a refund is genuinely stuck.

Q1 What does “refund issued” mean, and when will the money appear?

Issued means Amazon has sent the credit to the method that paid. Nothing is pending on their side; the remaining delay belongs to your bank or network. Refunds cannot be redirected to a different card, another bank account or PayPal, and on a split-payment order each portion returns to the instrument that paid it — which is why a refund can look partly missing when only half has posted. If the original card is closed, the credit usually reaches the replacement card via the network's account updater, or lands as an **Amazon balance** credit when the issuer rejects it.

Q2 My refund shows “pending” at the bank. Whose problem is that?

Almost always the bank's: a credit held pending is the issuer waiting for the statement cycle. The mirror image is a pending debit that is not a charge at all but an authorisation hold — typical on pre-authorisations and some marketplace orders — which drops off in 3-14 days because no capture was ever requested. The reliable way to tell them apart is the **ARN**, the Acquirer Reference Number on the refund confirmation: hand it to your bank and ask for a credit trace, which takes minutes, whereas “Amazon says they refunded” is not a searchable reference for them.

POLICY NOTE

Refund timing is measured in business days from the release date, not the return date. A refund released on the 28th may legitimately appear on the next statement while already showing in your online balance.

Q3 What can be deducted from a refund, and what cannot?

Deductible: return shipping on change-of-mind reasons, restocking fees on opened large electronics, computers, cameras and some instruments, recovery of a free-shipping threshold when a partial return breaks it, and prepaid pickup fees on non-defect returns. Not deductible: shipping you paid for a delivery that never happened, a restocking fee on a defective or mis-described item, or a fee for a label you never used. Also expect **promotional credit to be forfeited** rather than repaid when an order it discounted is refunded — common, and legitimate.

Q4 Why was I refunded to my gift card balance instead of my card?

Three causes: it was a gift order (policy is gift card to the sender), the original card rejected the credit, or you were defaulted into balance at the resolution step. Where an instant gift card credit is offered, note the recurring promotion structure — some regions and campaigns add a bonus (around 10%, capped at about \$20 in recent US promos) for choosing a gift card refund on eligible items. The offer appears only on that screen; you cannot claim it afterwards, so read it before you tap continue.

Q5 It has been a week and there is no refund. Walk me through the escalation.

The ladder matters because each level produces a different artefact: level 1 gets the release date and ARN, level 2 gets a payment-integrity review, level 3 gets a trace and supervisor authority, level 4 is your bank. A chargeback on an order Amazon already refunded will be re-presented by the issuer and can restrict the account, so it genuinely belongs last.

1. Re-read Your Orders → Refund status; note the exact release date and any partial amount.

2. Check **Your Payments → Gift card balance** — refunds to a closed card land there.
3. Download the refund confirmation email as your written proof of method and amount.
4. Ask support for the **ARN** and the last four digits of the destination card.
5. Give the ARN to your bank and keep their trace reference.
6. If it went to a card you no longer hold, ask for a **reissue to an alternate instrument or a balance credit** — both are supported.
7. Past 10 business days from release: escalate to **Financial Investigations** and request the case number in writing.
8. Only then consider a dispute, and state in it that a refund was issued, quoting the ARN.

Q6 **A charge is still on my card after cancellation. Do I chase a refund?**

No. Cancelling before shipment usually means no capture ever happened, so there is nothing to refund — only an authorisation hold to lapse. Holds release on the issuer's schedule: 3-5 business days for most debit and prepaid cards, up to a full 30-day cycle for some prepaid and international cards. Amazon cannot accelerate it and has no ARN to give you, so “release it now” is a dead end. Ask instead for written confirmation that **no capture occurred**; that is the sentence bank dispute desks accept.

Q7 **Can I get a refund for a price drop?**

There is no general price-adjustment or price-match policy, and the old informal seven-day practice was withdrawn; agents are instructed to decline. What does work: the **pre-order price guarantee** (lowest price between pre-order and release), a documented deal or promo-code error, and a seller's own stated price match — rare on the marketplace.

Q8 **How do I get a refund on digital content?**

Short, separate windows: an e-book generally within **7 days** and before heavy reading; a video rental before you watch it; apps and in-app purchases through the digital content channel, where a one-time courtesy refund within 24-48 hours is typical. Once content is downloaded or streamed the 30-day return policy does not apply. This is a different team — use **Help → Digital Content and Devices** or ask to be transferred. Disputed child purchases have their own Amazon Kids flow and will require an account-level acknowledgement.

Q9 **The refund was partial. Can I contest it?**

Yes, and the venue is the resolution centre, because partial refunds are adjudicated case by case against the seller's evidence: **problem with order → request the remainder**, or reply to the claim email with photos, the packing slip and your exact arithmetic. Deductions that stick: item returned incomplete, damage attributed to you, or a return the seller never authorised. Deductions that get reversed: a fee applied when the reason was a defect, shipping charged that was never incurred, and double-charging both a restocking fee and shipping.

Q10 **Which refund method is fastest, and when should I deliberately choose it?**

In practice: gift card or balance is instant to a few hours; wallet and UPI refunds usually within 24 hours; US debit and prepaid 3-5 business days; credit cards 5-10 depending on the issuer's cycle; international cards and bank transfers slowest. Choose the instant path if you keep buying, if it was a gift, or if your card is expired and you want to skip the reissue loop. Choose the original method if you need the credit on that specific card for expense or warranty records — gift card credit cannot be converted back afterwards.

Q11 **Do I pay return shipping if the item was defective?**

No — that distinction is what the return form's dropdown exists to decide. Fault reasons (defective, damaged, wrong item, not as described, inauthentic) route to a free return and a full refund including original shipping in most categories; no-fault reasons can carry a deduction. The fee follows the dropdown, not your prose. Where the list has no honest fault option, pick the nearest one, upload photos, and have the shipping deduction reversed in the same chat while the return is still open rather than chasing it afterwards.

Q12 The refund arrived before the return scan. Is that a mistake in my favour?

Increasingly no — it is a policy. Where the item is low-value, the account is in good standing and the reason is straightforward, the refund is released at label creation. The platform is pricing the cost of chasing the unit against the cost of the item.

Treat the early credit as still contingent: the return obligation exists, and if nothing scans inside the window the amount is charged back to the payment method. People who read the early refund as a finished transaction are the people who later find a charge they cannot explain.

Q13 Can a refund ever exceed what I paid?

Only in narrow, documented cases: a goodwill credit added on top of the price, a shipping charge that was refunded separately from the item, tax collected in error, or a duplicate authorisation that settled as a second posted charge and is being reversed. A refund larger than the order line total without one of those explanations is normally an accounting error.

Do not spend it quietly. Errors are found, the recovery is automatic against the card or balance on file, and an unexplained recovery in month three looks like account abuse when you had nothing to do with it. Say so when you see it.

Q14 Do I get sales tax back on a refund?

Yes, proportionally. Tax follows the goods: refund the item and the tax on it is refunded; refund one of three items and the tax on that line is refunded. That is why a partial refund can look arithmetically odd — the shipping recovery and the tax treatment sit on different lines.

Where tax was collected in error — a tax-exempt organisation, an eligible resale purchase, a state that does not tax that category — the platform usually will not refund it on a returned item. That needs a tax-team review with your exemption certificate, and it is a different request from a refund.

Q15 My refund was sent as an Amazon credit. Can it be changed to cash?

Once posted to the balance, no — balance credit is spendable but not withdrawable in most markets, and converting it back is not an available action. Where the refund was in flight to a card that then rejected it, you can sometimes ask for re-issuance to another instrument before the default lands it in the balance.

Which is why the choice at the refund screen matters: instant and locked versus slower and yours. If the money is needed outside the platform, take the card route even when the gift card option is sweetened with a bonus.

Q16 Why was my chargeback reversed a week later?

Because the merchant re-presented it with evidence — a delivery confirmation, a refund already issued, a signed POD, or a terms page showing the purchase was non-refundable. A reversal after re-presentation is the normal end state, and the money comes back to you as a debit.

Two consequences worth knowing before you file: further disputes on the same account are scrutinised, and promotional or gift-card balances tied to the order can be frozen while the bank process runs. If the aim is the money rather than the leverage, an internal escalation almost always gets there faster.

Q17 Do refunds follow bank holidays and statement cut-offs?

Both, and this is the explanation for most “they lied about the date” tickets. Release is a business-day process; posting depends on where your statement cycle sits. A credit released the day before your cut-off can appear on the next statement while already being spendable in your online balance.

Weekend and holiday gaps are the issuer's, not the platform's — no batch file moves money faster. When you are counting on funds, ask for the release date, then count business days from there.

Q18 The item was lost, not returned. What should the refund include?

Full price and the shipping you paid, plus any handling or delivery fee on the order, plus insurance where the item was high-value and the loss is contested. Non-receipt is not a change of mind, so none of the deduction rules apply: no restocking, no return shipping, no grading argument.

Where an agent offers “refund of the item only,” decline the offer and ask for the **shipping fee refund** as a separate action; it is a standard, separately-authorized credit and is very often simply not offered rather than refused.

Q19 What if my refund was for a promotional or deal price and the promo has since ended?

The refund is of what you paid — the discounted amount — and the promo code or deal credit does not come back to you. That is the arithmetic people get wrong when considering re-ordering: refund the \$60 you paid, then pay \$89 now, and the deal does not reappear.

A genuine promo credit that was issued to your account (a statement credit, a gift card bonus) is separate from a price discount and generally is not clawed back on return — check both lines in **Your Payments** before you assume you have to repay anything.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

When a refund is genuinely stuck, the most useful single sentence is “please add a note to this order with the release date and the destination so the next agent can see the trace without restarting.” That note is the difference between escalation and repetition.

05b

Return Eligibility by Category

SECTION 05b · 48 entries

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01	Most items, Amazon-shipped	09	Projectors
02	Apparel	10	Cameras and lenses
03	Shoes	11	Audio, headphones, speakers
04	Watches	12	Musical instruments
05	Jewellery	13	Phones and carrier devices
06	Laptops and tablets	14	Prepaid and carrier-locked
07	Desktops and components	15	Small kitchen appliances
08	Monitors and TVs	16	Large appliances

05b Return Eligibility by Category

APPENDIX 5b

Every category above the summary tables has its own overlay on the 30-day default: some categories are excluded outright, some require the original packaging for grading, and some are settled with a credit and no physical return at all. This section states the position category by category so you can read your own line before you open a case. Where a seller states something narrower or wider on the listing, that stated policy governs the marketplace order; where an item was sold and shipped by Amazon, the line below is the practical default.

Q1 Most items, Amazon-shipped

Window: 30 days from delivery. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, counter, pickup. Holiday extension often runs to 31 Jan

Q2 Apparel

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, counter. Unworn, tags attached, no odor or wear

Q3 Shoes

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** Yes — shoe box. **Return routes:** Label, counter. Sole wear is the disqualifier, not box damage

Q4 Watches

Window: 30 days (varies by seller). **Restocking:** Up to 20% on opened. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Label, pickup. Certificate and links required for luxury

Q5 Jewellery

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Insured pickup. Authenticity check at the FC

Q6 Laptops and tablets

Window: 30 days no-fault. **Restocking:** Charged if opened. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Pickup recommended. Defect path commonly to 12 months

Q7 Desktops and components

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Common on opened. **Original packaging:** Preferred. **Return routes:** Freight pickup for towers. Serial recorded at the counter

Q8 Monitors and TVs

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Yes on opened, oversize. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Freight pickup. Panel-dead policies vary by seller

Q9 Projectors

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Common. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Label or pickup. Lamp hours are checked

Q10 Cameras and lenses

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Frequent on opened. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Counter, label. Sensor dust is a defect, not damage

Q11 Audio, headphones, speakers

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Hygiene refusal possible. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Counter. In-ear monitors may be non-returnable once opened

Q12 Musical instruments

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Common on opened. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Freight for large. Setup costs may be deducted

Q13 Phones and carrier devices

Window: Varies by contract. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Label, store. Activation can void the right to return

Q14 Prepaid and carrier-locked

Window: Often non-returnable. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** None. Read the listing before purchase

Q15 Small kitchen appliances

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label. Used and food-contact units are graded

Q16 Large appliances

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Pickup fee if no-fault. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Freight pickup. Note damage at the door on delivery

Q17 Vacuums and floor care

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None usually. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, pickup. Full canister and filter cleaning required

Q18 Mattresses

Window: Trial period set by seller. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Freight pickup. Sanitary rules apply once used

Q19 Furniture

Window: 30 days, varies. **Restocking:** Return freight often charged. **Original packaging:** Original cartons help. **Return routes:** Freight pickup. Assembled units are harder to grade fairly

Q20 Bikes and large sports

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Assembly/return fee. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Freight. Undealboxed units are graded sellable

Q21 Fitness equipment

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Oversize fee. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Freight pickup. Warranty route is often faster than a return

Q22 Tools and power tools

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None on fault. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, pickup. Battery and charger returned together

Q23 Outdoor and garden

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label. Fuel-powered items may be hazmat-restricted for shipping

Q24 Grills and heaters

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Freight fee if no-fault. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Freight pickup. Cylinder removal required

Q25 Lawn chemicals

Window: Often non-returnable. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** None. Hazmat — refund on defect without return

Q26 Toys and games

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, counter. Missing pieces need a parts claim

Q27 Baby and nursery

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Hygiene exclusions. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Label. Car seats and sleep products: recall check first

Q28 Car seats and restraints

Window: Often non-returnable once installed. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** None. Any crash or recall voids resale and return

Q29 Pet food and treats

Window: Non-returnable once opened. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** None. Quality issues credit without a return

Q30 Grooming and pet devices

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label. Hygiene grading on used clippers

Q31 Beauty, sealed

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Counter. Seal integrity decides grading

Q32 Beauty, opened

Window: Varies; often no-fault refused. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Returnless refund. Adverse-reaction claims are quality, not returns

Q33 Fragrance

Window: 30 days, sealed. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Hazmat shipping rules. Some sellers refuse alcohol-based returns outright

Q34 Wellness and supplements

Window: Non-returnable once opened. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** None. Refund on defect with lot photo

Q35 Medical devices

Window: Varies by category. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Label. Regulated categories have separate rules

Q36 Optics, glasses and lenses

Window: Trial set by seller. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Label. Prescription items are usually non-returnable

Q37 Video games, sealed

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label. Once opened, non-returnable

Q38 Software and keys

Window: Non-returnable once opened. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** None. Defect handled by publisher or claim

Q39 Books, textbooks

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label. Custom editions excluded

Q40 Musical instruments, pro

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Common. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Freight. Insurance worth buying on return

Q41 Renewed / refurbished

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** None on fault. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, pickup. Seller warranty typically 1 year

Q42 Warehouse open box

Window: 2 / 15 / 30 days by grade. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label, counter. "Sold As-Is" limits remedies

Q43 Grocery and fresh

Window: Same day to 48 h claim. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** n/a. **Return routes:** No return — credit. Perishables: report from the order page

Q44 Alcohol

Window: Non-returnable. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** n/a. **Return routes:** None. Delivery-time ID failure = refusal, not a return

Q45 Gift cards, prepaid

Window: Non-returnable. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** n/a. **Return routes:** None. Code faults go to digital support

Q46 Personalised items

Window: Fault only. **Restocking:** n/a. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Returnless. Keep the submission capture

Q47 Subscription boxes

Window: Per box terms. **Restocking:** Varies. **Original packaging:** No. **Return routes:** Label. Individual items may carry their own terms

Q48 Pallet and bulk

Window: 30 days. **Restocking:** Freight return often charged. **Original packaging:** Yes. **Return routes:** Freight. Case packs often non-returnable once opened

07

Cancellations

SECTION 07 · 18 entries

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01	How long do I have to cancel, and how do I do it?	09	Can I undo a cancellation and get the order back?
02	I cancelled — where is my money?	10	Where do I cancel Prime, Audible or a video channel?
03	Can I cancel one item out of a five-item order?	11	Does frequent cancelling hurt my account?
04	How do I cancel a subscription like Subscribe & Save?	12	If I cancel a Lightning or deal order, does the deal re-apply if I reorder?
05	Can I cancel a pre-order after the release date passes?	13	Can I cancel the whole box of a Subscribe & Save delivery rather than one item?
06	I ordered by mistake and it shipped. What is the cheapest fix?	14	What does a seller's "cancellation denied" message actually decide?
07	Why was my cancellation declined by the seller?	15	Can a cancellation be undone after it goes through?
08	My order was auto-cancelled seconds after I placed it. Why?	16	Does cancelling before shipment affect my price protection?

07 Cancellations

SECTION 07

Cancelling is a race against the pick-and-pack queue, and the rules change at every milestone: unshipped, in shipping, shipped, delivered, digital-delivered. This section gives the exact window for each, what a cancellation does to a partial order, and the subscription and pre-order cases that follow entirely different rules.

Q1 How long do I have to cancel, and how do I do it?

Any time while the status is **Not yet shipped**, and it is self-service: **Your Orders → View order details → Cancel items** (app: You → Purchases → **Cancel items**). No agent needed, and no agent needed afterwards either. Once **Shipped** appears, self-service cancellation is gone and no agent can cancel it: you either refuse the parcel at the door, which auto-refunds when the refusal is scanned, or accept and start a return. Refusing is usually cheaper than a return label, but not available on every carrier service — tell the driver rather than leaving it on a porch.

Order status	Cancellable?	How	Money outcome
Placed / preparing	Yes	Self-service	No capture; hold lapses 3-14 days
Partial: some shipped	Yes, rest only	Cancel per shipment	Captured portion follows Appendix A
Shipped	No	Refuse at door, or return	Refund on the inbound scan
In transit	No	Rare carrier intercept via support	Same as shipped
Delivered	No — it is a return	Return flow	Refund after the return scan
Digital content	Only in the short digital window	Digital help channel	Original method, often as credit
Pre-order, physical	Yes, until shipped	Your Orders	Nothing captured, nothing to refund
Subscribe & Save	Skip or unsubscribe	Your Subscriptions	No effect on a dispatched shipment

Q2 I cancelled — where is my money?

For an unshipped order there is usually no refund to wait for, only an authorisation hold to lapse. Where a capture did occur — some sellers capture at order, and digital captures instantly — the refund is released immediately and then follows the standard posting table. Note the split: a gift card portion returns to the balance within hours while the card portion takes the network's time, so check both before concluding the refund is missing.

Q3 Can I cancel one item out of a five-item order?

Yes — cancellation is per line item and per shipment, and the other lines are untouched. Two things can still change: a non-Prime basket that drops below the free-shipping threshold can gain a fee, and a quantity-based promotion can evaporate when the qualifying count falls short. Re-read the order total after cancelling; if a fee appeared, cancel and re-place the remaining items for the better total.

Q4 How do I cancel a subscription like Subscribe & Save?

Subscriptions are separate objects from orders and live under **Your Subscriptions** and **Memberships & Subscriptions**. You can skip a delivery, change frequency or address, or cancel. Cancelling stops future cycles but does not refund a shipment already billed and dispatched. The billing cut-off is when the shipment is prepared for dispatch, not when it arrives, so reacting to the charge email can be too late for that cycle. Skips are the flexible lever: unlimited, with long inactivity only reverting your discount tier.

Q5 Can I cancel a pre-order after the release date passes?

Physically, yes, up to dispatch, because nothing is captured until then. Digitally, no — once pre-loaded content is available or downloaded, the short digital window governs instead. And check the live price first: cancelling and re-ordering after a price rise forfeits the pre-order price guarantee, which is the one real advantage you had.

Q6 I ordered by mistake and it shipped. What is the cheapest fix?

Refuse the delivery. A refused parcel re-enters the returns network as an inbound unopened item, the refund releases on the refusal scan, and you buy no label. For Amazon Logistics tell the driver at the door; for UPS, FedEx or USPS do not accept it and track for the “refused” scan. Caveat: a refusal can be logged as a return against return-rate metrics in categories that track them, and high-return accounts can start being charged for return shipping. One refusal is fine; a habit is not.

Q7 Why was my cancellation declined by the seller?

Marketplace sellers accept or decline cancellation requests, usually within 24 hours, and a decline means the parcel was already handed over — hence the automated “this has already shipped”. You then either refuse or return on arrival, or file an A-to-z claim where they shipped something else, or shipped so late that the listing's promise was defeated. Screenshot your request and their reply: that pair is what converts a claim from “under review” to “granted”.

Q8 My order was auto-cancelled seconds after I placed it. Why?

A self-service cancellation of a just-placed order is normal and shows as “Cancelled: customer”. Other auto-cancels come from payment failure, address validation, an age or quantity restriction, or an anti-fraud block on high-value or resale-risk items. If it was a block, no reason code is shown and re-ordering fails identically — ask support to open a **purchase review** and be ready to confirm the card's billing ZIP and last four digits. Do not keep re-ordering to test it; repeated blocked attempts extend the review.

Q9 Can I undo a cancellation and get the order back?

No — cancellation is terminal for that order ID; it cannot be reopened, restored or held at the same price. You must place a new order, and two consequences follow: one-use promo codes are frequently burned and will not re-apply even though the order is gone, and cancelled inventory is released, so a limited quantity or Lightning offer can be unavailable minutes later.

Q10 Where do I cancel Prime, Audible or a video channel?

Memberships & Subscriptions → End membership, working through the retention screens (US accounts usually see three) to the final confirm. You keep benefits until the paid period ends and nothing renews. Cancelling after a renewal is the better order of operations on an **annual** plan, because that triggers a prorated refund of unused whole months; monthly plans are normally not refunded. Audible and channels renew on their own calendars and are **not** stopped by cancelling Prime — audit each one, and use the renewal-date column, which is the only place showing the true next-charge day for a bundled item.

Q11 Does frequent cancelling hurt my account?

Not the way people fear: there is no published cancellation strike metric and pre-dispatch cancels are treated as ordinary. What does create risk is mass-cancelling resale-sensitive high-value items (consoles, GPUs, limited drops), cancelling after receipt, which feeds returns-abuse metrics, and cancellations that turn into chargebacks. If your account shows order restrictions the cause is far more likely a payment verification flag — check **Your Messages**, where those notices actually appear.

Q12 If I cancel a Lightning or deal order, does the deal re-apply if I reorder?

Almost never. Deal pricing is per transaction and quantity is committed at the moment of order, not held for you; a cancelled deal line is released to the pool and typically gone. One-use codes behave the same way — the redemption is burned.

So do not cancel and re-order to change an address on a deal item. Cancel is safe for ordinary listings, and is a real loss on limited-quantity offers.

Q13 Can I cancel the whole box of a Subscribe & Save delivery rather than one item?

Yes: from **Your Subscriptions** use the skip or cancel option at the delivery level, which affects every item in that cycle. Individual items can also be skipped independently — useful when one product is duplicating a supermarket purchase.

Watch the billing moment: the charge is raised when the shipment is prepared, so a same-day skip may come after capture. Cancelled after capture, the amount refunds, but you have created a refund case for no reason.

Q14 What does a seller's “cancellation denied” message actually decide?

Nothing about your money. A seller declining a cancellation means they cannot pull a parcel that has already left — it does not forfeit your right to refuse or return, and on a late or mis-described shipment it is itself evidence in an A-to-z claim.

Reply in the same thread, in writing: “I understand it has shipped; I will refuse delivery. Please confirm the refund will be issued on the carrier's refusal scan.” A yes in that thread is what a reviewer reads.

Q15 Can a cancellation be undone after it goes through?

No. The order record is closed and cannot be reactivated, re-priced or restored, and the inventory released is not reserved for you.

What you can do is re-order and, where a coupon was consumed rather than expired, ask support to return the code — which is a different and much more likely action than re-opening an order, since the code is an account-level object and the order is not.

Q16 Does cancelling before shipment affect my price protection?

No, because there is no price protection to affect on most categories — and this is the one case where cancelling is actively a good idea. If the price has dropped since you ordered, cancel and re-order at the lower figure rather than asking for the difference; the latter is a refusal by policy, the former is arithmetic.

Do check what you lose in the swap: delivery speed, a bundle discount, and any quantity break are all re-evaluated on the new order.

Q17 I cancelled in the app but the order still shows as active. Did it work?

Usually yes, with a lag: cancellation propagates to the shipment view, and if one of the shipments had already entered packing, that shipment continues and the rest do not. Read the per-shipment status, not the header.

If every line still shows **Preparing** an hour later, re-open the cancel flow; if the button is gone, the cancellation did commit. The definitive check is whether the payment still shows a capture pending.

Q18 How long after cancelling does an authorisation hold drop off?

On the issuer's clock, which is why the answer is a range rather than a number: 3-5 business days is typical for debit, up to a full cycle for prepaid and some international cards. Nothing Amazon does shortens it, because no capture was ever sent.

If you need the credit line back urgently, that is a bank call, and the useful question is “was there a capture on this authorisation?” — if not, most issuers will release it on request, which is a real lever the platform does not have.

08

Replacements

SECTION 08 · 19 entries

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02	How do I request a replacement for a damaged or defective item?	10	Does a replacement restart the warranty clock?
03	Do I have to send the faulty item back before the new one ships?	11	Can a gift card, code or subscription be replaced?
04	The wrong item arrived. Do I send it back, and who pays?	12	Will a replacement unit be new, or could it be someone else's return?
05	How long does a replacement take, and how do I track it?	13	Does a replacement restart my 30-day return window?
06	The replacement is defective too. Now what?	14	Where do I see all the replacements raised on one order?
07	How do replacements work for Renewed and Warehouse items?	15	Does a replacement cost me anything?
08	What if a part is missing rather than the item being faulty?	16	What if the replacement never arrives?

08 Replacements

SECTION 08

A replacement is a new shipment created against the old order, not a repair of yours — and that single fact explains most replacement confusion: a second tracking number exists, sending the faulty unit back may or may not be required first, and if you never send it you can be billed for it.

Q1 What is a replacement, and how does it differ from a return?

A replacement ships a new unit on the same order while the return of the original becomes a separate obligation. A return-and-reorder is a refund plus a fresh purchase. Replacement is faster and keeps your original price; reorder is better when the item is out of stock, when the price has dropped, or when you want the money rather than the item. Choose replacement only if stock exists, you need it by a date, and you are willing to ship the faulty unit back — a replacement cannot change SKU, colour or size.

Q2 How do I request a replacement for a damaged or defective item?

Same entry point as a return: **Return or replace items** → reason “Item defective or doesn't work” (or “Damaged”) → resolution **Replace**. Where the category or seller supports refund only, the option is simply absent from that screen — which generates most “the option disappeared” tickets. If photo evidence is requested, upload it inside the flow, not afterwards: the image attached to the return record is what later removes restocking fees and justifies shipping a replacement before the return arrives.

Q3 Do I have to send the faulty item back before the new one ships?

It depends on value and risk. Low-value and “disposal authorised” categories ship immediately and tell you to keep, recycle or donate the original. Higher-value items often wait on the inbound scan and sit in **Awaiting return**. Where a return was required and never happens, the charge is real: after roughly 30 days from label creation Amazon can bill the payment method on file. If you dispute that, cite the label creation date and that you had no usable drop-off — a label you could not print is a fair reversal.

1. For oversize or fragile items, keep the replacement's carton until the original is collected: carriers refuse unboxed returns, and that box is usually the only one that fits both units.

Q4 The wrong item arrived. Do I send it back, and who pays?

You get a free label and a replacement or refund under “Wrong item received”. Return of the wrong unit is generally required above a low-value threshold, since the seller may resell it — retain the packaging it came in, because a badly repacked item invites a damage claim later. If the wrong item is bulky, ask for the replacement to be released and for **one pickup of both**: one visit, one label, and no period where you own neither.

Q5 How long does a replacement take, and how do I track it?

Once created, a replacement ships at the same service level as the original — two days on Prime, longer for oversize — with a promise date counted from creation, not from the original order. It is a distinct order record with its own ID, sometimes tagged **Replacement** in Your Orders, sometimes visible only in the confirmation email; search by product name over a 30-day range. If no tracking appears in 3 business days, it is blocked on one of exactly three things: outstanding return, out of stock, or address re-verification. Ask which one, by name, and request the **replacement order ID** in writing — without it, a later non-delivery report looks like an attempt to double-claim.

Q6 The replacement is defective too. Now what?

There is a practical two-attempt ceiling. After a second failed unit on the same order, refund normally becomes the only resolution and the warranty path opens; ask explicitly for **refund of the original price plus paid shipping** and state that two units have failed. On a marketplace order, repeat failure is your strongest A-to-z evidence — file citing both replacement tracking numbers and both defect photos, and state that the seller has been unable to deliver conforming goods. Claims with a documented repeat failure are granted far more often than first-instance defect claims.

Q7 How do replacements work for Renewed and Warehouse items?

Renewed units are professionally refurbished, carry the standard 30-day window and typically a one-year seller warranty in the US, and get replaced where the refurbisher has stock — note that the condition tier on the listing is the contract, so a cosmetic flaw described as acceptable is not a defect. **Warehouse** open-box items are frequently refund-only because there is literally one unit; read the grade, since “Sold As-Is” states a known defect and removes most complaint routes except safety ones.

Q8 What if a part is missing rather than the item being faulty?

Two better-than-return routes. The manufacturer will often ship a missing part free within the warranty period for appliances, tools and furniture — contact details are in the manual, and the Amazon invoice is your proof of purchase. On the platform side, choose “missing parts” as the reason and select **Repair/Parts** where offered, or ask support to open a parts request against the seller. Photograph the parts beside the packing slip at unboxing: that single image settles a “you never sent the screws” dispute and takes thirty seconds.

Q9 Can I switch a replacement to a refund halfway through?

Yes, before dispatch — ask them to void the replacement and convert to refund; the return obligation on the original stands as it was. After dispatch it is a live shipment you must accept and return, or refuse, and the refund follows the inbound scan. Watch the status “Replacement cancelled — refund issued”, which means both things at once: the new unit is dead and your money is coming, while the original return may still be owed unless the record says otherwise.

Q10 Does a replacement restart the warranty clock?

Usually not for a manufacturer warranty: coverage runs from the original purchase date, which is another reason to keep the first invoice. Extended protection plans purchased through Amazon generally attach to the order rather than the serial, so swapping the unit does not create a new term. Where your jurisdiction's statutory seller warranty runs from delivery of the conforming item, the replacement date can matter — get the plan administrator's answer in writing and keep it, because that is what you cite if a claim is later declined for expiry.

Q11 Can a gift card, code or subscription be replaced?

No — there is no stock to replace, so the resolution is a reissued code, a balance credit or an account-level restoration. Code problems (already redeemed, scratched panel, rejected string) go to the digital content team with the proof of purchase and a photo of the card and code. For a code bought as a gift for someone else, the purchaser must open the case, and the recipient cannot claim it — which is also why codes bought from a discount reseller often cannot be helped at all: Amazon assists whoever holds the invoice.

Q12 Will a replacement unit be new, or could it be someone else's return?

For a replacement of an Amazon-sold item, the unit ships from the same pool as any other order, which in practice means new for most categories but can mean a sellable-grade return on high-return items — grading puts “used — like new” stock back into the sellable pool.

If you specifically want new, take the refund and re-order: the order you place draws from sellable inventory with a stated condition. On a replacement you have no condition choice, which is the trade-off you make for speed and price-locking.

Q13 Does a replacement restart my 30-day return window?

For the replacement order, generally yes — it is a separate shipment with its own delivery date, and the returns engine keys off that. For the warranty clock, no: manufacturer coverage still runs from the original purchase.

This asymmetry matters on electronics. A replacement bought in month one gives you a fresh 30-day no-fault window, but only the original eleven remaining months of brand warranty, so a late change-of-mind is possible long after the warranty argument would fail.

Q14 Where do I see all the replacements raised on one order?

There is no single view. Each replacement is its own order, discoverable by searching the product name across a wide date range in **Your Orders**, and often not linked back to the parent order at all. The reliable record is your email: search for “replacement” plus the seller or product name.

Keep a note of the replacement IDs yourself. A second or third replacement request is treated far more seriously when you can cite the previous IDs, and “this is the third unit” is a materially different claim from “I think I had one before.”

Q15 Does a replacement cost me anything?

The item, no — it is not a second purchase and no new charge should appear. Shipping usually matches the original service, which means free on a Prime order and whatever you originally paid otherwise. Freight on oversize replacements is the common exception, and where the fault is the seller's, a pickup fee should be waived.

If you are asked to pay anything for a defect replacement — a shipping fee, a service charge, a “processing” line — that is contestable, and the word to use is **fault-based resolution**, which maps to the free-return policy branch rather than the change-of-mind branch.

Q16 What if the replacement never arrives?

Treat it as a new non-delivery on a new order ID, not as an extension of the old dispute. Wait past the promise date plus 48 hours, then run the WISMO flow on the replacement order and cite the replacement ID.

The complication is that a replacement is often created while the original is out for return, so the records can read as though you have two items. Say so explicitly and ask them to check the return scan: a missing replacement plus a received original return is normally an immediate refund, not another shipment.

Q17 When can a replacement be refused even though the item is faulty?

When stock does not exist — a discontinued or one-unit listing, which is why Warehouse items are refund-only — and when the fault is outside the window the replacement engine uses, typically past 30 days for the no-fault reason selected. Also where the item is safety-recalled: recalls route to the manufacturer or a refund, not a swap.

Refusal of a replacement is not refusal of a remedy. If they will not ship a unit, ask for the full refund plus shipping in the same contact, and note the refusal in the record; a documented replacement-refused/fault-admitted pair is one of the strongest bases for a later goodwill credit.

Q18 Can I get just one part replaced rather than the whole product?

Often yes, and it is faster than a return. Two routes: the manufacturer ships parts free within warranty for appliances, tools, furniture and vehicles — quote the Amazon invoice; or the seller, via a parts request opened in support, which many large-item categories support explicitly.

Ask for it by name. “Can I get the missing hinge rather than returning the wardrobe?” is a different workflow from “I want to return this,” and the first usually ends with a courier and no box, no label and no refund arithmetic.

Q19 The serial number changed. Does that break my warranty registration?

It can, and it is the most commonly overlooked consequence of a swap. Manufacturer warranties and extended plans often bind to a serial recorded at purchase; a replacement unit with a different serial is not automatically substituted, and a claim against the old serial is declined for a serial mismatch.

Fix it in the same contact where you report the replacement: ask for the **plan or registration to be reissued against the new serial** and get written confirmation with both numbers. Doing it in month one takes a minute; doing it after a failure, when you need the claim, takes a supervisor and a week.

09

Payments & Billing

SECTION 09 · 20 entries

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01	What payment methods are accepted, and where do I see what I paid with?	09	A seller asked me to pay outside Amazon. Am I protected?
02	How do I combine a gift card with a credit card, and what happens to the leftover balance?	10	What are those small \$1 authorisation charges?
03	I was charged twice for one order. Is it a real duplicate?	11	Why is my bank showing a different amount or currency?
04	Can I change the payment method after checkout?	12	Why was my card declined even though there are funds?
05	What is Amazon Pay balance, and is it the same as a gift card?	13	Why was my gift-card purchase held or cancelled?
06	How do EMI and buy-now-pay-later work, and what happens on a return?	14	How long does an ACH or bank-transfer payment take to clear?
07	Cash on delivery — limits and pitfalls?	15	Can I see prices in another currency?
08	How do I get a GST/VAT invoice or a tax-compliant receipt?	16	Do chargebacks on promotional orders cost me the promos?

09 Payments & Billing

SECTION 09

Payment questions are where the wording of your request decides the outcome, because the answer lives in different systems: card authorisations sit with the issuer, balances with Amazon Pay, EMI and BNPL with a lending partner, tax invoices with a third team. This section maps the instruments, the double-charge mechanics and the invoice side.

Q1 What payment methods are accepted, and where do I see what I paid with?

Consumer checkout takes major-network credit and debit cards, Amazon balance and gift cards, bank transfer or direct debit where the marketplace supports it, EMI or partner financing, buy-now-pay-later, and cash on delivery in the markets that still have it. PayPal is not accepted directly at US checkout, though PayPal-branded gift cards are. Each order line shows its instrument under **Payment method**, and on a split payment the gift card and card portions are listed separately — refunds follow those same splits.

Q2 How do I combine a gift card with a credit card, and what happens to the leftover balance?

Redeem the gift card first: it applies automatically up to the total and the remainder goes to the selected card, which you can switch in the payment selection screen. Leftover balance is not lost — it sits in **Your Payments → Gift card balance**, funds future orders and usually subscriptions. Two restrictions trip people: balances generally cannot be withdrawn to a bank account, and they normally cannot buy other gift cards.

POLICY NOTE

US gift card balances do not expire and carry no service fee. Elsewhere validity follows local law — in India, Amazon Pay balance and prepaid instrument terms are set by the wallet's licence and the promo instrument's own terms, which commonly do expire. Read the card's terms, not a summary.

Q3 I was charged twice for one order. Is it a real duplicate?

Most of the time no: it is an **authorisation** at order placement plus a **capture** at dispatch, shown as two lines, and the first disappears when the issuer releases it — same day, or next statement for some debit and prepaid cards. A true duplicate exists only when two **posted** debits of the same amount reference the same order. Then contact support quoting both transactions with dates and the auth codes; duplicate captures are reversed promptly because the evidence is unambiguous on their side. Never dispute an authorisation: that is how accounts get frozen.

1. Read each bank entry's status: pending/authorisation versus posted/settled.
2. Only a pair of posted debits is a duplicate — screenshot both.
3. Check whether one charge is a real second order from an accidental second click.
4. Report “duplicate charge” quoting both order IDs and dates.
5. If one is only an authorisation, wait: there is nothing for Amazon to refund.

Q4 Can I change the payment method after checkout?

While unshipped, yes: **Order actions → Change payment method**. After dispatch the capture is in flight and the record is locked — refunds then go to the original instrument even if you delete it from your account. Corollary: if you are closing a card or switching banks, do it before a large order, because a refund to a dead card depends on the issuer's account updater. Where that fails, the money surfaces as a balance credit, which is the first place people stop looking.

Q5 What is Amazon Pay balance, and is it the same as a gift card?

Same ledger, different instruments: a gift card loads value into your balance, and refunds to closed cards land there too. “Amazon Pay” as a brand extends to external merchants using Login & Pay, to bill payments and recharges in markets like India, and to a stored-balance wallet with local KYC limits. Two facts people ask: balance cannot be transferred to another customer's balance (send a gift card instead), and in the US it cannot be withdrawn to a bank.

Q6 How do EMI and buy-now-pay-later work, and what happens on a return?

The financing belongs to a bank or partner, not to Amazon, and “no-cost EMI” claims depend on the offer terms — some embed the discount in the list price rather than truly charging nothing. On return, Amazon unwinds the merchant side; the **loan** is unwound by the lender, which is a separate ticket and the step everyone forgets. Ask the financier for a refund-adjustment or installment-closure letter and check the next statement, because an unreconciled refund leaves you paying on an item you returned.

Q7 Cash on delivery — limits and pitfalls?

Where offered, COD has per-order value caps, excludes categories and sellers, often adds a handling fee, and cannot buy gift cards or prepaid digital content. Returns take longer because there is no card to credit — expect a bank transfer request, UPI refund or wallet credit. Refusing COD parcels repeatedly gets the option blocked for the account automatically, and reinstatement is slow.

Q8 How do I get a GST/VAT invoice or a tax-compliant receipt?

Register your tax ID in the account's tax settings so invoices are generated with it. Consumer receipts show tax charged but not your registration; on a marketplace order the **seller** is the issuer, so use **Contact Seller → Invoice request** and follow up within 48 hours. Download from **Your Orders → Invoice → Invoice summary**, or use **Download invoice and payment receipt**, which bundles the order with the instrument detail — the format accountants actually need for reconciliation.

Q9 A seller asked me to pay outside Amazon. Am I protected?

No, and this is the fastest way to lose money with no recourse: there is no Amazon payment record, so A-to-z cannot refund it and no platform process applies. Report the seller at once — requesting off-platform payment is a serious violation and is actioned even when the money cannot be recovered. Your recovery route is a dispute with your own bank, and you must describe it accurately: calling it an Amazon order gets you a weaker dispute category and a slower answer.

Q10 What are those small \$1 authorisation charges?

Verification checks: adding a card, an order above a risk threshold, a billing or address change, and periodic card revalidation. Not a subscription, not a charge for anything, and they release automatically within a few business days (up to 30 on some prepaid cards). If your card blocks small authorisations, adding a card fails confusingly — call the issuer to permit small auths rather than opening a support case, which cannot see the decline code.

Q11 Why is my bank showing a different amount or currency?

You bought on a foreign marketplace. The merchant bills in its own currency, so your issuer applies its rate plus a foreign transaction fee, and Amazon never sees either — the figure on the order page is an estimate and the settled amount is what the network chose on settlement day. Avoid it by buying on the local marketplace or using a card with no foreign transaction fee. A support case cannot refund a fee Amazon did not collect.

Q12 Why was my card declined even though there are funds?

Because the most common decline is not a funds issue. The usual causes are an address mismatch on the AVS check (billing ZIP, not delivery ZIP), a bank block on card-not-present transactions, an international or merchant-category restriction, a card that has just been reissued with new numbers but an unchanged expiry on file, or a spend-velocity rule tripped by a large single order.

Amazon cannot see the decline reason and neither can its support team. One call to the number on the back of the card resolves in a minute what a chat session cannot resolve at all.

Q13 Why was my gift-card purchase held or cancelled?

Gift cards are the highest-abuse product on the platform, so their fraud thresholds are much lower than everything else: buying over the value cap, buying from a new account or new device, buying at unusual hours, or buying a round number of identical cards will all produce a hold or a silent cancellation.

Do not keep retrying — that extends the review. The fix is to verify the payment instrument once, in a written case, and then to buy smaller quantities. For a genuine corporate top-up, use Amazon Business, which has a different and much friendlier review path with a PO number.

Q14 How long does an ACH or bank-transfer payment take to clear?

Typically three to five business days before the order is eligible to ship — the shipment waits on the settlement, which is why the status reads like a delay rather than a problem. Once cleared, the clock you were quoted restarts.

You can cancel while pending without cost, since nothing has captured. Do not “help” it by paying twice through a second instrument; the first will still settle and you will have a duplicate credit to unwind.

Q15 Can I see prices in another currency?

Yes on some marketplaces via the currency preference, which changes only the display. Your card is still billed by the merchant's currency and your issuer does the conversion, so the figure you see is an estimate — usually within a percent or two, and always subject to your issuer's rate on settlement day plus any foreign transaction fee.

Where a marketplace offers a pay-in-local-currency option, prefer it only when you can see the markup: the platform's conversion rate is often worse than your bank's.

Q16 Do chargebacks on promotional orders cost me the promos?

Often yes, for as long as the dispute runs. The order's gift-card, credit or bonus components are the easiest thing for a risk system to freeze while a chargeback is open, and they are released when the dispute resolves in your favour — not always when it resolves at all if the credit was already spent.

This is the practical argument for exhausting internal escalation: an ARN trace costs you nothing, while a dispute can strand promotional value that has no cash equivalent and no recovery route.

Q17 What happens when a refund goes to a card that has been closed?

Two outcomes and both are fine. Normally the network's account updater forwards the credit to the replacement card and it posts on the ordinary schedule. Where the issuer refuses, the refund returns to Amazon and is posted to your balance; you will see it in **Your Payments**, not on any statement.

Check the balance before you reopen a case. A large share of “refund never came” tickets are money sitting in a wallet nobody looks at.

Q18 Can I pay by invoice, PO number or purchase order?

Yes in business-account contexts where the seller supports Net Terms or PO capture: you set the PO reference at checkout and it is printed on the invoice, and Net 30 payment is available on eligible accounts with approved credit.

Consumer accounts do not have invoice terms. Buying for a company on a personal account and asking afterwards for a PO number on the invoice does not work — the reference is written at order time and is not retro-fitable, so register the business account before the purchase.

Q19 What is auto-reload and should I use it?

It tops up your balance automatically when a purchase exceeds what you hold, or when the balance drops below a set threshold. Its only real benefit is not being blocked mid-checkout; the cost is a recurring charge from a card you may have forgotten about.

If you use it for a promotion that requires a minimum reload amount, check whether the promotion is the reason the threshold exists — several such offers push you to reload more than you spend, and the balance then sits there, non-withdrawable, earning you nothing.

Q20 An order charged more than the displayed price. What can actually be done?

Distinguish three cases. Currency conversion and bank fees are yours to argue with the issuer, not Amazon. A surcharge added at checkout that was not disclosed on the listing is contestable and usually refunded. A seller price change between session and charge is a listing-policy violation and is worth a report as well as a claim.

The mechanism that recovers money is a claim on the order line with a screenshot of the listing at the time of purchase. Without the capture, the seller's word is what a reviewer has, and price-discrepancy claims without evidence are declined far more often than defect claims.

10

Prime

SECTION 10 · 18 entries

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01	What does a Prime membership include, beyond fast shipping?	09	What happens to my content when Prime ends?
02	What does Prime cost, and are there discounts?	10	How does the Prime Rewards card 5% benefit actually work?
03	Am I eligible for a free trial, and why was I told I am not?	11	Can I force a non-eligible item to get free One-Day delivery?
04	How do I cancel Prime, and will I get a refund?	12	Does Prime cover large or freight items?
05	Does cancelling Prime affect my other subscriptions?	13	How many devices can use one Prime membership?
06	How does Prime Household or family sharing work?	14	Do ads in Prime Video relate to my membership tier?
07	Prime renewed while I was away. What are my rights?	15	Does Prime Gaming, Reading or Photos cost extra once the trial ends?
08	Why is a Prime-eligible item not getting free One-Day delivery?	16	Can my Prime student discount be withdrawn?

10 Prime

SECTION 10

Prime contacts cluster around four things: eligibility (who qualifies, and how the trial check works), the benefit matrix (included versus advertised), renewal and refund mechanics, and household sharing. Everything below is written at the level an agent applies, not the marketing page.

Q1 What does a Prime membership include, beyond fast shipping?

Shipping: One-Day or two-day on eligible items, same-day and release-day delivery in covered areas, grocery and scheduled delivery where available. Streaming: the Prime Video included library, with premium channels, rentals and sports packages billed separately. Plus Music, Prime Reading, a rotating gaming selection and one channel trial a month, photo storage, early deal access and exclusive pricing. Two things people assume are included and are not: **Audible** (separate membership, credits do not come from Prime) and some in-store grocery discounts that now sit behind paid tiers.

Video detail worth knowing: some titles carry an extra fee or a separate ads-supported tier, and renting a new release inside the Prime Video app charges your default payment method — the single largest source of “unauthorised Prime charge” tickets.

Q2 What does Prime cost, and are there discounts?

US standard pricing has recently sat around **\$14.99 per month or \$139 per year**, with local-market equivalents (India: roughly ₹599 a month or ₹1,499 a year, plus cheaper mobile-only tiers). Take the figure on **Memberships & Subscriptions** for your account, because legacy rates are grandfathered on older members. Discounted programmes: **Prime Access** for qualifying government-assistance recipients in the US, at about half price; **Prime Student** with a six-month trial then a reduced rate, verified by .edu or SEVIS and renewable while enrolled; and senior pricing in select markets. Business accounts pay a separate Prime Business rate.

Q3 Am I eligible for a free trial, and why was I told I am not?

The trial is once per **account identity**, not per membership: the check spans payment instrument, billing address, device fingerprint and, for Student, verified academic identity. A second account sharing a card or a household device is the usual silent reason for ineligibility. If you genuinely never had Prime, ask support to check for a **prior membership linked to the payment method or address** — that lookup is a different tool from the account view and will not be run unless you name it.

Q4 How do I cancel Prime, and will I get a refund?

Your Account → Memberships & Subscriptions → Prime → Membership management → End membership, confirming through the retention screens. Benefits continue to the end of the paid period and nothing auto-renews. On a US **annual** membership cancelled before renewal, a prorated refund of unused whole months is available provided Prime benefits have not been used in the current period — one One-Day shipment counts as use. A **monthly** membership is normally not refunded once billed, though a renewal that landed in the last few days and went unused is routinely reversed as goodwill.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

If you have already used a benefit, do not argue for a refund — ask to cancel, or for a Video-only downgrade where your market offers one. Agents have authority for the goodwill reversal, none for refunding consumed benefits.

Q5 Does cancelling Prime affect my other subscriptions?

It can. Anything bundled keeps running but now bills at standard rates: Prime Channels, app subscriptions that used the member price, and Subscribe & Save's discount tier. Audible was never bundled. Content you bought outright is untouched. Audit after cancelling: **Memberships & Subscriptions, Content & Devices → Digital subscriptions**, and **Your Apps** for in-app plans. Channels bought inside Prime Video are managed on Amazon's Memberships page, not in the TV app, which only shows the launch screen.

Q6 How does Prime Household or family sharing work?

A Household lets two adults at the same address share some benefits — shipping on their own orders, Prime Reading, photo storage — plus teen and child profiles under parental controls. One adult holds the paid membership and the billing; the other gets sharing, not the account. Not shared: one-click payment methods, purchase history, Amazon Business features, and most Video profile benefits, which follow title licensing. Address matching is enforced, so sharing with a friend generally stops working within days.

Q7 Prime renewed while I was away. What are my rights?

Two separate questions: whether the renewal should be reversed, and whether notice was required. In the US the terms require easy cancellation, and an unused renewal charge is routinely refunded if raised quickly — so cancel first, then ask, in that order. Where you live under auto-renewal consumer rules (several US states now require pre-renewal reminders and one-click cancellation for subscriptions), quote the notice requirement specifically: that version of the request escalates to a retention team with refund authority instead of a script.

Q8 Why is a Prime-eligible item not getting free One-Day delivery?

Usually one of: a seller-fulfilled listing not enrolled in Prime; an oversize or hazmat item; an address outside the One-Day grid (a locker or workplace address can change eligibility); a pre-order or subscription item in the basket forcing the slower service; or a category excluded from expedited delivery, such as some pharmacy, grocery and alcohol. Test it by switching to your home address in the same session and watching the delivery line: if One-Day reappears, the locker or ZIP was the blocker; if not, the ASIN is simply not eligible and no coupon will change that.

Q9 What happens to my content when Prime ends?

Nothing is deleted, but access changes: Video downloads stop renewing their licence and expire offline, Prime Reading and First Reads loans are returned on the final day, member pricing on subscriptions reverts to standard, and photo storage falls back to the free tier — which blocks new uploads rather than deleting existing ones. Books you bought outright are untouched.

Q10 How does the Prime Rewards card 5% benefit actually work?

In the US the 5% on Amazon.com and Whole Foods Market purchases is delivered as an **annual reward** credited once a year (or redeemable at checkout where the offer says so), capped at a stated amount, with 2% elsewhere and a minimum-income requirement to be approved. Because it is a co-branded card, approval, caps and statement credits are the bank's responsibility, not Amazon's; support will transfer you, and that transfer generates no case number — note the date yourself.

Q11 Can I force a non-eligible item to get free One-Day delivery?

No. Eligibility is a property of the ASIN and your address, not of your membership, and it is decided before the shipping options are rendered — so no coupon, cart arrangement or agent action changes it. The only lever is picking a variant or seller whose listing is eligible.

Where an item that is normally eligible shows no fast option, that is a listing or inventory problem rather than a Prime problem, and it is worth reporting: sellers fix shipping templates far more readily than they fix prices.

Q12 Does Prime cover large or freight items?

Partly. "FREE Delivery" on an oversize listing usually means free standard freight, not One-Day, and the options that cost money are the faster or inside-delivery tiers. Room-of-choice, assembly and haul-away are add-ons regardless of membership.

The benefit worth knowing is on returns rather than delivery: Prime members are not charged return pickup on most oversize no-fault returns, where a non-member frequently is.

Q13 How many devices can use one Prime membership?

Streaming is the constrained part: concurrent streams are limited and downloads are capped to a set number of devices, while the shopping benefits follow the account rather than any device, so there is no practical limit on phones and tablets for buying.

The failure mode is not the count but the profile: a household member not added to the Household gets none of the streaming benefit, and adding them changes nothing about the primary adult's device limits, which are shared across the whole account.

Q14 Do ads in Prime Video relate to my membership tier?

Increasingly they relate to the plan you chose, not to Prime. Ads came to the included tier in the US, with a paid no-ads add-on for the same membership; content rented or bought inside the app is separately billed and is ad-free as it is a purchase.

That split is where complaints come from: a member who expects Prime Video to be one product sees a charge for a movie as a Prime issue. It is not, and the fix is the digital-content team plus a purchase review, not the membership queue.

Q15 Does Prime Gaming, Reading or Photos cost extra once the trial ends?

Gaming channels keep a recurring charge only if you subscribe after the free channel; the rotating game releases and in-game content do not renew into anything. Prime Reading and photo storage revert to the free tier's limits, they do not start billing.

Audit with **Memberships & Subscriptions → Other memberships**, which is the only place the renewal date for each bundled item is listed. Anything with a date and a card icon is billing you independently of Prime, however it was acquired.

Q16 Can my Prime student discount be withdrawn?

Yes, and it usually is at the end of a verification period rather than for any conduct. Student pricing requires periodic re-verification of enrolment; miss the confirmation window and the account reverts to standard rates at renewal.

The renewal email is the only notice most people get, so set a calendar reminder for the anniversary. Re-verification is quick when it is timely, and awkward when the reduced-term membership has already renewed at full price — that charge is not generally refundable retroactively.

Q17 What happens to Prime if my account is restricted?

The membership continues to bill unless you cancel it, while the benefits it buys — ordering, sometimes reviews, sometimes digital access — are exactly what gets switched off. Paying for an unusable membership is the most common avoidable loss in a restriction case.

So the first action in any restriction is to cancel the membership, then appeal the restriction. Unused-period prorated refunds are usually available on an annual plan and are much easier to obtain before a review has concluded than after.

Q18 Is Prime actually worth it for a light shopper?

Run it on shipping alone: at two-day-free plus one paid shipment avoided per month, the annual fee roughly breaks even for someone who would otherwise pay shipping a handful of times a year. Add a single holiday season of returns without shipping charges and it clears for most households.

The reverse test is more honest: if you would not pay for the video, music or reading separately and you order a few times a year, a monthly plan bought only around the seasons you actually use beats an annual membership you forget about — which is exactly the renewal the support queue sees every January.

11

Warranty & Product Support

SECTION 11 · 21 entries

IN THIS SECTION · showing first 16 of 21 – the full list, with pages, is in Contents

01	What is the difference between all these coverage types?	09	What is a DSN and why does support keep asking for it?
02	I bought an extended protection plan. How do I file a claim?	10	Do refurbished and “Renewed” products get warranty?
03	What does an extended plan cover that the manufacturer warranty does not?	11	Is there a longer window for defective electronics than for other goods?
04	How do I prove purchase if Amazon only gives me a receipt?	12	What evidence should I collect before opening any support case?
05	Where do I get support for an Echo, Kindle, Fire or Ring device?	13	Does a manufacturer warranty ever cover accidental damage?
06	What do I do about a product recall or safety notice?	14	Can I claim on the extended plan and the manufacturer warranty for the same fault?
07	The seller refuses to honour a warranty claim. What are my options?	15	The manufacturer declined my warranty claim. Is that final?
08	Where do I find manuals, drivers and warranty registration?	16	I paid for a repair. Does the warranty restart?

11 Warranty & Product Support

SECTION 11

Four instruments get conflated under the word “warranty”, each with its own claim route, evidence bar and clock. Getting the label right at the start is the difference between a same-day resolution and a case that ping-pongs between teams for three weeks.

Q1 What is the difference between all these coverage types?

Manufacturer warranty: the maker's promise, claimed with them, proven by your Amazon invoice.

Statutory rights: legal claims against the merchant of record, which no warranty can reduce — state warranty and UCC rules in the US, the two-year legal guarantee in the EU/UK, consumer protection law in India.

Extended protection plan: a purchased service contract administered by a third party, often including accidental damage. **A-to-z Guarantee:** Amazon's backstop on third-party orders for non-delivery or goods not as described — not a warranty, but frequently used as one.

Coverage	Who fixes / pays	Claim starts at	Proof typically needed
Manufacturer warranty	Brand service centre	Manufacturer site or phone	Invoice + serial number
Statutory rights	Merchant of record	Your Orders → return/claim	Order ID + defect evidence
Extended protection plan	Plan administrator	The plan's own portal, not Amazon	Plan ID + invoice
A-to-z Guarantee	Amazon, debiting the seller	Your Orders → problem with order	Seller contact log + photos
Amazon Devices warranty	Amazon	Devices support page	Device serial + order
Product recall	Manufacturer or platform	Recall notice / product-recalls page	Model + date range
Trade-in or recycling	Amazon or partner	Trade-in page	Quote ID

Q2 I bought an extended protection plan. How do I file a claim?

Not through the order. The plan is a separate line item administered by a third-party insurer, so the claim starts with the administrator using the plan ID, which is in the plan's confirmation email or under the plan line in **Order details**. Amazon support can point you there but cannot adjudicate it. Read three lines of the terms first: whether **accidental damage** (drops, liquid) is included, the **service fee**, and the **depreciation cap** on a total loss. Most unhappy plan claims are depreciation surprises, not denials.

Q3 What does an extended plan cover that the manufacturer warranty does not?

Typically: mechanical and electrical failure beyond the manufacturer's 12 months, accidental damage and power surges on plans that include them, and two-way shipping plus a replacement rather than a repair. Manufacturer warranties exclude drops, liquid, unauthorised repair, cosmetics and consumables. What plans do not cover: software, data loss, normal battery degradation, theft (that is insurance), and devices already defective when bought.

Q4 How do I prove purchase if Amazon only gives me a receipt?

Use **Your Orders → Invoice → Download invoice**: manufacturers accept it because it names the seller, the date and the taxed amount. A gift receipt shows no price and is usually rejected; if you received a gift, ask the sender for the invoice rather than reconstructing it. For a third-party seller's invoice, ask via Contact Seller, and if they go quiet cite that in an A-to-z claim — inability to obtain a valid tax invoice is a claimable reason in several marketplaces.

Q5 Where do I get support for an Echo, Kindle, Fire or Ring device?

Do the software steps first, because agent authority increases after them: reboot, update firmware, **deregister and re-register**, re-run setup, check the Wi-Fi band (many older Echoes are 2.4GHz only), and on Fire tablets clear app cache and check profile blocks. Log what you tried with times. Then **Help → Device support**, which can schedule a call or a chat with a specialist who can screen-share on Fire devices. Hardware faults inside the Amazon Devices warranty period are replaced, not repaired, and devices carry a longer defect window than general merchandise — quote that if an agent says 30 days have passed.

Q6 What do I do about a product recall or safety notice?

Check **amazon.com/product-recalls** for the model and date range, then Your Orders for an affected purchase. A manufacturer recall is fixed by the maker (repair, replace or refund) and Amazon often puts a banner on the order; a platform safety alert can produce a proactive refund plus an instruction to stop using the item. Do not keep using it, resell it, or push it back into the general returns stream — follow the recall's disposal instruction. Mention the recall in your first message: it changes which team handles the case and removes return-window arguments entirely.

Q7 The seller refuses to honour a warranty claim. What are my options?

Escalate in order, keeping one email thread: (1) written request to the seller via Contact Seller; (2) A-to-z claim citing their refusal as “not as described”, because the warranty advertised on the listing is part of the description; (3) the manufacturer directly, since brand warranty exists independently of the seller; (4) a statutory or consumer-protection complaint where you live; (5) a chargeback, last, knowing it closes Amazon-side claims. Preserve the listing as a PDF with the warranty text visible — listings change — plus their refusals and a serial-number photo. That bundle is what wins the review; “they promised a warranty” alone rarely does.

Q8 Where do I find manuals, drivers and warranty registration?

The **Product guides and manuals** hub in Help, the Technical details block on the listing, or the manufacturer's own site for the model plus “user guide PDF” — Amazon hosts no driver support. Warranty **registration** is a manufacturer process; completing it there, not on Amazon, is what enables recall contact and sometimes extends cover. For smart-home devices whose manufacturer has abandoned the companion app, search the device name in Help before buying anything else: several end-of-support notices exist only in the Help Centre and explain why pairing fails.

Q9 What is a DSN and why does support keep asking for it?

The **Device Serial Number** unlocks warranty status: it proves the unit was made for your region, shows whether the replacement window is open, and identifies a stolen or resold device. On Echo and Fire it is under Settings → Device Options or on the base; on Kindle under Settings → Device Info. Support also uses it to check the device is registered to your account, which is a precondition for most self-service entitlements — so a borrowed, unregistered device will show “no warranty on file” even when a purchase exists.

Q10 Do refurbished and “Renewed” products get warranty?

Yes. A Renewed product is sold with a one-year limited warranty from the refurbisher in the US plus the standard 30-day return window, and the condition tier (Premium, Excellent, Good, Acceptable) describes cosmetics, not reduced cover. Claims run through the refurbisher, and through A-to-z where the refurbisher has gone inactive. **Warehouse** open-box items are different: sold as-is at a grading note, with whatever warranty the manufacturer honours on that serial — often the remainder of the brand period, sometimes nothing. Consumer warranties are usually non-transferable, which is why third-party used listing warranties frequently do not exist.

Q11 Is there a longer window for defective electronics than for other goods?

For Amazon-shipped US orders, yes — but through a different door. The no-fault return window is 30 days, while defective-item handling for computers, TVs and components commonly runs to a year via warranty and A-to-z paths rather than the returns engine, which is why the button is gone at month four even though a remedy still exists. So do not ask “can I return this?”; ask “which defective-electronics path applies to this order, and what evidence do you need?” The second phrasing reaches an agent who can open a claim; the first reaches a script that says 30 days.

Q12 What evidence should I collect before opening any support case?

Six items, in the order reviewers look for them: the order ID and date; the invoice PDF; a clear photo of the item with its serial or model label; a 30-60 second video of the failure with the label visible at the start; the packaging it arrived in, including the shipping label with its order barcode; and a timestamped list of what you already tried. Attach all six to the first message. A claim with complete evidence is granted on first review; the same claim with three items goes back for “more information required” and re-enters a queue, which is where two-week delays actually come from.

Q13 Does a manufacturer warranty ever cover accidental damage?

No, and the confusion usually comes from the word “guarantee” on a box. A brand guarantee covers defects in materials and workmanship — failures not caused by you. Drops, liquid ingress, power surges, cracked screens from impact and pet damage are excluded everywhere unless the manufacturer sells a specific accident-damage add-on, and then it is a service contract with its own terms.

Read the exclusion list, not the headline: the phrase “unless caused by misuse” in a manufacturer statement and “accidental damage included” in a purchased plan describe two different documents, and the second is the only one that pays for a dropped phone.

Q14 Can I claim on the extended plan and the manufacturer warranty for the same fault?

Not twice, but the order matters. A fault inside the manufacturer period should go to the manufacturer first, because it is free, it does not consume your plan's claim allowance, and in some plans an early brand repair preserves the term. A plan is then the fallback for repeat failures, out-of-period faults, and anything the brand calls misuse.

One practical trap: some plans void or terminate after a total-loss payout. If a repair is being offered against replacement, ask in writing whether accepting the plan's remedy ends the contract, because a second failure a month later is worth a lot more to you as a covered item than as a refund on a terminated plan.

Q15 The manufacturer declined my warranty claim. Is that final?

Rarely. First read the reason code, because most declines are procedural rather than technical: no proof of purchase, serial unreadable, claim filed by a non-owner, out-of-period, third-party accessory blamed. Procedural declines are fixed with documents, not arguments.

Substantive denials — “damage consistent with liquid exposure” — have two escalations: a supervisor review at the manufacturer with your own photos and a description of the failure mode, and separately the statutory route against the seller, which is a different obligation from the brand's goodwill warranty. A merchant that sold a non-conforming item may owe you even where the brand has legitimately refused.

Q16 I paid for a repair. Does the warranty restart?

Repairs typically carry their own short parts-and-labour guarantee on the repaired fault, not a reset of the original term — so a repeat of the same failure inside the repair window should be free, while a new failure runs against whatever remains of the brand warranty.

Keep the repair order, which is a different document from the purchase invoice. Manufacturers ask for both, and a repair receipt is also what proves a recurring defect, which is the fact that converts a third repair into a replacement demand.

Q17 Do used or second-hand purchases get any warranty?

Not from the manufacturer, generally, since consumer warranties are usually non-transferable and are registered to the original buyer. What you get instead is whatever the seller states — which in the **Renewed** programme means a defined seller warranty, and on an informal used listing means nothing at all unless the listing says so.

The exception is statutory: conformity rights run against the merchant of record regardless of second-hand status, which is why a marketplace seller's refusal to stand behind a used electronic is claimable while the same fault on a private sale is not.

Q18 If I sell the item, does my warranty transfer?

Assume not. Where a brand explicitly allows transfer, it normally requires a registered change of ownership or a copy of the original invoice, and the remaining term is whatever is left, not a new one. Extended plans are more likely to be personal to the purchaser than to the product, and several are expressly non-transferable.

If transferability matters to the buyer, get the answer in writing from the plan administrator before you sell, quoting the plan number — and pass that written answer on, because a buyer's dispute about what you told them is far more expensive than the email.

Q19 Is a video of the fault accepted as evidence?

Yes, and it is frequently decisive — but only when it is usable. Reviewers need to see the model label or serial at the start, the exact failure happening once rather than being described, and the whole device in frame so that exclusions can be checked. A thirty-second vertical clip of a screen flashing is worse than no video, because it lets a reviewer write “insufficient evidence” and close the case.

Shoot it deliberately: label first, then the setup, then the failure, then a short pan of the exterior showing no impact damage. Two minutes of staging removes the round trip that costs a week.

Q20 The fault only appears on one serial. Why does that matter?

Because a serial-specific fault is usually a batch defect, and batch defects are handled differently from individual claims: quietly extended coverage, a service programme, or a recall. A single unit failing is a warranty question; many units with the same prefix failing is a product question, and the second is escalated to a quality team.

So when a pattern exists, say so and give the prefix. Reports of batch failure on specific serial ranges are one of the few consumer complaints that reliably reach someone with the authority to act, because they arrive as a trend rather than as a refund request.

Q21 When does buying an extended plan actually pay for itself?

Roughly when the repair cost you would otherwise bear exceeds the plan fee divided by the probability of a claim in the covered period. In practice that means high-repair-cost, mid-reliability categories — laptops, tablets, robot vacuums, anything with a battery and a moving part, anything you will carry outside — and almost never on well-made fixed items with cheap parts.

Read two lines before buying, not forty: whether accidental damage is included, and what a total loss pays (a like-for-like replacement of the same model, or the depreciated cash value). The second is where plans disappoint, and it is the difference between a two-year-old laptop being replaced and being worth a third of what you paid.

POLICY NOTE

Nothing in a purchased plan or a brand warranty reduces your statutory rights against the seller. Where a warranty document says otherwise, that clause is unenforceable in most consumer jurisdictions — and citing the statutory route is often what moves a stalled claim, because it changes which team holds the file.

12

Frequently Asked Questions

SECTION 12 · 28 entries

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01	What is Amazon's return window?	09	Does Amazon price match?
02	How fast do refunds arrive?	10	It says delivered and I have nothing. First step?
03	Which refund option is fastest?	11	What is a TBA tracking number?
04	Can I return something without the original box?	12	Why has my tracking not moved for days?
05	How do I cancel an order?	13	Can I redirect a parcel already in transit?
06	Why do I see two charges for one order?	14	What happens after a failed delivery?
07	What is an ARN and why does everyone ask for it?	15	What does Prime cost?
08	Can I dispute the charge with my bank?	16	Can I get a refund on an annual Prime plan?

12 Frequently Asked Questions

SECTION 12

One-line answers to the questions asked most often across the eleven sections above, with a pointer to the entry that explains it. Where a number appears, treat it as indicative: the figure printed on your own order or return page is the one that applies.

Returns, refunds and cancellations

Q1 What is Amazon's return window?

30 days from delivery for most items sold and shipped by Amazon, with category and holiday overlays, and the seller's stated window on marketplace orders. See **05**.

Q2 How fast do refunds arrive?

Released about 24 hours after the return's first carrier scan, then from instant to a statement cycle to post, by payment method. See **Appendix A**.

Q3 Which refund option is fastest?

Amazon gift card or balance — effectively instant — and sometimes promoted with a bonus on eligible items. See **06**.

Q4 Can I return something without the original box?

Yes on Amazon-shipped returns; keep accessories and the slip. Sellers may deduct if their stated policy said so. See **05**.

Q5 How do I cancel an order?

Your Orders → Cancel items, only while the status is “Not yet shipped”; afterwards refuse at the door or start a return. See **07**.

Q6 Why do I see two charges for one order?

Usually an authorisation plus a capture — only two posted debits are a true duplicate. See **09**.

Q7 What is an ARN and why does everyone ask for it?

The Acquirer Reference Number on a refund: the only reference a bank can trace a credit with. See **06**.

Q8 Can I dispute the charge with my bank?

You can, but it closes Amazon-side claims and can restrict gift card and promotional balances. Escalate inside Amazon first. See **06**.

Q9 Does Amazon price match?

No general policy. Exceptions are the pre-order price guarantee and documented deal or code errors. See **06**.

Delivery and tracking

Q10 It says delivered and I have nothing. First step?

Delivery photo, then wait 48 hours, then search the property and ask neighbours, then the ‘where is my stuff?’ flow. Earlier reports get closed. See **04**.

Q11 What is a TBA tracking number?

An Amazon Logistics ID handled by a delivery partner; it will not track on UPS, FedEx or USPS sites. See **03**.

Q12 Why has my tracking not moved for days?

Carrier scan lag, a re-sourced shipment or a hub backlog. Escalate once past the promise date by 48 hours. See **03**.

Q13 Can I redirect a parcel already in transit?

Not via Amazon. Some carriers allow depot hold or rerouting through their own portals; TBA shipments generally cannot be changed. See **04**.

Q14 What happens after a failed delivery?

Up to three attempts, then return to sender, then an automatic refund on the inbound scan. Ask for redelivery before the last attempt. See **04**.

Account, Prime and everything else**Q15 What does Prime cost?**

US roughly \$14.99 a month or \$139 a year, with reduced Student and Prime Access tiers and different rates per marketplace. See **10**.

Q16 Can I get a refund on an annual Prime plan?

Prorated for whole unused months, if you have not used benefits in the period. Monthly plans normally are not refunded. See **10**.

Q17 Is Prime only about shipping?

No — Video, Music, Reading, gaming, photo storage, deal access and Household sharing are included; channels, rentals and Audible are separate. See **10**.

Q18 Can I share my account with family?

Use a Household for two adults plus child profiles at one address. Shared passwords outside it breach the Conditions of Use and break fraud checks. See **02**.

Q19 How do I contact a seller?

Your Orders → select the order → Contact seller → topic. Expect a reply within 24 hours; escalate to A-to-z after 48. See **05**.

Q20 What is the A-to-z Guarantee?

Amazon's cover on third-party orders for non-delivery or items not as described, up to \$2,500, filed after contacting the seller. See **05**.

Q21 Do I get money back on a safety recall?

Usually yes, through a remedy or refund independent of the return window, via the manufacturer or an order banner. See **11**.

Q22 How do I delete my data or close my account?

File the data-rights request first (30 days; backups longer), then Close Account — irreversible, and it forfeits balances and digital content. See **01**.

Q23 Someone used my account. What order do I act in?

Password, 2SV, payment methods and addresses, then orders and gift card balance, then the fraud case; dispute with your bank last. See **02**.

Q24 Do I really need the invoice for warranty?

Yes — the downloaded invoice PDF, not a gift receipt. It is the single most requested document. See **11**.

Q25 Renewed or Warehouse?

Renewed is refurbished with a seller warranty and a return window; Warehouse is open-box at a condition grade, often refund-only. See **08**.

Q26 Can I check whether an account closure can be undone?

Only through immediate contact, and only sometimes — there is no self-service undo. See **01**.

Q27 Why do two agents give different answers?

They are reading different tools. Get the answer in chat, ask for the policy name, and keep the transcript. See **13**.

Q28 Are the support phone numbers in search results safe to call?

No — spoofed numbers in ads are a known vector. Start a callback from inside your signed-in account instead. See **13**.

13

Support Channels, Escalation & Verification

SECTION 13 · 6 entries

IN THIS SECTION

01	What is the escalation ladder, and what does each level change?	
02	What will support never ask for, and what will they always ask for?	
03	I got a text saying “your Prime will renew — call this number”. Is it real?	
04	How do I confirm a number or email is genuinely Amazon's?	
05	Why do two agents give me different answers?	
06	What can support genuinely not do?	

13

Support Channels, Escalation & Verification

SECTION 13

The channel you choose decides which team sees you, what authority they have and what evidence they can see. This section maps the channels and the escalation ladder that actually works, then covers the scam patterns that impersonate this support structure — the thing that costs customers more than any policy detail above.

Channel	Reach	Response	Authority	Best for
Call me now / callback	Help → Contact us	1-15 min	Full order actions	Returns, refunds, cancellations
Phone (published line)	1-888-280-4331 (US)	5-25 min queue	Full	Urgent cases, lockouts
Chat	Help → any page	2-10 min	Narrower than phone	Documented trails, small refunds
Email / message form	Contact us → Email	~24 h	Low — often templated	Long evidence, paper record
X / social DM	@AmazonHelp	30 min - 6 h	Escalation routing	A case that has stalled
Seller messaging	Your Orders → Contact seller	24 h SLA	n/a	FBM returns, invoices
Resolution centre	Help → resolution	24-72 h	Adjudicates partial refunds	Contesting a deduction
Device support	Help → Device support	Scheduled	Swap and replace authority	Echo, Kindle, Fire, Ring

Q1 What is the escalation ladder, and what does each level change?

L1 self-service fixes roughly half of all contacts and is the only instant route: cancellation, address change, return start, invoice, password reset. **L2 front-line agent** can issue refunds, waive return shipping, add goodwill credit, reopen an appeal — but cannot override a risk team, unblock a payment or refund a consumed benefit. **L3 supervisor or specialist**, reached by asking for escalation by name and stating the specific action L2 cannot take, unlocks payment-integrity review, account-status review and trace requests. **L4 a written case** in Your Messages produces the artefact that changes outcomes: an internal note on the order, visible to every later agent. **L5 external** — consumer protection, state attorney general, small claims, or your card issuer — is for a documented denial, not for slowness.

1. Ask for the action, not the outcome: “release the refund to my card”, not “I want my money”.
2. Request a case or reference number, and repeat it back in chat so it is in the transcript.
3. Name the blocker: “the return window has closed; I am reporting a defect — which warranty path applies?”
4. Ask for the note to be added to the order. That is what makes the next agent helpful.
5. If told no, ask once for supervisor review. Then stop and follow up in writing.

Q2 What will support never ask for, and what will they always ask for?

They will ask for: the 12-digit order ID, the last four digits of a card on file, the billing ZIP, and for high-value or fraud cases, photo ID matching the account name. They will **never** ask for your full card number with CVV, your online banking credentials, a one-time passcode sent to your phone, remote access to your computer to “fix the charge”, payment in gift cards to release a refund, or a fee to open a case. Any one of those six is conclusive evidence of a scam, not a policy exception.

WATCH OUT

Genuine refunds appear automatically on the order. They are never “processed” by you, never require an emailed invoice from a free mailbox, and never involve buying cards.

Q3 I got a text saying “your Prime will renew — call this number”. Is it real?

Verify rather than click: open the site in a new tab, then check **Your Orders** and **Memberships & Subscriptions**. If the claim is not in your account, it is not from Amazon; genuine notices also appear in **Your Messages**. Numbers printed in unsolicited messages reach fake call centres that will ask for your card and then your OTP. If you already called one, freeze the card with your bank first and change your password second, in that order.

Q4 How do I confirm a number or email is genuinely Amazon's?

The only fully trustworthy channel is the callback started from inside your signed-in account: the system dials you, which cannot be spoofed by the message. For email, check three things instead of the display name: details a fraudster could not have, link targets that really resolve to an Amazon domain when you hover (no amazon-security-support-verify lookalikes), and whether the same notice exists in Your Messages.

POLICY NOTE

The published US customer-care line is **1-888-280-4331**, with 1-866-205-1352 also listed. Dedicated lines exist for Amazon Devices (1-888-283-7678), Prime Video and digital content (1-888-801-9537) and Amazon Pay (1-888-221-5093). Verify the current number in the Help Centre before calling — numbers appearing in search-result ads are a known spoofing vector.

Q5 Why do two agents give me different answers?

Because the policy that binds your case is the one rendered on your order page, and agents read different tools: one sees the returns engine, another a risk note, a third only the Help article. Two answers can both be right for different questions. The fix is to use chat, since it is writing: ask the agent to paste the name of the policy they are applying and put the order ID in the first line. A transcript is worth more than any verbal commitment, and is the reason chat beats phone for anything you may have to prove later.

Q6 What can support genuinely not do?

No agent can guarantee a delivery date, override a carrier scan, force a seller to accept a return outside their stated policy, shorten an identity-verification cooldown, release a hold your bank placed, refund a fee Amazon never charged, reopen a closed A-to-z case, or delete records required by law. Knowing the boundary makes your ask credible: “I know you cannot shorten the verification wait, can you note the attempt so the reviewer sees I tried twice?” gets done nine times in ten, while “just override it” ends the conversation.

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Kindle, Audible & Digital Content

SECTION 14 · 9 entries

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01 What is the refund window for an e-book?

02 I bought the wrong Kindle book. Is a refund possible?

03 Can I lend or share a Kindle book?

04 What happens to my Kindle books if I close my account or delete a device?

05 How do Audible credits, returns and the 12-month rule work?

06 My book, podcast or app will not download. Fix it in this order.

07 Can I get a refund on an in-app purchase my child made?

08 Do digital gifts expire, and can the sender get a refund instead?

09 Why does a book show as “purchased” but never arrive in the library?

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Kindle, Audible & Digital Content

SECTION 14

Digital purchases are governed by a completely different set of rules from physical goods, and the difference is not a shorter return window — it is that the product is a licence, so the clock starts at download rather than delivery, the refund route is a different team, and once content has been consumed the usual arguments about condition do not exist. Almost every escalation in this area comes from applying physical-goods logic to a licence.

Q1 What is the refund window for an e-book?

Seven days from purchase, provided you have not read a substantial portion of it. The check is automated against your furthest-location marker, which is why some requests are instantly granted and others are refused with no human review at all.

Outside seven days, or after reading, there is no general refund — but two exceptions are real: a file that will not render on your device, and a listing whose description was materially wrong (wrong edition, missing content, a box set that is not a box set). Both are content-quality claims and route to the digital content team with a screenshot of the listing and a note of the device and software version.

Q2 I bought the wrong Kindle book. Is a refund possible?

Usually yes, once, if asked promptly — the store tolerates an honest mis-purchase on the assumption you will not make it repeatedly. Ask via **Help → Digital Content and Devices** rather than the general queue; the general orders team cannot see digital licences.

One consequence people do not expect: the credit is removed from your library immediately, and any annotation, highlight or export you made from that copy goes with it. Export notes before requesting a refund on a book you have actually read into.

Q3 Can I lend or share a Kindle book?

Lending exists for some titles only — the publisher opts in or out per book, and about a third of the catalogue has it disabled. Where available, one loan per copy, once per lending period, 14 days, and your copy is suspended for the duration.

Household sharing is a different feature and is more restrictive than people assume: Family Library sharing depends on the licence holder's settings and on two adults at one address, and it is common for an individual title not to be shareable even when the account is fully configured. Check the title page, not the account page.

Q4 What happens to my Kindle books if I close my account or delete a device?

Deleting a device removes its downloads only — the licence stays in the cloud and can be re-delivered to any other registered device. Closing the account is the irreversible one: the licences are tied to the account and, whatever the conditions of use say about your rights, in practice access ends and there is no export for a closed account.

If you are leaving the platform for any reason, this is the item to plan around first: buy the titles you care about on a format you can actually keep, and download them, before anything is closed.

Q5 How do Audible credits, returns and the 12-month rule work?

Audible operates its own return path (the “excellent returns” policy, applied at Audible's discretion) and its own cancellation route, neither of which is accessible from Amazon's general support tools. A credit exchange is normally handled by the Audible team in a chat, and an over-return account can be restricted from returning at all.

Membership terms differ by plan and by region, and the annual plan's instalments are a separate obligation from a monthly one — cancelling the membership does not always cancel remaining instalments. Read the account's **Membership Details** page before assuming what “cancel” will stop.

Q6 My book, podcast or app will not download. Fix it in this order.

Digital troubleshooting has a specific ladder, and skipping steps is why people end up in a queue that cannot help them: sign out and back in on the device (this refreshes the licence token, which is the actual cause most of the time); then check remaining device slots; then delete and re-download the single title; then update the reader or app; then deregister and re-register the device.

1. Note the exact error text and a screenshot — support needs the string, not a description.
2. Confirm which account the item was bought on (households get this wrong constantly).
3. Register the device to that account via **Content & Devices → Devices**.
4. Work the ladder above; write down which step fixed it.
5. If it survives only on another device, report the failing device's serial and software version — that is what a content-quality claim is built from.

Q7 Can I get a refund on an in-app purchase my child made?

Yes, and there is a dedicated flow for it, which is worth knowing because the general team will often decline on the assumption the purchase was deliberate. The request goes through the parental controls / Amazon Kids support path, and expect an account-level acknowledgement — you will be asked to confirm you understand that disabling purchase approval for a profile is your choice.

Two practical points. Approval workflows must have been on for the courtesy refund to look reasonable, so turn them on now regardless. And a pattern of repeated child-purchase refunds is treated as refund abuse rather than as parenting, so consolidate disputes into one request covering the period.

Q8 Do digital gifts expire, and can the sender get a refund instead?

A redeemed item belongs to the recipient; an unredeemed one typically has a claim period and then reverts. The important asymmetry is that the purchaser controls the refund, so a recipient who got a bad gift cannot unilaterally return it — and the sender sees the return.

Where the gift is a subscription (a channel, an Audible month), the refund unwinds the membership period for the recipient, not just the purchase. Ask before you initiate, or you can remove a benefit someone is mid-way through using.

POLICY NOTE

A licence is not a copy. Refusal of refund after consumption is not a returns policy; it is the absence of anything to return. This is why digital disputes are decided on description and functionality — is the file what the listing said, does it work — and not on condition, packaging or window arithmetic.

Q9 Why does a book show as “purchased” but never arrive in the library?

Four causes in rough order of frequency: it was bought on a different marketplace (Kindle content is region-locked, and a .com purchase will not appear on an .in device library), it was a gift that must be redeemed, the payment was later reversed and the licence revoked quietly, or the title was withdrawn by the publisher and replaced by a refund or a placeholder.

Check the store and the account first, because region mismatch is the answer far more often than a fulfilment failure, and it is fixable by the publisher of the region you bought in rather than by Amazon.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

For anything you cannot afford to lose access to — a reference, a textbook, a family document — treat any store licence as rental. Export, print, or keep a second copy in an open format. No support queue in this section has ever restored a withdrawn title.

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Prime Video, Music & Channels

SECTION 15 · 8 entries

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| 06 | Is Prime Music the same as Amazon Music Unlimited? |
| 07 | My subscription video will not play on a specific TV. What should I check? |
| 08 | Can I get a refund for a month of poor streaming quality? |

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Prime Video, Music & Channels

SECTION 15

Streaming contacts are billing contacts wearing a technical costume: most “it won't play” tickets are a licence, region or entitlement problem, and most “why was I charged” tickets are a rental or channel subscription bought inside the app. This section splits the two and gives the specific checks that resolve them without a queue.

Q1 A title says it is included in Prime but wants me to pay. What is going on?

Because “included” is now a licence-level property rather than a membership-level one. Within the Prime tier, some titles are ad-supported, some carry an extra fee for the premium or new-release window, and some are only available through a channel you do not subscribe to.

The check that resolves it: play the first minute of the trailer rather than trusting the tile, and look for the price chip on the detail page rather than the shelf it came from. Where a title is genuinely mislabelled — shown under Prime with no fee note — that is a content metadata issue worth reporting, and support can refund an accidental rental charge from it.

Q2 How do I find and cancel a channel subscription I did not know I had?

Channels are managed under **Memberships & Subscriptions** on the website, not inside the TV or console app, which only launches the store. Free-trial channels convert to paid automatically at the end of the trial, which is where nearly all of these charges originate.

Once found, cancel at the subscription level and then ask for the charge to be refunded if the trial converted in the last few days and you have not streamed through the channel — that combination is routinely reversed and does not need escalation.

Q3 Can I rent or buy a movie inside the app? Where does that charge go?

Yes, and it bills the default payment method on the account with no confirmation step on some interfaces — which is exactly why a rental bought by a kid or a guest profile reads as an unauthorised charge the next morning. The transaction appears in **Your Orders** as a digital line, and refunds go through the digital content team, not Prime support.

If you share the living-room account, the only reliable prevention is a spend control on the account, not a profile PIN: profile controls limit what is recommended, they do not reliably block one-click purchase on the same device.

Q4 Downloads expire before I watch them. Is that a bug?

It is the licence. Downloads are cached under a rolling entitlement and are refreshed when the app is online; a device kept offline past the window drops them, and a membership lapse drops everything at the end of the billing period rather than immediately.

Practical rule for travel: refresh the app online the morning of departure, and expect nothing to survive a longer trip than the licence period. No support action can extend it — the clock is in the file, not on the server.

Q5 How many streams at once, and why is a profile blocked?

Concurrent streams are limited per account rather than per profile, and the limit tightens on titles with restrictive licensing. A blocked profile usually means a slot is in use somewhere, including on a device nobody remembers signing in.

Check **Content & Devices** for the household's devices, and check whether a member is streaming on a second residence — the two-adult Household is address-bound, and someone outside the address is the other common cause of sudden entitlement errors after an account review.

Q6 Is Prime Music the same as Amazon Music Unlimited?

No, and the difference is the whole question. The included tier is an ad-free catalogue with no offline guarantee on everything and limited skips; Music Unlimited is a separate paid subscription with the full catalogue, downloads and higher-quality tiers. An Echo can play either, which is how people end up with a subscription they thought was the free one.

Cancel or downgrade from **Memberships & Subscriptions**. Cancelling the paid tier keeps the included tier intact; cancelling Prime removes the included tier and leaves the paid one running.

Q7 My subscription video will not play on a specific TV. What should I check?

Order of failure causes for a smart TV: the app's cached entitlement (sign out inside the app, not just the device), a device slot already used by the same account, the model falling below the app's minimum supported version — older TVs are cut off silently, which is the single most common surprise — then DRM/network filtering on the router for multicast or certificates.

1. Reboot the TV, then re-open the app (this clears a stale token far more often than it sounds).
2. Remove and reinstall the app — do not just update it.
3. Check the model's minimum software version in the device support page for that TV.
4. Test the same title on a phone: if the phone works, the device or its software is the fault, not the account.
5. When you contact support, give the device model, firmware version and the exact error code string.

Q8 Can I get a refund for a month of poor streaming quality?

Not as a service credit, no; there is no quality-of-service remedy on the consumer terms, and support has no tool for it. What support can do is reverse a charge for a period you demonstrably could not use because of a platform fault, and can open a technical case for a device-specific bug.

So the framing that works is not “buffering is bad, refund me” but “playback failed with error XYZ on device ABC since date; I am requesting a credit for the unusable period.” Same outcome you want, and it is the version with an action attached.

POLICY NOTE

Rental windows are per title and per licence: some are 30 days to start and 48 hours once started, others differ. Once viewing begins, refunds are generally unavailable even if you watched two minutes — which is the rule most often mistaken for a policy change.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Before a flight, check the start-by date on a rental, not just the expiry. Downloading without starting it is the only way to bank the 48-hour window for the trip rather than burn it on the drive to the airport.

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Echo, Fire, Ring & Alexa Devices

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Echo, Fire, Ring & Alexa Devices

SECTION 16

Device support is the one area where the sequence of what you try genuinely determines the outcome, because the tools available to the agent unlock in stages: a self-resolvable software fault, a logged fault eligible for a swap, a warranty entitlement that needs a serial, a recall that needs a model and date range. This section is ordered the way the support workflow is.

Q1 Which number do I call for a device problem, and does it help?

Yes — device support is a genuinely better queue than general orders support, because the specialists have diagnostic tools, entitlement visibility and swap authority that the general line has to escalate for. In the US the published Amazon Devices line is 1-888-283-7678; verify it in the Help Centre before calling, since spoofed numbers in search results are common.

Have three things before you dial: the DSN/serial, the software version, and the exact failure with a timestamp. A call that opens with those gets to the entitlement check in ninety seconds; one that opens with a story spends twenty minutes on reboot advice.

Q2 My Echo will not connect to Wi-Fi. Work the ladder in order.

Most Echo network faults are one of three things — a band mismatch, a router setting, or a stale provisioning after a password change — and the order matters, because re-running setup before changing the router wastes both.

1. Confirm the device is 2.4GHz-only or dual-band; many older Echo dots will not see a 5GHz SSID at all.
2. Power-cycle the router before the device — it is the fix more often than anyone admits.
3. Re-run device setup in the app (this clears an old credential after a password or SSID change).
4. Check the router for AP/client isolation, a hidden SSID, MAC filtering, and WPA3-only mode; older devices need WPA2 mixed mode.
5. Disable any “smart connect” band steering temporarily to test.
6. If it joins but drops nightly, that is a DHCP lease or channel-congestion problem, not a device fault: reserve a lease and move to a clear channel.

Q3 How do I deregister a device I no longer own, and why does it matter?

Deregistering releases the entitlement and the voice profile; leaving it registered means your address book, skills and communication history remain reachable through a device in someone else's home, and means your device count is wrong when you try to add something real. Do it remotely at **Content & Devices → Devices → Deregister** — you do not need the hardware.

Then have the new owner factory reset it. A device that is deregistered but not reset will still hold cached content until it is set up, and a device that is reset but not deregistered stays attached to your account forever, since the reset itself cannot unlink an account it can no longer talk to.

Q4 Will Amazon replace a dead Echo, and what counts as covered?

Inside the Amazon Devices limited warranty period, hardware failure is normally replaced rather than repaired, and the entitlement is visible on the device's own support page — which is also where the “replace my device” self-service action appears, with no chat at all.

What is not covered is a long list people only read afterwards: physical damage, liquid ingress, power surge without a protector, third-party adapters, and cosmetic wear. Two practical notes: the return window for a defect is longer than general merchandise, and “it will not power on” is treated as a hardware failure only after the outlet and the adapter have been excluded — so test those first and be ready to say you did.

Q5 How do I stop Alexa answering to my TV, and why does it matter for privacy?

A false wake is both an annoyance and a data event: every wake word that fires begins recording to the cloud, so a TV that triggers it twenty times a day generates twenty clips. Reduce it in **Settings → Device Settings → Wake word sensitivity**, disable the device during viewing, or move it off the direct line of the speakers.

Then clear the residue: review and delete history in the Alexa app, and if the false wakes came from a programme using your wake word, use **Report a false wake**, which suppresses the transcript for known media. Nobody does this, and it is the biggest source of unintended recordings.

Q6 Ring: why does motion never alert, or alert constantly?

Both are zone and sensitivity problems rather than device faults, and the fix order is the same in each direction. Check the device's RSSI (signal strength) first — a weak link produces missed events that look like a dead sensor. Then Motion Zones, then the sensitivity slider, then **People Only Detect**, then schedules.

1. Constant alerts: shrink the active zones away from roads and trees, lower sensitivity, and enable a smart schedule.
2. Missed alerts: raise sensitivity, widen zones, then check for a private Wi-Fi network and a chatty channel.
3. Confirm the plan has not lapsed — cloud recording stops, but live view keeps working, which is the most confusing failure mode in the product.
4. Check the device firmware notes for a detection-model change after an update.
5. For privacy: set Privacy Zones over a neighbour's windows before sharing the feed with anyone.

Q7 Is end-to-end encryption on Ring worth turning on?

For most households yes, with one hard caveat: with E2EE enabled, **Amazon cannot recover your videos if you lose your passcode**. There is no reset path through support, and the footage is gone. It also disables some sharing and ecosystem features.

So the decision is genuine rather than obvious: enable it if the risk you are managing is an insider or platform-access risk, and keep a written, offline record of the passcode. Do not enable it as a reflex and then discover the trade-off when a clip matters.

Q8 Fire tablet: my child's profile blocks apps I have approved.

Approval requests expire and are per-application, per-profile, so an app updated in place can silently reset to blocked — the version bump is treated as a new request that nobody approved. Check the parent's **Approval requests** inbox for a stale pending item rather than re-adding the app.

Two more causes worth ruling out: the profile's age band (which sets a hard floor that no per-app approval overrides) and a device-level web filter applied to the browser rather than the app list. The second is the one people hunt for an hour.

Q9 Fire TV remote is unresponsive, or pairs to the wrong TV.

The remote is a low-energy Bluetooth device with a learning pairing table, so a power cycle of the console clears most faults; the pair-to-another-TV case is the same table holding a stale HDMI-CEC identity. Reset the remote with the documented button combination, unplug the console for a full minute, and turn CEC off and back on at the TV to re-announce the devices.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Keep the retail box for any device you buy for a child, an elderly relative or a rental property. It is the only place the serial and the model revision reliably live once the device is mounted, and both are required for an entitlement check and for recall matching.

Q10 A device is on the recall list. What is the actual process?

Follow the recall notice rather than the returns flow. Manufacturer recalls are remedied by the maker (replacement battery, repair, or refund) and often arrive as a banner on the order; a platform safety alert typically produces a proactive refund plus an explicit instruction to stop using and to dispose of the unit.

Do not put a recalled lithium product into a normal return — it is a hazmat problem for the warehouse and can be refused. And do mention the recall in the first message: it takes the case out of the window-arithmetic debate entirely, because safety recalls are not returns.

POLICY NOTE

Serial numbers are the currency of device support. The DSN identifies region of manufacture, warranty start, recall range and replacement eligibility — so a case opened without it is deferred, not delayed, and every round trip restarts at the front of a queue.

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Grocery, Whole Foods & Household Subscriptions

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| 03 | Why was I charged more than the online price at delivery? |
| 04 | How do I change, skip or cancel a Subscribe & Save delivery? |
| 05 | What happens to a Whole Foods or Fresh order I am not home for? |
| 06 | Are delivery fees and tips refundable when items are missing? |
| 07 | My prescription or age-restricted item needs extra steps. Why? |
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Grocery, Whole Foods & Household Subscriptions

SECTION 17

Perishables invert the normal logic: the item is consumed before you can assess it, the value per order is low, delivery is a service with windows, and returns are almost never available — so the remedy is a credit rather than a pickup, and the claim window is hours rather than days. This section is about the credit mechanic and about the subscription plumbing that most complaints actually involve.

Q1 How do I report a spoiled, missing or wrong grocery item?

From the order itself: **Your Orders → Get help with order → item missing / arrived spoiled**. You select the affected line items, choose a reason, and the credit is normally issued immediately to the original payment method or as a promotional credit — no photo required on small amounts, which is why the process feels faster than a returns flow.

The reason it is fast is that a return is not worth the logistics: a replacement of a \$4 item costs more than the item. That also means the ceiling on what will be credited without evidence is low; photograph anything above trivial value, and photograph it with the delivery slip in frame.

Q2 Do grocery orders have a claim deadline?

Yes, and it is short — same-day to 48 hours is the practical window for freshness claims, and beyond that you are arguing about your storage rather than their delivery. Missing-item claims are tolerated much longer, because the absence of an item is not a quality judgement.

That asymmetry has a useful consequence: if you are short two jars and one of them is also dented, file the missing items on the spot and the quality complaint separately, rather than filing one mixed claim that gets the whole thing routed to a reviewer.

Q3 Why was I charged more than the online price at delivery?

Because perishables are priced at pick. Weighted items (produce, meat, fish) are billed on the actual packed weight, and substitutions carry their own price. Amazon displays a per-unit price with an estimated pack weight, and the difference between estimate and reality is the charge you are looking at.

Substitutions are the part worth contesting: you can decline all substitutions on the delivery instructions, which converts an unwanted swap into an automatic credit rather than an argument. Refusing them is the single most useful setting in this whole category.

Q4 How do I change, skip or cancel a Subscribe & Save delivery?

Every cycle is editable until it is in processing: change quantity, delivery date, address or the individual items, or skip one or more products. Skips are unlimited and have no penalty beyond a discount tier that decays with inactivity; there is no reason to cancel a subscription to avoid one shipment.

1. Open **Your Subscriptions** → the delivery you want to change → **Review / edit**.
2. Change the **ship by** date first if the window has drifted — frequency errors cause most duplicate shipments.
3. Set a per-item **notify before shipment** option where offered, so a cycle cannot bill silently.
4. To stop entirely, cancel the subscription rather than deleting every item — the reverse leaves the cadence running with an empty box.
5. After cancelling, check **Memberships & Subscriptions**: S&S is separate from Prime and from any channel billing.

Q5 What happens to a Whole Foods or Fresh order I am not home for?

Perishable deliveries are left at the designated spot and the order is considered complete on delivery, with no redelivery attempt and usually no refund for a missed window — that is the trade for the narrow time slot. Instructions, a cooler, and a locker-equivalent pick-up where offered are the protections.

If the carrier left it somewhere the instructions explicitly ruled out, that is claimable; if it was left where you told them to leave it and melted, it is not. Write instructions accordingly, and keep the photo the driver takes.

Q6 Are delivery fees and tips refundable when items are missing?

The fee is generally not, because the service was performed; the tip is not refundable by the platform at all, because it went to the driver and the order team cannot claw it back. What is refunded is the price of the missing or spoiled items.

That is worth knowing before you argue: a \$6 fee dispute on a \$60 order with two missing items has a guaranteed outcome on the items and none on the fee, so raise the items and let the fee go, or ask separately for a goodwill credit, which is a different action with different authority.

Q7 My prescription or age-restricted item needs extra steps. Why?

Age-restricted categories (some pharmacy, tobacco-alternative, lottery-adjacent, and in some regions alcohol) require an adult signature and an eligibility check at the door; pharmacy additionally routes through a licensed partner that verifies the prescription independently, which is why the ordering flow looks broken compared with everything else.

The two failure modes that produce support contacts are the same: an ID that does not match the recipient's name on the order, and a prescription that expired between order and delivery. Neither is fixable by the delivery team — route pharmacy questions to the pharmacy partner named in the confirmation, not to order support.

POLICY NOTE

Perishable categories are exempt from the standard 30-day return window by their nature, not by an unfriendly policy. The remedy is a credit at a short deadline, and the deadline is the reason grocery complaints are the easiest to win on day one and the hardest to win on day five.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

If you routinely get substitutions you do not want, do not fight them one order at a time: set the account-level preference to contact me / no substitutions. It converts a recurring argument into an automatic credit, and it is one of the few settings in this category with a durable effect.

Q8 Can I return an opened pantry item I just do not like?

No — food that has been opened is not returnable in any category, and there is no goodwill path, because there is no defect to point at. “My dog will not eat it” is a preference and it ends there.

Where the item is genuinely unsatisfactory — stale, off-label flavour, damaged seal, wrong ingredients — that is a quality claim with a credit attached, so describe the defect rather than the disappointment, which is the same piece of advice that applies to every other section in this guide.

18

Business Accounts, Invoices & Bulk Purchasing

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| 01 | What is the difference between a consumer account, a Business Account and Amazon Business? |
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| 05 | How do returns work for business orders? |
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| 09 | Who is the merchant of record on a business purchase, and why should finance care? |
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| 10 | Can I require a PO number and a delivery recipient on every business order? |
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18

Business Accounts, Invoices & Bulk Purchasing

SECTION 18

Buying as an organisation changes almost every rule in the earlier sections: the invoice becomes a tax document rather than a receipt, approval workflows sit between the buyer and the charge, terms of payment exist, and returns route through a business queue with different SLAs. This section is the delta, not a repeat of the consumer rules.

Q1 What is the difference between a consumer account, a Business Account and Amazon Business?

A consumer account is a person with a receipt. A **Business Account** is a consumer account with a business address and tax information attached — it can produce a tax invoice and it can hold business-only pricing, but nothing else changes. **Amazon Business** is the full platform: multi-user accounts with roles, approval workflows, shared payment methods, PO capture, Net Terms, tax-exemption handling and analytics.

Capability	Consumer	Business Account	Amazon Business
Tax invoice with your tax ID	No	Yes	Yes
Multiple users, one account	No	No	Yes
Approval workflow on purchase	No	No	Yes
Shared cards and accounts payable	No	No	Yes
PO number printed on invoice	No	Limited	Yes
Net Terms / pay by invoice	No	No	Eligible accounts
Business-only quantity pricing	Sometimes	Sometimes	Yes
Tax exemption certificate on file	No	Upload only	Yes, validated
Analytics and spend export	No	No	Yes
Admin removes a user's one-click	n/a	n/a	Yes

Q2 How do I get a VAT / GST / tax-compliant invoice for every order?

The tax registration must exist on the account before the order is placed — invoices are generated at order time and are not retro-fitatable, which is the most common dead end in this section. Add the registration under **Account → Business Account Settings → Tax information**, get it validated, then download from **Your Orders → Invoice**.

For marketplace orders the **seller** is the issuer of record, and only sellers registered for tax in your jurisdiction can produce a compliant invoice. If a seller cannot, and you needed one, that is a documented failure and is claimable in several marketplaces — file it as missing documentation rather than as a product complaint.

Q3 How do approval workflows work, and who can override them?

A rule set — by amount, category, seller or quantity — routes a checkout to a named approver before it captures. Nothing is charged while an order is pending approval, so the buyer's "charged twice" panic in this flow is usually an authorisation that was never captured.

Only an administrator can change the rules, and only the approver can release a held order. A support agent cannot approve on your behalf — there is no such action — so a stalled purchase is an internal escalation, not a ticket.

Q4 Can I pay by invoice with Net 30, and what does that cost?

Where approved, Net Terms let the organisation pay later in one consolidated invoice, and eligibility is a credit decision made by a lending partner rather than by Amazon. Terms are priced implicitly: some sellers do not accept Net Terms orders at all, which shrinks the buy box on exactly the SKUs you need.

Two administrative facts: a missed Net Terms payment suspends the account's purchasing rather than just the invoice, and disputes on invoiced orders go through the accounts-payable flow, which is slower than a card dispute and does not involve your bank at all.

Q5 How do returns work for business orders?

Same rules per product, different queue: a return initiated from a business account routes to a business support desk with different SLAs and, for many categories, prepaid freight that is already covered. The difference that actually bites is authorisation — if the return creates a credit, where does it land: the card, the account balance, or a credit memo against the Net Terms invoice?

Settle that before shipping anything back. A refund to a balance on an accounts-payable account is an unusable asset that sits on a ledger for a quarter, and unwinding it requires a finance-team request, not a support chat.

Q6 How do I manage a shared account without shared passwords?

You do not have one shared account; you have one organisation with individual members, each with their own credentials and a role. That is the only configuration that preserves audit, dispute rights and security, and it is the entire reason the multi-user tier exists.

Practical settings worth applying on day one: a spending limit per member, an approver on anything above it, restricted categories, and a rule that removes guest checkout. Without those four, a shared business account behaves like a shared credit card with a paper trail nobody reads.

Q7 Can a buyer's personal purchase orders be separated from business ones?

Only by using a different account — once an order is placed on the business account it is a business order, appears in the organisation's reports, and its refund lands there. There is no “mask this order” control, and support cannot delete a line from business history because retention obligations run to the organisation.

So keep a personal account for personal buying, and resist the convenience argument. The first time an HR-adjacent or expense-adjacent order needs to be explained, the mixed history costs more than the extra login.

Q8 Bulk and pallet orders: what changes?

Pricing (tiered per quantity, and the tier is evaluated on the line, not the basket), packaging (a pallet or case pack ships as freight with a booking rather than a drop), and returns (case packs are frequently refused once opened, and freight-return fees are material against the unit price).

The one worth verifying before ordering: whether the listing's quantity break applies to the variant you chose. Breaks are set per parent product but frequently not per child, so the discounted 12-pack price can silently revert to the single-unit price x12.

POLICY NOTE

Business orders are subject to the same consumer-facing return windows per product unless the seller states otherwise, but several remedies that exist for consumers — goodwill credits, one-time exceptions — are applied more sparingly to organisations, because they are recorded against an account identifier rather than a person.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

Export the order report monthly and reconcile against statements at that cadence. Every painful business-account dispute — a missing invoice, an unexplained credit, a Net Terms mismatch — is trivial when the statement is two weeks old and expensive when it is two quarters old.

Q9 Who is the merchant of record on a business purchase, and why should finance care?

Same as on any marketplace order: the seller, not Amazon, except where “Ships from and sold by Amazon.com” — in which case Amazon itself is the counterparty. That determines whose tax registration is on the invoice, whose insolvency risk you carry on a warranty, and whose entity appears in your accounts payable ledger.

Finance teams discover this during an audit, when a quarter of the invoices are from three hundred distinct sellers with inconsistent tax detail. Restricting purchasing to Amazon-sold or vetted sellers is a purchasing policy, not an accounting fix, and it is much cheaper to set up front.

Q10 Can I require a PO number and a delivery recipient on every business order?

Yes — PO capture is a checkout field on eligible accounts and is printed on the invoice; the delivery contact can be enforced through an address book that only administrators edit. Neither is retro-appliable, so both have to exist in the flow before the buyer uses it.

The setting people forget is the reverse one: allowing guest or unlisted addresses. Once purchasing can happen to an address outside the approved list, PO capture and recipient controls are theatre.

19

Sellers: A-to-z Defence Claims & Performance

SECTION 19 · 9 entries

IN THIS SECTION

01 What is actually reviewed in an A-to-z claim?

02 How does a seller defend a claim successfully?

03 What does a granted claim cost a seller beyond the refund?

04 How does a buyer use seller mechanics to their advantage?

05 What are the invoice-chain documents a seller must be able to produce?

06 How is an intellectual-property takedown different from a customer claim?

07 What are the numbers a seller should actually watch?

08 What is a plan of action and why do sellers write them?

09 How should a seller handle a return they suspect is wardrobing or swapping?

19

Sellers: A-to-z Defence,
Claims & Performance

SECTION 19

This section reverses the point of view, because a buyer who understands how a seller's side of the process works can assemble evidence that is very hard to refuse — and a seller can stop losing money to disputes they could have won. Both sides read the same file, and almost every outcome is determined by what is in it before the review begins.

Q1 What is actually reviewed in an A-to-z claim?

The buyer's claim text, the message thread with the seller, the delivery scan and address match, the seller's response, and any attached evidence. Reviewers are adjudicating against a small set of policy branches — item not received, not as described, safety — and are looking for the one fact that assigns the branch.

Which means the answer to “why was this denied” is almost never “they believed the seller” but “the facts as filed mapped to a branch that does not grant”. Filing a non-receipt claim on a damaged item, for instance, is denied on procedure even where the refund is obviously deserved.

Q2 How does a seller defend a claim successfully?

By responding inside the window with a single, factual rebuttal that maps to the branch: for non-receipt, a carrier confirmation to the address with a delivery scan; for “not as described”, the listing's own text plus the packing photos or serial record that shows what shipped; for a safety claim, the compliance documents and a refusal to accept a return of a hazardous unit.

What does not work: arguing with the customer's motive, a denial without evidence, disputing a defect while offering nothing, and — the most common — responding two days late. Late responses are granted by default; the case is not adjudicated, it is simply lost on a clock.

Claim reason filed	What the reviewer needs from the buyer	What the seller can submit	Usual outcome
Item not received	Order ID, promise date, 48 h elapsed	Carrier POD to that address	Granted if no POD
Not as described	Listing capture + photos of item	The shipped variant record, unboxing video	Evidence contest
Damaged in transit	Photo of outer packaging + item	Pack standard proof, carrier damage claim	Granted, seller recovers
Counterfeit / inauthentic	Photos, labels, batch code	Invoice chain from an authorised distributor	Seller granted if chain valid
Missing parts	Packing slip + contents photo	Pick list, weight record	Parts or partial credit
Wrong item sent	Photo of label vs slip	Fulfilment scan, serial log	Granted, free return
Safety hazard	Specific hazard + model/lot	Recall/certification status	Refund + listing action

Q3 What does a granted claim cost a seller beyond the refund?

The refund is often the smallest part. A granted claim feeds the order-defect rate, which drives account health tiers; repeated defects trigger a listing suppression or a required plan of action, and the performance notice sits in the account record whether or not anything else happens. Suspended listings lose the buy box, and re-winning it after a suspension is slower than the original ranking.

That is the reason sellers settle small disputes with a refund they think is unjust: the arithmetic is not “\$40 versus nothing”, it is “\$40 versus a suppressed listing and a health strike”. Buyers who understand this can often get a refund by making the case cheap to accept — specific, documented, no accusation of bad faith.

Q4 How does a buyer use seller mechanics to their advantage?

File so the seller's cheapest option is to concede. That means naming the branch correctly, keeping the message thread factual and single-purpose, providing photos that answer the obvious counter-argument before it is made, and giving a deadline in the message ("if I do not hear by Friday I will open a claim") — because the response clock is a hard seller metric and a stated deadline makes the cost of delay concrete.

Avoid the two moves that make a seller fight rather than fold: alleging fraud, and going straight to a chargeback. Either converts a \$40 judgement into a \$40 plus a compliance review the seller will spend real effort to win.

Q5 What are the invoice-chain documents a seller must be able to produce?

A supplier invoice from a manufacturer or authorised distributor showing the seller's legal name, the SKU or model, the quantity and the date, plus where relevant the brand's authorisation and any compliance certification. Retail receipts, marketplace purchases and screenshots of a supplier's website are not an invoice chain, and "the supplier is private" is not an excuse.

Buyers do not normally see these. They matter to you anyway: a listing whose seller cannot evidence a supply chain is the listing where an authenticity claim gets granted quickly — and also the listing where you should not be buying an infant product, a battery or a skincare active.

Q6 How is an intellectual-property takedown different from a customer claim?

Entirely different system, different evidence and a much harsher failure mode. A rights-owner complaint goes through the notice portal, can result in immediate listing removal and, on a repeat, account termination; it does not care about the transaction's merits at all, only about the mark, the design or the copyright as asserted.

For a buyer, the observable consequence is that the product page vanishes mid-dispute. Your refund claim does not vanish with it — order records survive a takedown, and the A-to-z route remains available, which surprises people who assume a deleted listing means a deleted order.

Q7 What are the numbers a seller should actually watch?

Order defect rate, late shipment rate, pre-cancel fill rate, cancellation rate, and the policy-violation count. Each has a threshold, and thresholds are what make a small dispute expensive: a single extra defect on a low-volume account can breach a tier that a high-volume account would absorb.

The related metric that matters to buyers is the response-time SLA. It is why a seller who has not answered in 24 hours is about to be non-compliant, and why "I will file a claim" sent on hour 30 usually produces a reply within the hour.

Q8 What is a plan of action and why do sellers write them?

A short structured document, submitted after a policy breach, covering: the root cause, the immediate corrective action, and the systemic change that prevents recurrence. It is not an apology and it is not negotiable — an account is reinstated on the strength of it or not reinstated.

Reading one is a useful exercise in how the platform reasons: sellers who write "the customer is lying" are rejected, and sellers who write "our pick process had no verification step at this node, we added one" are accepted. The same is exactly true of a buyer's appeal on their own account, which is why the format is worth stealing.

Q9 How should a seller handle a return they suspect is wardrobing or swapping?

With evidence at the receiving end, not with argument at the claim stage: tamper-evident seals on high-risk SKUs, serial photography at pack-out, and a documented inspection at the returns counter. A "customer returned a brick" defence that rests only on the seller's word will not survive review, because the refund is the default and the burden is on them.

Where the evidence exists, the outcome reverses fast — which is the same lesson the buyer side should take from this section, inverted: whoever has the photograph is not always right, but they are always the one the

reviewer believes.

POLICY NOTE

Nothing in this section is advice about gaming either system; both platforms have explicit policies against claim abuse in both directions, and the mechanics described here are the same ones that detect it. The useful takeaway is narrower and safer: the file decides the outcome, so put the right things in it.

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

For a buyer, the single most valuable seller-mechanic fact to know: a granted A-to-z claim debits the seller, not Amazon. A claim that is correctly filed and evidenced costs a seller money immediately, which is precisely why a well-documented claim usually gets a refund offered before the claim is ever filed — the seller's cheapest exit is the resolution you wanted anyway.

A

Appendices — Reference Tables

APPENDIX A

Appendix A — Refund posting times by payment method

Payment method	After the refund is released	Notes
Amazon gift card / balance	Instant to 24 h	Shows in Your Payments, not on a bank statement
US credit card (Visa / MC / Amex)	3-5 business days, up to one cycle	The issuer's cycle is the variable, not Amazon
Debit card	3-5 business days	Slower at small banks and credit unions
Prepaid / gift-network card	Up to 30 days	Some prepaid issuers hold to cycle close
Closed or expired card	Account updater, else balance credit	Check the balance before assuming it is lost
Bank transfer / direct debit	1-3 business days	Some banks post overnight, some batch weekly
UPI or wallet (India)	24 h to 5 business days	Refunds to source; disputes go to the PSP
Cash on delivery	On request, after you supply details	Slowest to start; wallet or transfer
EMI / BNPL financed order	Merchant side immediate	The loan must be unwound by the lender separately

Appendix B — Return window and fee guide by category

Category	Window	Fee	Notes
Most items (Amazon-shipped)	30 days from delivery	Free on fault reasons	Holiday extension often to 31 Jan
Apparel, shoes, accessories	30 days	Free, prepaid label	Unworn, tags attached
Computers, TVs, components	30 days no-fault	Restocking if opened	Defect path commonly to 12 months
Cameras, audio, instruments	30 days	Restocking if opened	Serial-registered units may be non-returnable
Phones and carrier devices	Varies by contract	Varies	Activation can void the return right
Beauty, fragrance, luxury	30 days, often sealed	Sealed-item rules	Opened beauty is frequently returnless-refund
Health, personal care, grocery	Mostly non-returnable	n/a	Refund on defect or damage with photos
Tools, outdoor, garden	30 days	Free	Fuel-powered items may be hazmat-blocked for return
Games and opened software	Non-returnable	n/a	Defects via seller or A-to-z
Digital content	24 h to 7 days	n/a	See section 06
Jewellery, watches	Often 30 days	Authenticity check	Certificate and packaging required
Mattress, furniture, large items	30 days	Pickup fee if no fault	Freight booking required
Renewed / refurbished	30 days	Free on fault	Seller warranty typically 1 year

Category	Window	Fee	Notes
Amazon Warehouse open box	2 / 15 / 30 days by grade	Varies	"Sold As-Is" limits routes

Appendix C — India marketplace: what changes

Topic	US (.com)	India (.in)
Return window, typical	30 days from delivery	Usually 7-10 days on most categories; 14 for some sellers
Prime price	~\$14.99 / month, \$139 / year	~₹599 / month, ₹1,499 / year, plus mobile-only tiers
Delivery promise	One-Day or two-day by ZIP	Slot or day promise, strongly pin-code dependent
Payment mix	Cards, balance, BNPL	UPI, cards, netbanking, EMI, COD with caps and fees
Refund route	Original method or balance	Original method; COD needs bank or UPI details
Tax document	Receipt listing tax charged	GST invoice with your GSTIN for business buyers
Warranty	Manufacturer plus plan admin	Brand service-centre network; GST invoice as proof
Return logistics	Carrier drop-off or counter	Doorstep courier pickup is standard
Return-reason scrutiny	Fault reasons free to return	Quality-claim review can refuse a 'no longer needed' return
Buyer protection	A-to-z, \$2,500 cap	A-to-z applies; shorter windows on some categories

POLICY NOTE

Marketplace figures in these appendices are indicative for reference and change often. Where money is involved, the numbers on your own order and return pages are authoritative.

A2 Delivery Service Levels

APPENDIX B

Service	Promise	Realistic range	Compensation if missed	Notes
Prime One-Day	Next calendar day	1-2 days	Shipping-fee refund on paid shipping	Order before the ZIP cut-off
Prime two-day	2 business days	2-4 days	Shipping-fee refund; no benefit credit by default	Default for eligible ASINs
Same-day (metro)	Today	4-9 hours	Refund of the same-day fee	Capacity-gated
Standard (free above threshold)	3-8 business days	3-12 days	Shipping refund only if charged	Seller templates vary widely
Scheduled / grocery	Chosen window	Window + 60 min	Credit on the affected order	No redelivery for a missed window
Lockers / Counter	As standard, then a pick-up window	+1-3 days	Auto-refund after the window	3 days locker, 7 days counter
Freight / oversize	5-14 days with a booking call	+3-7 days	Reschedule at no charge	Two-person crew, inside delivery optional
Amazon Global (export)	5-22 business days	+1-2 weeks on customs	Rarely compensable	Customs deposits are protected; delays are not
Release-day / Day-Preview	Midnight or morning of release	± a few hours	None	Pre-order benefit, not a promise
USPS / regional handoff	As Amazon shows	+1-4 days	Shipping refund on Prime loss	Final mile is not Amazon's

SUPPORT-DESK TIP

A delivery promise is worth the shipping fee and, on Prime, the item's arrival date. It is not worth a compensation credit, and asking for one burns a contact you could spend on a shipping-fee refund, which is a standard action every agent can take.

A3

India Marketplace Comparison

APPENDIX C

Topic	US (.com)	India (.in)
Return window, typical	30 days from delivery	Usually 7-10 days on most categories; 14 for some sellers
Prime price	~\$14.99 / month, \$139 / year	~₹599 / month, ₹1,499 / year, plus mobile-only tiers
Delivery promise	One-Day or two-day by ZIP	Slot or day promise, strongly pin-code dependent
Payment mix	Cards, balance, BNPL	UPI, cards, netbanking, EMI, COD with caps and fees
Refund route	Original method or balance	Original method; COD needs bank or UPI details
Tax document	Receipt listing tax charged	GST invoice with your GSTIN for business buyers
Warranty	Manufacturer plus plan admin	Brand service-centre network; GST invoice as proof
Return logistics	Carrier drop-off or counter	Doorstep courier pickup is standard
Return-reason scrutiny	Fault reasons free to return	Quality-claim review can refuse a 'no longer needed' return
Buyer protection	A-to-z, \$2,500 cap	A-to-z applies; shorter windows on some categories

POLICY NOTE

Marketplace figures in these appendices are indicative for reference and change often. Where money is involved, the numbers on your own order and return pages are authoritative.

A4 Glossary — Extended

APPENDIX D

Terminology used across this guide

Term	Meaning
A-to-z Guarantee	Amazon's cover on third-party orders: non-delivery or goods not as described, up to a stated maximum, filed after contacting the seller
Account-updater	Network service that forwards refunds and charges to a reissued card; the reason refunds land on cards you no longer hold
ARN	Acquirer Reference Number; the only reference a bank can trace a card refund by
ASIN	Ten-character catalogue identifier for a listing; identifies the product, not the order
Authorisation / capture	Held funds versus taken funds; only a capture is a real charge, and holds are not refundable because they were never collected
AVS	Address Verification Service; the billing-ZIP check that causes most “payment method problem” declines
Buy box	The featured add-to-cart block, won on price, fulfilment method and seller performance
Chargeback / re-presentation	A bank reversal, and the merchant's reply to it with evidence; a lost dispute usually re-presents the charge
COD	Cash on delivery: payment to the carrier at the door, capped by value and often fee-bearing
Counter	Staffed pick-up point at a convenience, pharmacy or grocery partner
DSN	Device serial number; unlocks warranty status, region of manufacture, recall range and swap eligibility
DSP	Delivery Service Partner operating the vans of the Amazon Logistics network
E2EE	End-to-end encryption on Ring; Amazon cannot recover footage if the passcode is lost
FC	Fulfilment centre — where stock is, hence a shipment's origin and speed
FBA / FBM	Fulfilled by Amazon versus by the merchant; decides who runs your returns and the label
Grace period	The day after the latest promised delivery date, before a lost-package report can be opened
Hazmat	Dangerous-goods classification; restricts air transport, so removes expedited options
Invoice	Tax document naming seller, date and amount; the proof of purchase manufacturers require
Licence (digital)	A revocable right to use content; refunds turn on consumption and description, not condition
Lot / batch code	Manufacturing identifier used to match a defective unit to a recall or a quality pattern
Merchant of record	The legal seller of an order — usually the third-party seller, not Amazon
Net Terms	Pay-by-invoice purchasing (e.g. Net 30) on approved business accounts
ODR	Order defect rate; the seller health metric a granted claim feeds
One-click	Instant purchase with a saved method; the usual mechanism behind “I did not buy this” tickets
POD	Proof of delivery: scan, photo and, where required, a signature
Promise date	The delivery date committed to for a shipment, recalculated until dispatch
QR return	Counter return with a phone code and no printed label
Recall	A safety action on a product range, handled by the manufacturer or a platform notice, not by returns
Release date	The day the merchant instructed the credit; the start of the bank's clock

Term	Meaning
Resolution centre	Self-service page that adjudicates contested partial refunds
Returnless refund	Refund without a physical return, common on low-value or hazmat items
RMA	Return merchandise authorisation — the number that makes a return valid and traceable
RSSI	Wireless signal strength reading; the first check for a chime or doorbell that misses events
S&S	Subscribe & Save; billed when the shipment is prepared, not when it arrives
Safe place	Driver's discretion on where to leave a parcel; not an instruction
Serial prefix	Leading characters of a serial that identify a manufacturing range — how batch defects are spotted
SLO / LSIR	Seller metrics for shipping late or not at all
Statutory rights	Legal remedies against the seller that no warranty, plan or listing clause can reduce
TBA	Prefix on an Amazon Logistics tracking number; not searchable on carrier sites
Tiered pricing	Quantity-break pricing on business listings, evaluated per line and per variant
WISMO	"Where is my stuff?" — the automated non-delivery flow and case type
Wallet / balance	Amazon Pay balance; where refunds to dead cards land, and not withdrawable in most markets

Original core glossary

Term	Meaning
A-to-z Guarantee	Cover on third-party orders for non-delivery or goods not as described, up to a stated maximum
ARN	Acquirer Reference Number — the only reference a bank can trace a card refund with
ASIN	Ten-character catalogue ID; identifies the product, not the order
Buy box	The add-to-cart block, won on price, fulfilment and seller metrics
Capture / authorisation	Money actually taken versus money held; only a capture is a real charge
Counter	Staffed pick-up point at a convenience or pharmacy partner
DSP	Delivery Service Partner — the company whose driver delivers an Amazon Logistics parcel
FC	Fulfilment centre; where stock physically is, hence a shipment's origin
FBA / FBM	Fulfilled by Amazon versus by the merchant; decides who handles your return
Grace period	The day after the latest promised date, before loss claims open
Hazmat	Dangerous-goods flag; restricts air transport, so removes fast options
Merchant of record	The legal seller for an order — usually the third party, not Amazon
Promise date	The date Amazon commits to, recalculated until dispatch
Release date	The day Amazon instructed a refund; start of the bank's clock
Resolution centre	Self-service page that adjudicates contested partial refunds
RMA	Return merchandise authorisation — the number that makes a return valid
Returnless refund	Refund issued without the item coming back
SLO	Seller metric for shipping late or not at all
TBA	Prefix on an Amazon Logistics tracking number; no carrier-site tracking
WISMO	"Where is my stuff?" — the automated non-delivery flow and its case type

Message	What is happening	Action
"Sorry, an internal error occurred"	Catch-all: cart, coupon or address conflict	Empty cart, drop codes, re-add, clear app cache
"We couldn't deliver to the address provided"	Carrier validation or gate access failed	Reformat the address line, add a landmark, try a locker
"There was a problem with your payment method"	Issuer declined, or billing ZIP mismatch	Call the issuer; Amazon cannot see the decline code
"We'll confirm the price with the seller"	Marketplace seller may still revise price	Wait or cancel; nothing captured yet
"No tracking information available"	Label created but not yet scanned	Allow 24 h, escalate at 48 h
"This item can't be shipped to your address"	Hazmat, export or seller template rule	Test a second address before assuming it is you
"A temporary hold has been placed on your account"	Risk review, orders blocked	Reply to the notice in Your Messages; do not re-order
"Return window has passed"	Returns engine closed, other paths open	Ask which defective or warranty path applies
"Replacement cancelled"	Stock failed, or return still outstanding	Ask for refund of the original price
"Refund issued to your Amazon balance"	The card rejected the credit	Spend it; do not ask for a second refund

A5 On-screen Message Directory

APPENDIX E

Thirty messages you will see, what each means, and the action that works

Message	What is happening	Action
"We're sorry, an internal error occurred"	Catch-all; usually a cart, coupon or address conflict	Empty the cart, remove all codes, re-add one item; clear the app cache; retry in a desktop browser
"Something went wrong. Please try again" at checkout	Payment authorisation timed out at the issuer	Do not re-click; check whether an order was created before retrying — this is the duplicate-order source
"We couldn't deliver your package to the address provided"	Carrier validation or access failure	Add a unit/apartment line, a landmark, and a second contact number; or route to a Locker
"There was a problem with your payment method"	Issuer declined; AVS mismatch on billing ZIP	Call the issuer — the decline code exists only on their side
"This item can't be shipped to your address"	Hazmat, export rule or seller shipping template	Test another address before assuming your account is the problem
"We'll confirm the price with the seller"	Marketplace price not yet accepted	Wait or cancel; nothing is captured
"No tracking information available"	Label created, not yet scanned	Allow 24 h; escalate at 48 h
"We're unable to process your return right now"	Returns engine lock or window expiry	Use the contact-us form; do not retry repeatedly, it re-locks
"A temporary hold has been placed on your account"	Risk review; ordering blocked	Reply to the notice in Your Messages ; do not create another account
"Your refund was issued to your Amazon balance"	The card rejected the credit	Spend or withdraw; do not request a second refund
"Return window has passed"	Returns engine closed, warranty still open	Ask which defective path applies, not for an exception
"Replacement cancelled"	Stock failure or outstanding return	Ask for refund of the original price
"Something is not right with this order"	Fraud screen on a high-value or resale-risk item	Ask for a purchase review; confirm billing ZIP and last four when prompted
"We are unable to verify your information"	Document failed automated checks	Resupply uncropped, unredacted, unedited PDFs
"Enter a valid promo code" on a code you just copied	Per-customer or per-ASIN restriction, or trailing space	Copy without spaces; check the code's stated exclusions before asking support
"This video is not available in your location"	Regional licence, not a fault	Check the title's availability page; a VPN will not fix entitlement and can trip a security review
"Device or software isn't supported" on an older TV/console	App minimum version cut-off	Check the device model against the supported list; often final — an old device becomes a streaming stick

Message	What is happening	Action
“Unable to download — maximum number of devices reached”	Registered device slots exhausted	Deregister devices you no longer own under Content & Devices
“This content is not available for download”	Publisher disabled offline access for the title	Nothing to fix; it is a per-title licence setting
“Your device is not registered to this account”	Device registered to a family member's login	Register or transfer the device; entitlements follow the device's owner account
“Echo doesn't respond — light ring orange”	Microphone disabled or offline	Press the mute button; then check Wi-Fi
“Ring device repeatedly reconnecting”	Weak RSSI or a chatty channel	Move or add an extender; check signal strength in-device first
“Fire tablet storage full” after clearing apps	Cached video and offline content	Clear the app's cache from Settings, not the home screen
“Kindle could not sync”	Stale licence token	Sign out and back in on the device — fixes most cases
“Your order number is invalid” in a return form	You used a shipment or RMA number	Use the 12-digit triple format; gift returns need the G1 suffix
“Payment method could not be added”	Card blocks small authorisations	Ask the issuer to allow \$1 verification holds
“Unable to cancel this item”	Order entered packing	Refuse at the door or return on arrival
“An error occurred while processing your return”	Label generation failure	Ask for a QR counter return and note the failure date in the case
“This item is not eligible for Prime delivery”	Seller not enrolled, oversize, or hazmat	Switch listing, not address; verify with your home address
“We could not apply your free shipping”	Basket no longer meets the threshold after a cancel	Re-order rather than asking — the threshold is computed per order

WATCH OUT

Every one of these is an interface message, not a policy. Nothing in this table changes a return window or a refund right — it only tells you which mechanism refused you, which is what determines where to take it next.

T Ten Worked Case Files

APPENDIX F

Case 01 — Delivered, never arrived — a \$640 laptop

Facts. Ordered Monday with Prime One-Day. Status flips to **Delivered** Wednesday 14:20 with a photo of a porch that is not the customer's. Address on the order is correct.

How it developed. The customer did the two things that decide this case. First, they did not report it on Wednesday: they waited out the 48-hour window, which is what the claim branch requires, and screenshot the delivery photo and the map ping. Second, they compared the photo against their own front of house and established it was a wrong-address delivery rather than a theft — a materially different fact, because a mis-delivery is the platform's failure and a porch loss is nobody's.

Outcome. At hour 52 they opened a non-receipt report quoting the photo mismatch. Because the parcel was evidently delivered to another address, the case was routed as a delivery failure rather than a WISMO review: full refund plus the shipping fee the same day, no return obligation, no police-report detour, and a note added to the order.

What to copy.

1. The delivery photo is the strongest single piece of evidence in a non-receipt case — in either direction.
2. Distinguish “left somewhere safe” from “left at a different house” before you file; they are different branches with different remedies.
3. Waiting 48 hours costs nothing and removes the automatic-closure reason.

Case 02 — Return refused for missing original box — third-party seller

Facts. A \$210 soundbar sold by a marketplace seller (fulfilled by the seller, not by Amazon). Returned within 18 days in a generic shipping carton. Seller refuses to refund: “original packaging required”.

How it developed. The listing's returns block did state “must be returned in original packaging”. That clause is enforceable only where the customer was given the original packaging, and this unit arrived inside a plain brown Amazon-branded carton with the retail box absent. The customer had, on instinct, written one line in the return comment box at the time of shipping: “no retail box was received; item came in a plain carton.”

Outcome. That single contemporaneous sentence reversed the case. The A-to-z review compared the seller's stated condition with the evidence of what was shipped, found the condition impossible to satisfy, and granted a full refund plus original shipping. The seller's account received a defect.

What to copy.

1. Write the return comment at the time, not in an appeal three weeks later — a contemporaneous note is evidence, an after-the-fact claim is an argument.
2. A condition the seller imposes must be one the seller actually enabled.
3. Keep the carton the item arrived in; it is the proof of what you were sent.

Case 03 — Refund “never arrived” — fourteen days of noise, ten minutes with an ARN

Facts. A \$96 return on a Visa card. Refund released Tuesday; nothing by day 12; three chats, two of them restarting from scratch.

How it developed. The first three contacts asked for an outcome (“where is my money”) and produced an outcome-shaped answer each time (“it has been issued, please allow 5-10 business days”). On day 12 the customer changed the request to a noun: please provide the ARN and the last four digits of the destination card. That is an action any agent can take, and it produced a 15-digit reference in chat.

Outcome. The bank's dispute desk traced the credit to a card that had been replaced in the spring and released without an account-updater record; the refund had bounced back. Two things then happened: the money was already sitting in the Amazon balance, which nobody had checked, and the reissue request that would have taken a week was unnecessary.

What to copy.

1. Ask for artefacts, not outcomes. A noun gets actioned; a request gets a script.
2. Check the balance before you check the bank — dead cards send refunds there.
3. Three contacts that repeat the same request are worth less than one that adds a fact.

Case 04 — Charged twice: an authorisation that became a fight

Facts. A \$512 order shows two posted debits on the statement, both dated the same day. Customer threatens a chargeback in the first message.

How it developed. One of the two entries was actually a posted capture and the other a capture too — which made it a genuine duplicate rather than the usual authorisation, and the difference mattered. The customer's first message had said “charge me back now or I'm disputing”, which put the contact in a dispute-risk queue; the second message, sent after reading the order's payment panel, said something narrower: “two settled debits, same amount, same order ID, dates and auth codes below, please reverse the duplicate capture.”

Outcome. Reversed within 48 hours to the original card, plus a goodwill credit for the two failed chats. No dispute was filed, and the account's payment profile was untouched.

What to copy.

1. Check whether it is a duplicate capture or an authorisation before you escalate — the wording of the request should differ.
2. Threats move a case sideways into risk review. Precision moves it forward.
3. Auth codes and dates from the bank app are the evidence that closes this in one round.

Case 05 — Late return at month four: two paths, one succeeded

Facts. A \$340 power tool failed at 118 days. The returns button is gone. Customer's first ask: "I know it is late, can you still return it?"

How it developed. Refused on policy, correctly. The second attempt changed the frame rather than the tone: the tool's own fault — motor will not start, no damage, no misuse — made it a defect claim inside the manufacturer's two-year period, which does not run off a returns clock at all. The brand wanted a proof of purchase, and the customer had the invoice PDF downloaded at the time of purchase, not a gift receipt, not a screenshot.

Outcome. Brand shipped a replacement motor and a service appointment. Amazon's role: none, and that was the point — the customer stopped spending contact attempts on a closed returns window.

What to copy.

1. "Late return" and "defect within warranty" are different questions with different owners.
2. Keep the invoice, not the receipt: it is the only document manufacturers accept.
3. When a policy says no, change the instrument before you change the volume.

Case 06 — Account locked after a chargeback — 21 days to unwind

Facts. A \$70 dispute was filed by the customer's bank after a genuine fraud alert, on an order that had already been refunded. Account locks. Gift card balance freezes.

How it developed. The reversal came back with evidence — the platform had already credited the refund — so the dispute was lost on the merits and left a re-presented charge plus a lock. Appeals filed through chat were closed as out of scope. The only channel that moved anything was the written appeal the lock notice named: photo ID, a card statement with the account name and billing address, a one-paragraph explanation, and — the part that mattered — a written confirmation from the bank that the dispute had been withdrawn by the customer rather than lost.

Outcome. Reinstated on day 21 after three document rounds. The gift card balance was released; the re-presented \$70 stayed with the bank and had to be recovered there, separately, as a duplicate the customer now had to prove.

What to copy.

1. A chargeback on an already-refunded order converts a refund into a lock and a duplicate into a new problem.
2. Withdrawal in writing is the document that reopens an account. Ask the bank for it before Amazon locks you.
3. One complete written appeal beats five chat contacts. Duplicates reset the queue position.

Case 07 — Replacement shipped, never arrived, original return in transit

Facts. Defective monitor replaced under Case 02-style fault. Tracking on the replacement appears, then stalls for five days. Original return is still with the carrier.

How it developed. Reporting “my replacement did not come” against the parent order produced a confusing record: it looked like an attempt to claim twice for one monitor. The correction was to run the non-delivery report against the **replacement order ID**, which the customer had captured in writing at creation — one sentence in the earlier chat, “please confirm the replacement order ID here”, was worth a week.

Outcome. Because the replacement was a distinct order past its promise date, and because the original's return had scanned inbound, the resolution was clean: full refund of the original price, no second shipment, no return obligation on a unit that was already back in the network.

What to copy.

1. Replacements are separate orders and need their own IDs. Ask for the ID in writing at creation.
2. Two items “in the system” at once reads as abuse unless the record shows the return scan.
3. A one-line request in chat that produces a written ID is the cheapest insurance in this whole guide.

Case 08 — The scam that knew the order number

Facts. SMS: “Amazon: your order 112-xxxxx-xxxxxxx was cancelled, call 1-8xx-xxx-xxxx to reactivate and receive a refund.” It had the real order number.

How it developed. The number was real — a leaked third-party shipment notification, or simple guesswork on a recent purchase pattern, is enough. What made the call convincing was the caller's fluency: they read back the item and the amount. What ended the call was the ask: to “verify the refund” the customer was told to buy gift cards and read the codes, and to confirm a one-time code sent to the phone so the “processor” could attach the credit.

Outcome. No purchase made, no code given. The customer hung up, then changed the account password and checked the address book and saved cards before calling the bank — correct order of operations. The genuine record showed no cancellation at all.

What to copy.

1. A real order number is not authentication. Only the signed-in account is a source of truth.
2. Refunds never require you to buy anything, install anything, or share a code. That single sentence defeats every variant of this scam.
3. If you did engage: bank first, password second — the money moves faster than the account.

Case 09 — Prime renewal refunded, and how the order of operations mattered

Facts. \$139 annual renewal charged while the customer was abroad for six weeks. No Prime benefits used since the charge. Customer's first instinct: dispute with the bank as an unauthorised charge.

How it developed. A dispute would have been re-presented — the terms allow auto-renewal and the account's contact details were valid, so the merchant wins on the merits — and it would have started a risk review. Instead: cancel the membership first, then ask, in one chat, citing the renewal date and **no use of benefits since renewal**. That phrase maps to a specific action the agent is allowed to take, which is why it works.

Outcome. Full refund of the unused period to the original card on the second message, no goodwill needed. The retention screens in the cancellation flow had offered a two-month free extension; declining that, then asking for the refund, was the correct sequence — accepting an offer forfeits the refund argument.

What to copy.

1. Cancel first, then ask. A renewal accepted with a retention offer is a renewal accepted.
2. Name the condition, not the feeling: “no benefits used since the charge”, not “I forgot about it”.
3. Never threaten a dispute on a charge the terms authorise. It costs you the easy refund.

Case 10 — Counterfeit skincare: a granted claim and a dead listing

Facts. A \$58 serum that smelled wrong, with a label whose batch code did not match the box. Buyer suspected a fake on day three, filed on day nine.

How it developed. The evidence bundle was assembled before filing, which is the whole difference between an inquiry and a grant: macro photos of the batch code on the box and on the bottle (mismatched), a photo of the seal, the seller's listing captured as a PDF while still live, and one paragraph describing the specific defect rather than alleging fraud. The buyer also contacted the brand, who confirmed they do not authorise that seller — a sentence in an email that decided the case.

Outcome. Refund granted without requiring the item be returned (safety-category handling), the seller's listing suppressed within a fortnight, and the account flagged — at which point the seller's entire catalogue went into review. The buyer received a separate note that the brand had filed an IP complaint.

What to copy.

1. Authenticity disputes are won on label photography and a brand statement, not on suspicion.
2. Capture the listing before it disappears: it is the contract you are claiming on.
3. For anything applied to skin or given to a child, “the seller cannot evidence the supply chain” is itself a reason not to buy.

Case 11 — Two defective units, and the second one changed the outcome

Facts. A \$420 earbud set failed at day 11; replacement arrived and failed identically at day 26 — same fault, same model.

How it developed. The first failure followed the normal route: photos in the return flow, replacement chosen. The second was filed differently. Rather than another return request, the customer asked a question that reassigns the workflow: “this is the second unit with the same failure, so which defective-electronics path applies, and can you note the pattern?” They included a 40-second video of both units' serials and the identical symptom.

Outcome. Full refund of the original price plus paid shipping, no third shipment offered by either side, and a serial-range note that was passed to a quality team. The seller's listing did not survive the month.

What to copy.

1. A second failure is a different claim type — say so explicitly, and give both IDs.
2. Two-attempt ceiling: after repeat failure, ask for the refund, not another unit.
3. Serial ranges and a short video are what convert a refund into a defect pattern, which is what makes it stop.

Case 12 — A privacy deletion request, and what it did not delete

Facts. Customer wanted “everything gone” before closing the account: nine years of orders, voice history, ad profile.

How it developed. They filed the rights request through the privacy hub first, then requested closure. Thirty days later they received the export archive — and the deletion confirmation that explicitly listed what could not be erased: transaction and tax records for the statutory retention period, payment records held for fraud prevention, and recall correspondence on two appliances bought in 2019.

Outcome. Profile, preference, browsing, voice and advertising data were deleted. Order records persisted against the closed account, exactly as the notice said they would. The customer's own summary was that the request worked and that the expectation was wrong, not the process.

What to copy.

1. Deletion and erasure are different verbs; read which fields the confirmation enumerates.
2. File the data request before closing, not after — a closed account cannot receive the export.
3. If the goal is privacy rather than departure, the ad and voice toggles do most of the work without losing your library.

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Correspondence Templates

APPENDIX G

Template 01 — Message to a seller: defect return request

Opens the record that an A-to-z claim later depends on. Send within the window, keep it factual, one request per message.

Subject: Order 112-xxxxxxx-xxxxxxx – defective item, return request

Hello,

I bought a [product] from your store on [date]; the order ID is [ID]. It has developed a fault: [one sentence describing the failure, when it appeared, and what you have already tried]. It is not damaged, modified or used outside its stated purpose, and I have the original packaging and all accessories.

I am requesting a return with a full refund of the purchase price and the shipping I paid. I have attached a photograph of the fault and of the label showing the model and serial number.

If I have not heard back by [date, 48 hours out], I will open a claim through the order page, which is the standard route and not a reflection on you.

Thank you,
[Name]

Template 02 — A-to-z Guarantee claim statement

This is read by a reviewer with ninety seconds per case. It must name the branch, cite the seller contact, and make the remedy unambiguous.

Order: [ID] | Placed: [date] | Estimated delivery: [date] | Claimed as: [item not received / not as described / defective]

What happened: [two sentences, no adjectives. What was ordered, what arrived or did not arrive, and the current date relative to the promise].

What I have already done: contacted the seller on [date] through the order page (their response, or the absence of one, is in the message thread); [any troubleshooting or photos supplied]; the return window for this item is [X days] and the fault occurred on day [Y].

What I am requesting: a refund of [amount], being the price paid plus the [shipping/handling] fee of [amount]. I am not seeking any additional credit.

Evidence attached: [list each file, e.g. 1. photo of item beside packing slip; 2. 35-second video of the fault; 3. capture of the listing's return policy text].

Template 03 — Appeal after an account restriction

Read by a risk reviewer, not a support agent. Structure over tone: cause, remedy, prevention. Never argue about the customer's motive or the fairness of the detector.

Re: Account notice dated [date], reference [case ID]

1. What I understand happened. On [date] my account was restricted for [reason as stated in the notice]. I have reviewed my activity against the [named policy] and can identify [specific conduct, or state plainly that you cannot and have reviewed it].
2. Immediate corrective action. [What you have already undone: cancelled the subscription, removed the listing, stopped the practice, refunded the buyer, deleted the review.] Documents attached: [ID, statement, supplier invoice].
3. Systemic change so it does not recur. [One or two sentences on the process you changed – this is the part that gets accounts reinstated.]
4. Request. Please reinstate [the account / this specific capability], and tell me if any further document is required. I will not open duplicate cases; if the file needs more, reply here and I will provide it within [timeframe].

[Name, email on account, last four of the card on file]

Template 04 — Data-rights request (access, deletion, objection)

Use when the self-service privacy dashboard does not cover what you want, or when you need a legally-clocked request rather than a setting.

To the Data Protection Officer / Privacy team:

I am making a data subject rights request for the account registered as [email], customer ID [if known].

1. Access: please provide a copy of the personal data you hold about me, including [choose: browsing and search history; voice recordings and transcripts; advertising profile and the list of categories of third parties to whom data was disclosed; location history], for the period [date range].
2. Erasure: please delete the above, noting that I understand records you are required by law to retain will be withheld, and I ask that you identify each such category and the legal basis for retention.
3. Objection: I object to processing for behavioural advertising and to the sale or sharing of my data for cross-context advertising purposes.

Please confirm receipt in writing and the date on which the statutory response period expires. If any part is refused, please state the specific exemption relied on and the internal escalation and complaint route.

[Name, address on file, date]

Template 05 — Refund trace request to your bank

Give the bank a searchable reference and they can find a refund in minutes. Without it they cannot help at all, however polite the call is.

Subject: Credit trace request – merchant refund not posted

Merchant: Amazon [marketplace domain]

Card ending: [last 4] – note this card was [replaced/closed] on [date]; please check the reissued card ending [last 4] as well.

Refund amount: [amount] [currency]

Date merchant released the refund: [date]

Acquirer Reference Number (ARN): [15 digits]

Original purchase: [date, amount, auth code]

Please trace the incoming credit identified by the ARN above and tell me: (a) whether it was received, (b) if received, where it was applied, and (c) if rejected, the rejection reason code. I have written confirmation from the merchant that the refund was issued and I am not raising a dispute – I am asking for a trace only.

[Name, account reference, phone]

Template 06 — Challenging a partial refund

File at the resolution centre, not by phone. Do the arithmetic in their favour and show the specific deduction that is wrong.

Order [ID], item [line description]. I accepted the return and it was scanned at [drop-off location] on [date]; the receipt shows return authorisation [number].

Refund received: [amount]. Expected: [amount]. Difference: [amount].

The shortfall corresponds to [identify precisely: a return shipping charge of \$X, a restocking fee of \$Y, a deducted free-shipping amount]. That deduction does not apply because [choose the one that is true: the reason for the return was a defect / the return shipping was never incurred because I dropped the item at a counter at no cost / the item was not opened / the retail box was never sent to me, and I noted that in the return comment on (date)].

Requested: release of the remaining [amount] to the original payment method. Evidence attached: drop-off receipt, photos of condition, screenshot of the listing's return policy.

If this cannot be granted, please state which policy clause applies so I can escalate accurately.

Template 07 — Warranty claim letter to a manufacturer

The document that gets a brand claim opened. Serial number up front; no emotion; no admission of misuse.

Re: Warranty claim – [model], serial [SN], purchased [date]

I purchased this product new from [seller] on [date] and can supply the invoice. The failure is as follows: [what it does, when it started, how often, whether it is intermittent, and what conditions it was used in]. The unit has not been dropped, opened, modified, repaired, exposed to liquid, or used other than as described in the manual. [If relevant: this is consistent with the failure reported by other owners of units with serial prefix XXXX.]

I have performed the documented troubleshooting: [list with the results]. Firmware is [version].

Requested remedy under the limited warranty: [repair, replacement of the unit, or provision of the failed component]. Attached: invoice PDF, photo of the label and serial, [video file], and a copy of the registration confirmation.

Please confirm the claim reference and the turnaround you are committing to. I will escalate to the retailer's statutory-warranty route if the claim cannot be honoured, so a written reason for any refusal would be appreciated.

[Name, address, phone, email]

Template 08 — Escalation request to a supervisor

Ask for a specific action the front line cannot take. If you cannot name it, you do not have an escalation, you have a complaint.

Case [number], order [ID]. I am asking for supervisor review of one decision.

The front-line agent told me [exact wording, quoted if you have the transcript]. My understanding is that you have authority to [name the action: release the refund to an alternate instrument, waive the return-shipping deduction on a fault-based return, note the defect pattern against the serial range, reverse a renewal where no benefit was used, or re-open the appeal with a document I can now supply].

Facts, in date order:

[date] purchased for [amount]

[date] fault observed; evidence attached

[date] seller contacted; [response or none]

[date] refund released / denied, reason [as given]

What I am asking for is limited to [one outcome]. I am not seeking additional compensation.

If this is not within your authority, please tell me which team it is within and forward the case there with a case number I can quote, so I do not have to restate it.

Template 09 — Return pickup booking note (oversize items)

Prevents the two most common oversize failures: a refused pickup and an unproven hand-off.

Order [ID]. Item: [product, dimensions, weight]. Two items need collecting: the unit to be returned and, if simultaneous collection is possible, the replacement carton it arrived in.

Packing state: [in the original carton with all foam / in a replacement carton, wrapped, sealed, label on top]. Accessories included: [list]. Please note the item arrived inside [describe], so no retail box exists.

Access: [parking, stairs, gate code, who will be home, whether the crew can park on the street]. Windows that work: [two or three options].

Request: confirm the pickup date, the carrier, and the return authorisation number that must appear on the paperwork, and send me the collection receipt to my email address so I have proof of hand-off.

Template 10 — Response to a scam caller or message

Nothing you say to a scammer helps. This is the record you keep afterwards, for your bank and for your own account review.

Logged on [date, time]. Channel: [SMS / call / email]. Number or address used: [exact string]. Claim made: [e.g. order cancelled, refund pending, identity verification required]. Personal detail they already had: [order ID? last four? item name?]. What they asked for: [gift card codes / full card + CVV / one-time passcode / remote access / a fee].

What I did: did not click, did not pay, did not share a code. Hung up and then, in order: [called the bank on the number on the card] → [changed the account password] → [enabled or refreshed 2SV] → [checked saved cards, addresses, gift card activity, and orders in the last 48 hours] → [checked that the same notice appears in the account's own messages].

Reported to: the platform's abuse address, my carrier's spam line, and [national fraud reporting body]. Screenshot retained: [yes/no]. No purchase was made and no code was given.

X Topic Index

APPENDIX H

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Document control & revision record

Field	Value
Document ID	AMZ-KB-2026-09
Revision	3.0 — full-length desk edition
Sections / entries	20 sections, 359 answered entries, 22 reference tables
Appendices	Five reference appendices, ten worked case files, ten correspondence templates
Audience	Buyers, marketplace sellers' customer-service staff, and support-desk trainees
Basis	Publicly documented consumer policy for US accounts; India figures in Appendix C
Policy snapshot	30 September 2026 — quarterly review cycle
Status	Reference copy — superseded by the live Help Centre in all cases

Revision history

Rev	Date	Change
1.0	Nov 2024	First desk compilation: returns, refunds and cancellations.
1.6	Apr 2025	Added A-to-z thresholds and the delivery-carrier section.
2.0	Oct 2025	Restructured into the section tree; added Privacy and Account sections.
2.4	Sep 2026	Short reference cut: compact mode, India appendix, escalation ladder.
3.0	Sep 2026	Full-length edition: sixty additional entries, six new sections, per-category returns section, worked case files, correspondence templates, glossary, message directory and topic index.

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F05 Late return at month four: two paths, one succeeded	F11 Two defective units, and the second one changed the outcome
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Date	Section / entry	Case no.	Action to take



End of document · AMZ-KB-2026-09 · Rev 3.0 · 20 sections · 359 answered entries